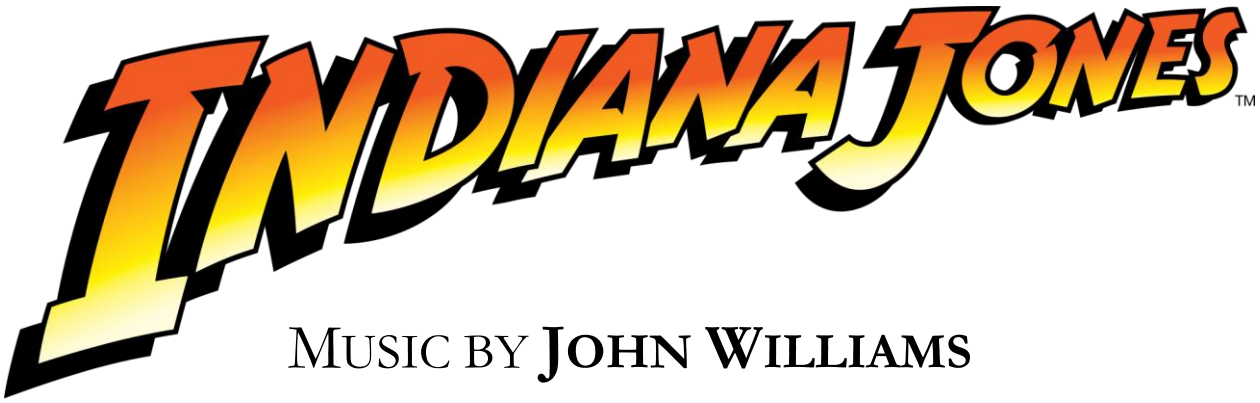
A GUIDE TO THE MUSICAL THEMES OF



MUSIC BY **JOHN WILLIAMS**

Raiders of the Lost Ark (1981)
Indiana Jones and the Temple of Doom (1984)
Indiana Jones and the Last Crusade (1989)
Indiana Jones and the Kingdom of the Crystal Skull (2008)
Indiana Jones and the Dial of Destiny (2023)

CATALOGUE CONTENTS

I. **Heroes and Sidekicks**
II. **Villains and Henchmen**
III. **MacGuffins and Artifacts**
IV. **Chases, Fights, and Escapes**
V. **Creepy Crawlers** (*Future Update*)
VI. **Exotic Locales** (*Future Update*)
VII. **Appendix**

This guide is updated and revised continually. Stay tuned!

Materials herein are based on research and transcriptions of
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Associate Professor of Music, Tufts University.

Stable link here: franklehman.com/indiana-jones-themes | Updated July 2, 2023

THEMES AT A GLANCE

John Williams's five *Indiana Jones* scores are defined by a strongly thematic style, emblematic of the revival of the Classical Hollywood symphonic idiom during in the 1970s-80s. Most themes and recurrent motifs introduced within a given entry are varied and developed significantly within that entry, though besides the Raiders March, and to a lesser extent Marion's Theme, no theme is substantially revisited across films.

The below list displays **prominent** series themes in order of **first in-film** appearance. Major leitmotifs—themes with particularly strong musical salience and degree of development—are indicated in **bold**; each film tends to introduce only three. Below table does not include incidental motifs or set-piece themes.

RAIDERS OF THE LOST ARK *(ROTLA)*		***First Use***	***Cue***
1.	**Raiders March**	0:11:50	2m2
2.	**Ark**	0:19:45	3m1
3.	**Marion**	0:21:30	3m2
4.	Medallion	0:28:05	3m4/4m1
5.	Nazis - Motif	1:18:30	8m5 (hinted 6m3)
THE TEMPLE OF DOOM *(TOD)*			
6.	**Short Round**	0:10:54	1m7/2m1
7.	**Willie**	0:14:50	2m2
8.	**March of the Slave Children**	0:24:15	3m1
9.	Sankara Stones	0:25:25	3m1
10.	Pankot Palace	0:35:40	4m3
11.	Temple of Doom	1:00:00	7m1
THE LAST CRUSADE *(TLC)*			
12.	Cross of Coronado	0:03:20	1m2 or 1m3
13.	**Grail**	0:10:30	1m4/2m1
14.	Father & Son	0:22:30	3m3
15.	**Henry Jones Sr.**	0:34:58	4m3 or 5m1
16.	**Nazis - Theme**	0:52:40	6m3 (?)
17.	**Scherzo for Motorcycle & Orchestra**	0:59:20	6m3
18.	Keeping Up With The Joneses	1:07:20	6m5
THE KINGDOM OF THE CRYSTAL SKULL *(KOTCS)*			
19.	**Russians**	0:05:03	1m3
20.	**Irina**	0:05:43	1m4
21.	**Crystal Skull**	0:30:40	2m15 (hinted 2m6)
22.	Mutt	1:19:03	5m39 (hinted 2m19)
THE DIAL OF DESTINY *(DOD)*			
23.	**Voller & Nazis (Theme Cluster)**	0:00:35 (**D**), 0:05:30 (**A**), 0:06:10 (**B**), 0:17:05 (**C**)	
24.	**The Antikythera (Theme Cluster)**	0:11:45 (**B**), 0:12:05 (**A**)	
25.	**Helena**	0:14:40	
26.	Syracuse	1:25:40	
27.	Archimedes	1:50:45	



I. HEROES AND SIDEKICKS
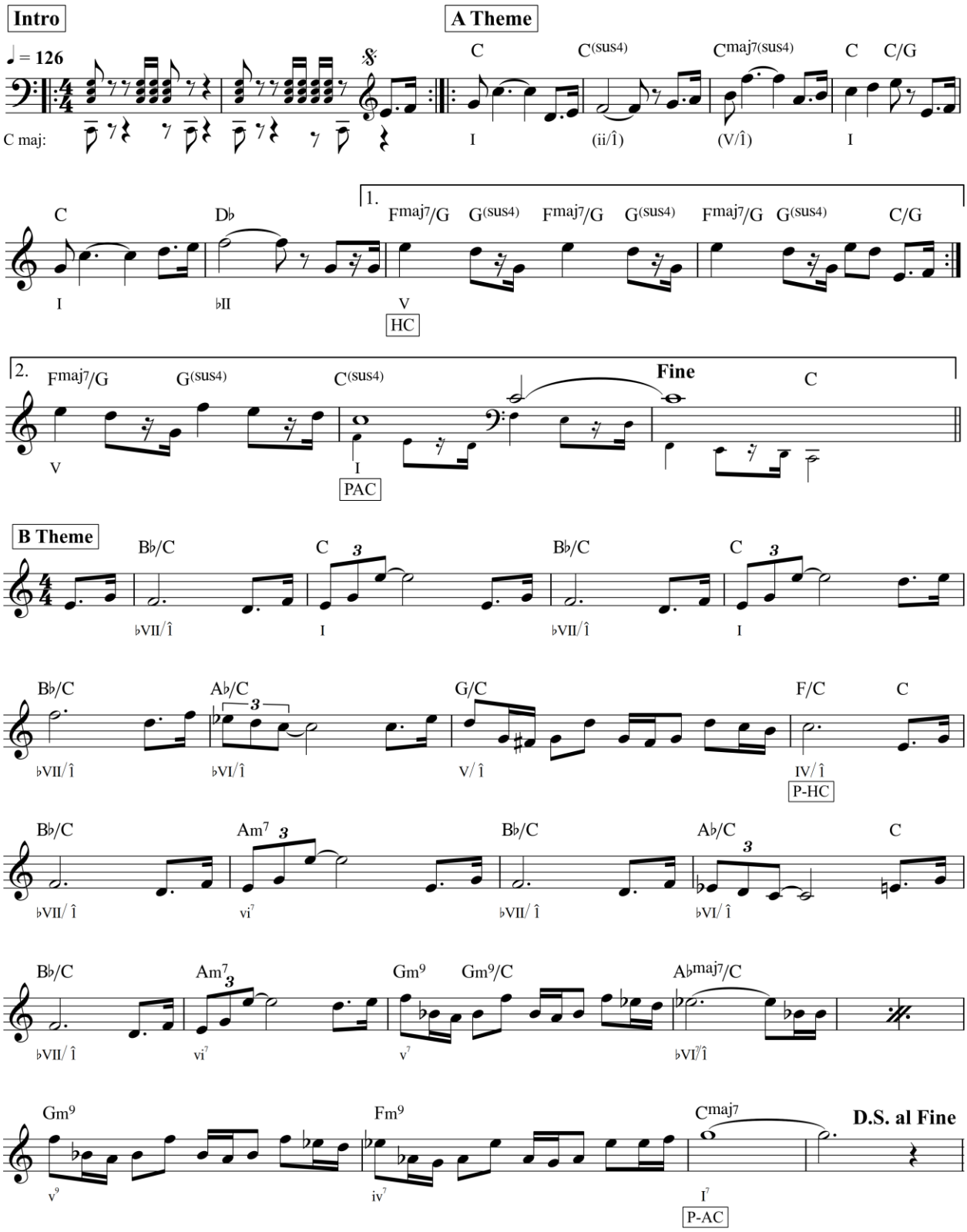
The protagonists in the *Indiana Jones* series tend to be strongly identified with musical themes, starting with the title character himself, whose leitmotif, "The Raiders March," doubles as the brashly anthem for the franchise itself. The Raiders March also has a tendency to interact and combine with other hero themes (Short Round, Mutt). Generally speaking, protagonist music in this series follows typical Classical/New Hollywood practices of associating heroes with functional tonality, major or major-type scales, conventional phrase and thematic structures, and tuneful and easily learned melodic patterns that bear repetition and abbreviation.

Not every protagonist receives a distinct theme (Sallah, Marcus, Oxley) or a properly recurring leitmotif and thematic material for female characters in earlier entries (Marion, Willie, Elsa) tend to serve as romantic relationship themes as much as they do musical portraits of individuals. Indiana Jones's father, Henry Jones Sr., has a particularly complex musical characterization, with a leitmotif that serves equally a Grail Quest theme, and a cluster of related musical ideas (Keeping Up With The Joneses, Father and Son) with somewhat vague and inconsistent usage.

THE RAIDERS MARCH

Example transcribed from ROTLA End Credits, Part 2
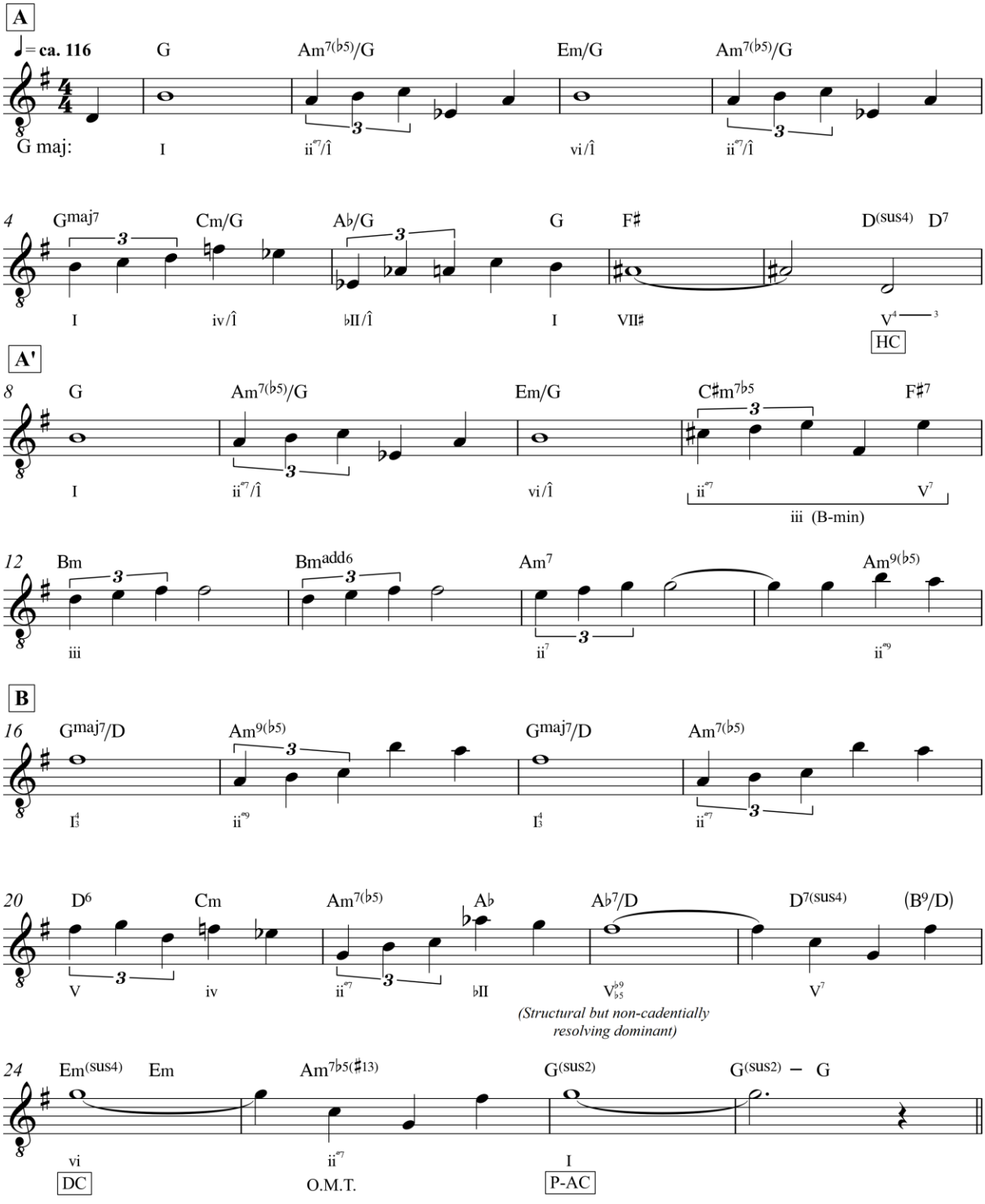
Major Theme. Franchise-defining melody, used and varied extensively in **every film**. Associated closely with character Indiana Jones (Harrison Ford), heroism and adventure more generally. Comprises two sub-themes used independently in underscore: the ubiquitous **A Theme** and the slightly rarer **B Theme**, together components of rounded ternary form in concert arrangement, with **B** serving as a bridge. *Note: Thematic transformations of Raiders March to be detailed in future update to this catalogue.*



MARION

Example transcribed from ROTLA End Credits, Part 2

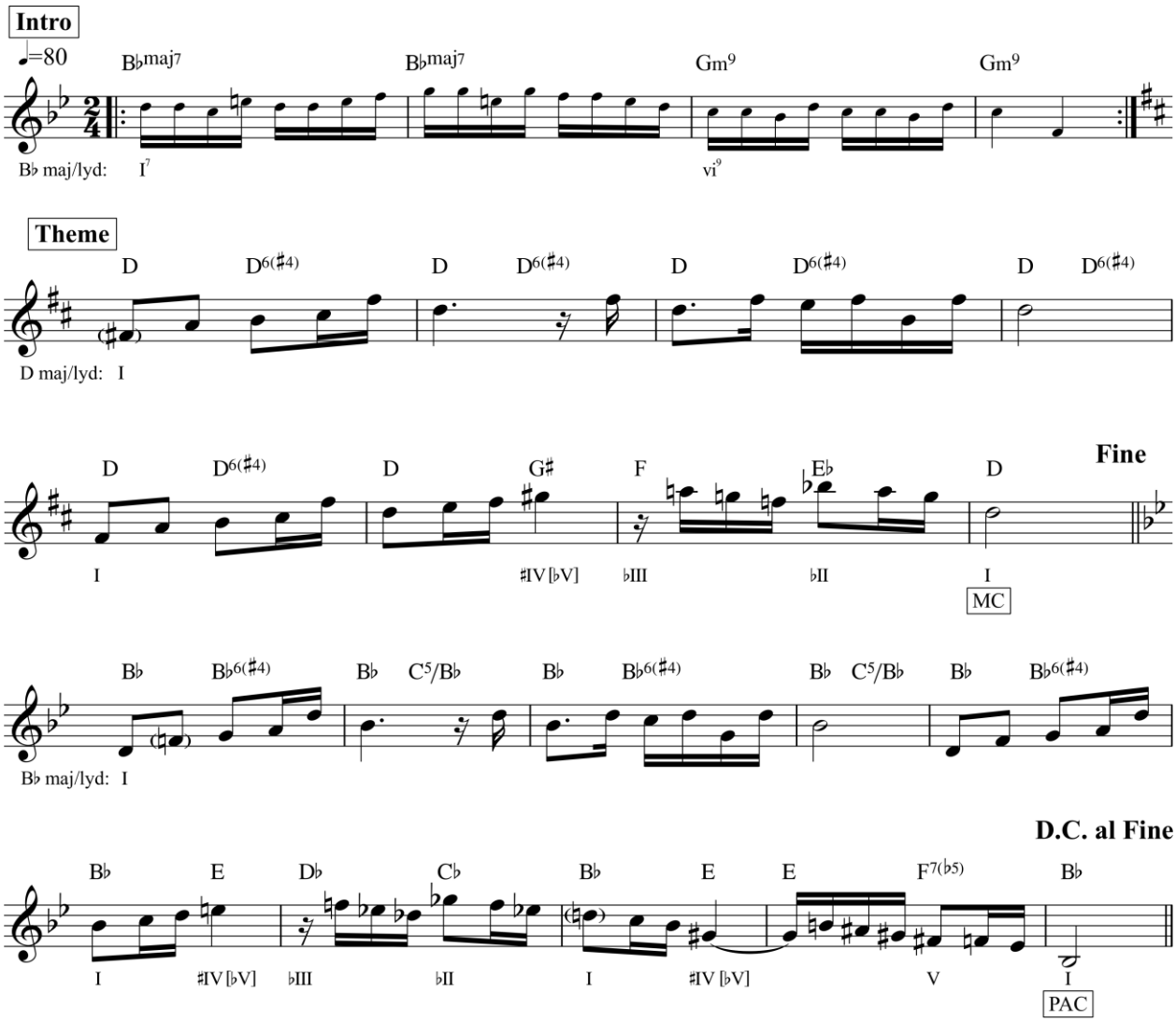
Major Theme. Leitmotif for heroine Marion Ravenwood (Karen Allen). Primarily employed as romantic love theme in *Raiders*, less a characterization of Marion than Indy's feelings towards her. Takes on more active, action-oriented character in several cues upon revival in *Crystal Skull* (e.g. 4m37, 5m42).
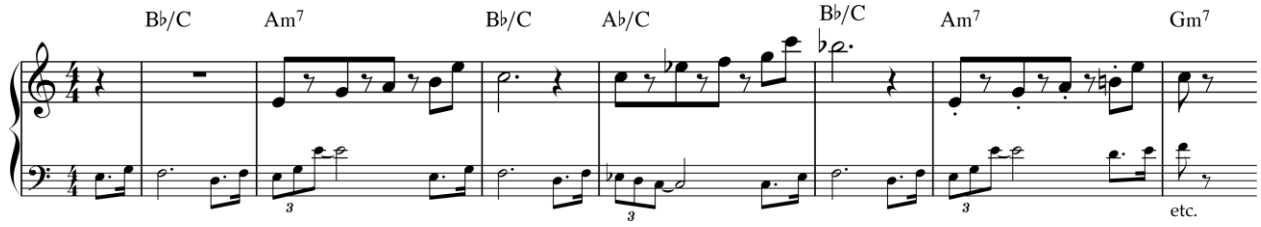


SHORT ROUND

Examples transcribed from TOD 12m5

Major Theme. Leitmotif for Indy's child sidekick Shorty (Ke Huy Quan) in *TOD*, with a handful of less specific usages (e.g. 3m3/4m1). Melody pentatonic, with lydian and chromatic harmonic inflections. Capable of serving as countermelody against/variation of/extension for Raiders March A & B.
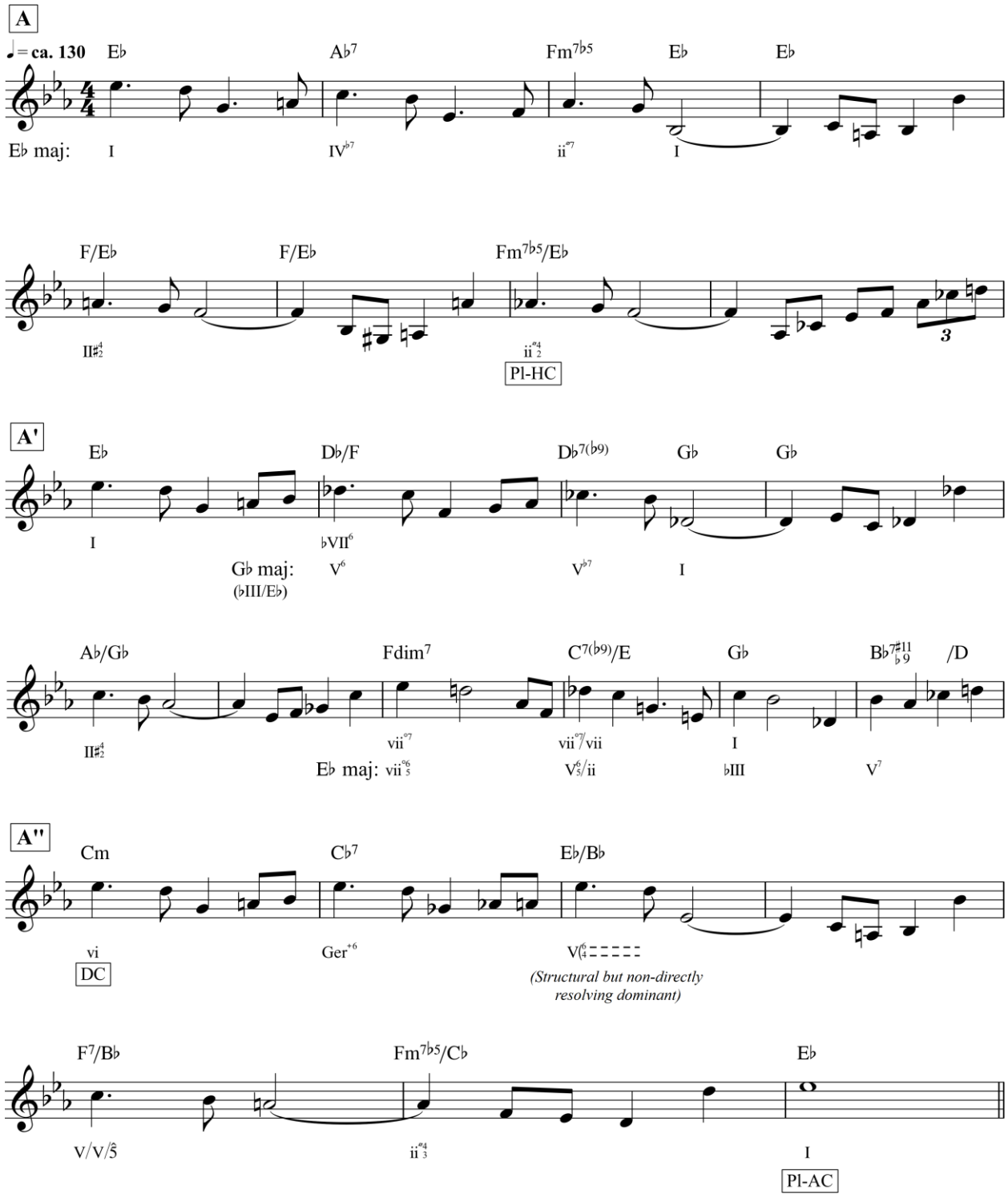


SHORTY & INDY



WILLIE

Example transcribed from TOD 12m5
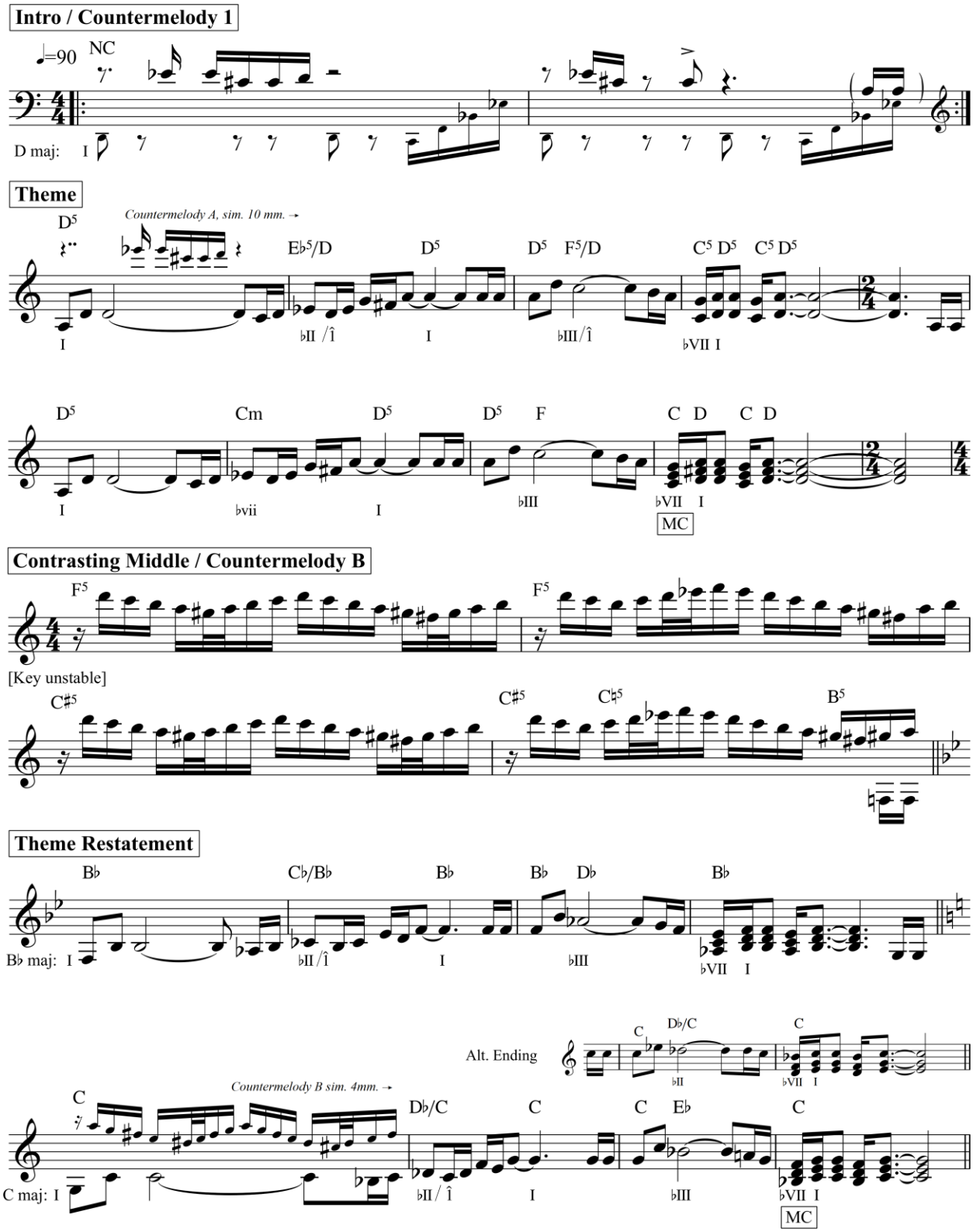
Major Theme. Leitmotif in *TOD* for heroine/love-interest Willie Scott (Kate Capshaw). Like Marion's theme, serves as much as romance leitmotif as musical characterization of Willie specifically. Melodically and orchestrationally distinctive but harmonically and formally related to Marion.



MARCH OF THE SLAVE CHILDREN

Example transcribed from TOD 9m7/10m1

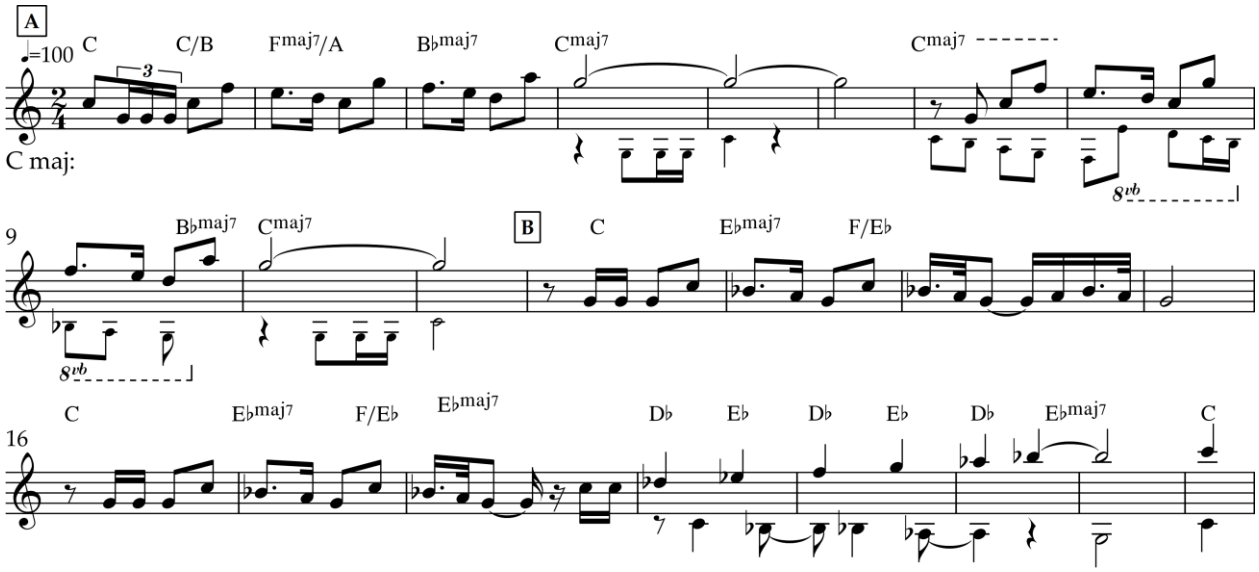
Major Theme. Multi-purpose leitmotif from *TOD*, representing enslaved villagers, heroic rescues, legend of Sankara Stones, and idea of "Fortune of Glory." Strong modal inflections throughout. Main melodic idea supplemented by two recurring countermelodies with similar non-diatonic orientation.



BRITISH RELIEF

Example transcribed from TOD 12m1

One-off motif for Captain Blumbert and the British soldiers he brings to rescue the heroes at end of TOD. Elgarian/Waltonian touches characteristic of Williams writing in Edwardian heroic style.

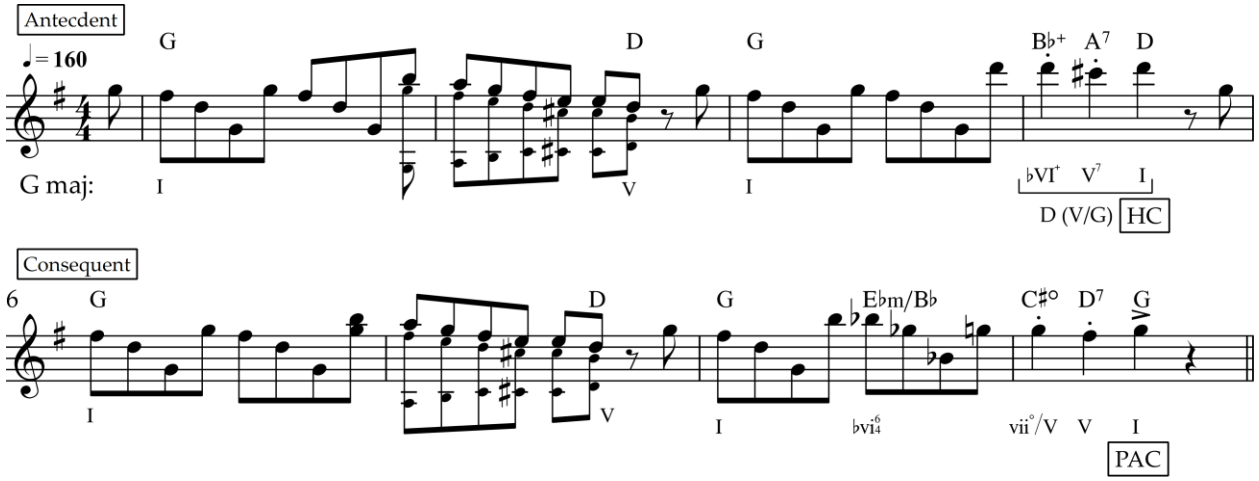


YOUNG INDY
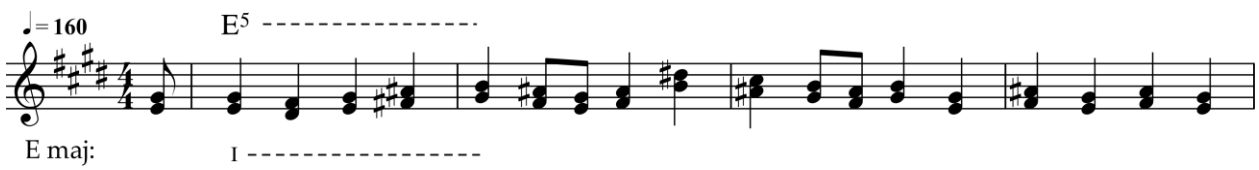
Examples transcribed from TLC 1m3, 1m4/2m1

Pair of related minor themes from TLC, used and developed only during "Indy's First Adventure" sequence (1m2 to 1m4/2m1). Lydian inflections and melodic patterns shared by both.

YOUNG INDY MOTIF 1
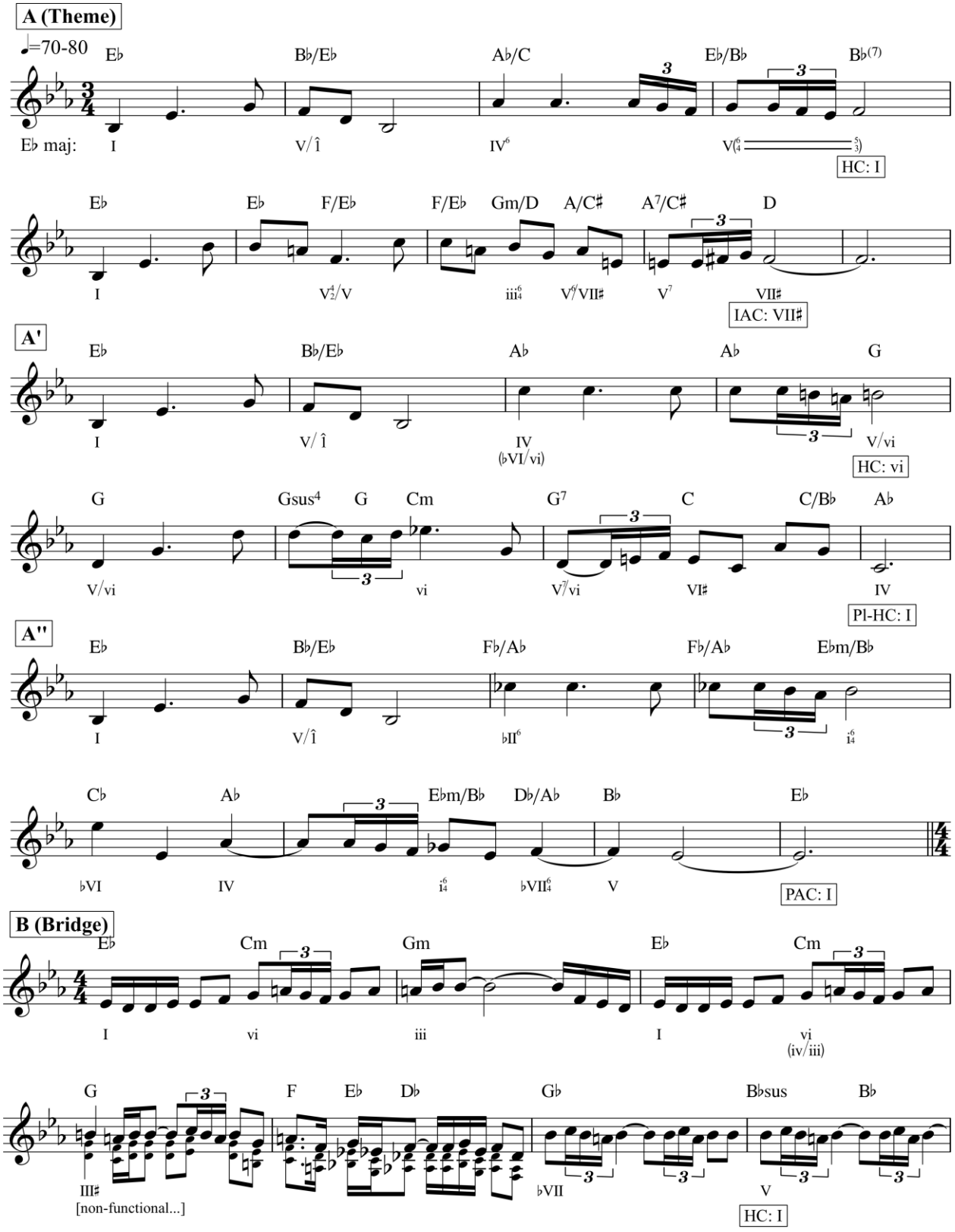


YOUNG INDY MOTIF 2



HENRY JONES SR. / GRAIL QUEST

Example transcribed from TLC 14m2

Major Theme. Leitmotif in *TLC* for relationship between Indy and father Henry Jones (Sean Connery). Also serves as general Grail Quest theme in *TLC*, family theme in *KOTCS* (3m13, 7m54).

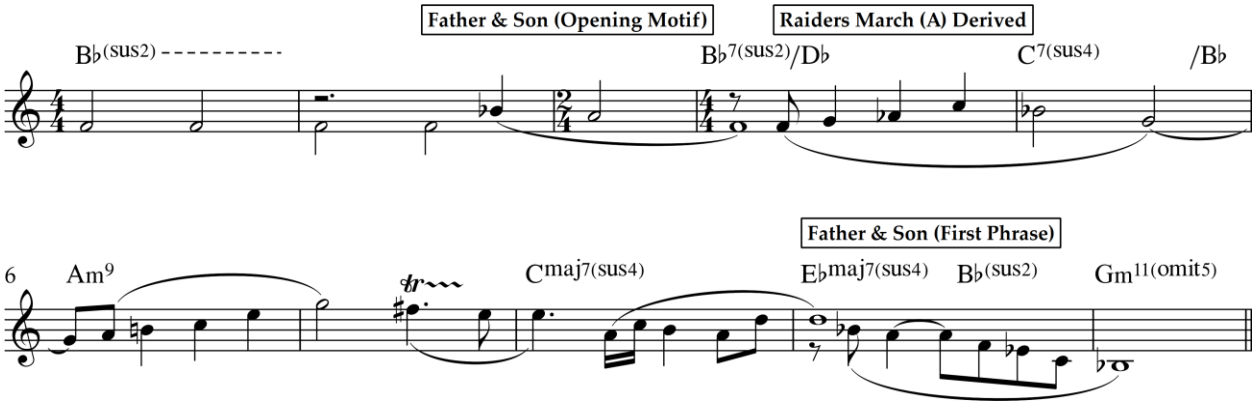


FATHER AND SON

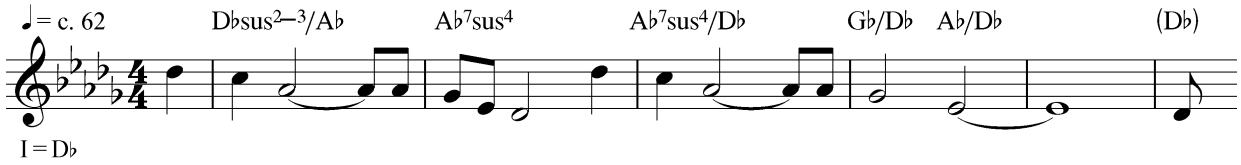
Examples transcribed from TLC 3m3, 7m4/8m1, and 9m2.

Minor, easily missed but common and versatile motif from *TLC*, closely related to and probable source of "Keeping Up With The Joneses" motif (see next page). Associated with relationship between Indiana Jones and father Henry Jones, heard at moments of high poignancy or sentiment. No definitive form: multiple stages in its fairly subtle development depicted below.

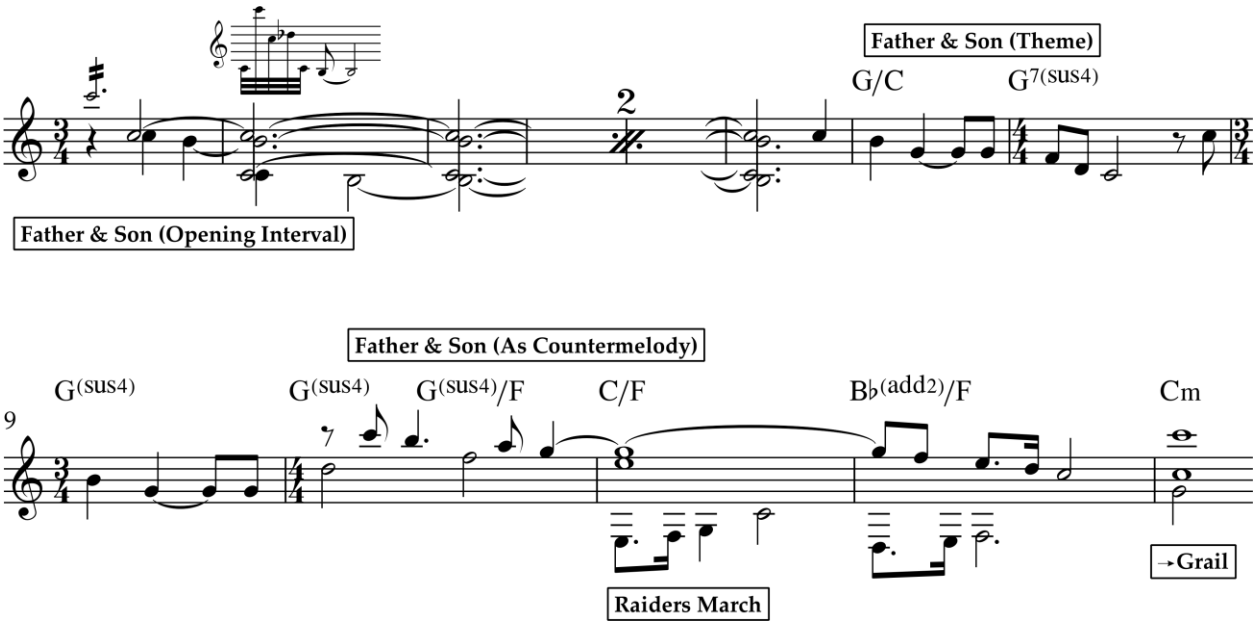
INTRODUCTORY STATEMENT



CLEAR STATEMENT



CLIMACTIC STATEMENT + COMBINATION WITH RAIDERS MARCH

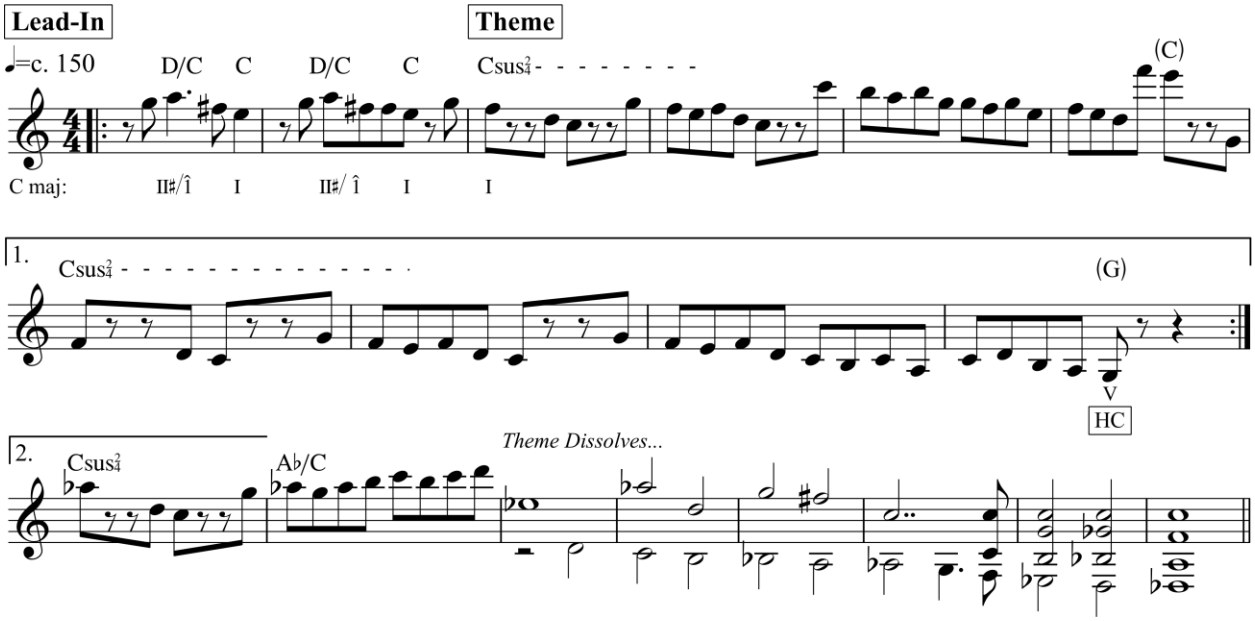


KEEPING UP WITH THE JONESES
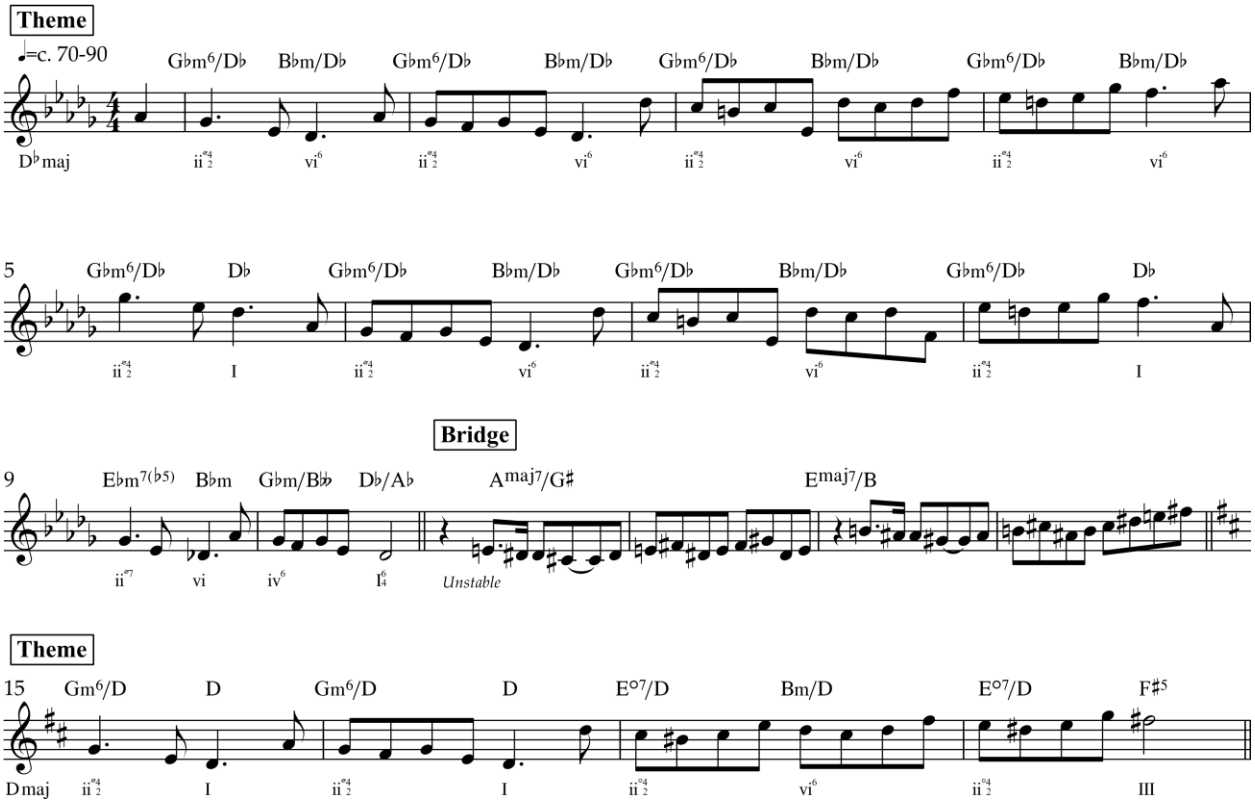
Examples transcribed from TLC 9m2 and 7m4/8m1.

Minor theme from TLC, primarily presented in unused cue 9m2 ("Keeping Up With The Joneses" on OST). Associated with misadventures of Marcus and the Jones Boys. Two distinct variants: fast in 6m55 & 9m2, 10m3/11m1 as light-hearted action music, slow/sentimental in 9m2 & 7m4/8m1. Derived from Father & Son motif: *c.f.* shared (Î-7̂)-5̂-4̂-2̂-Î figure; derivation esp. apparent in 9m2).

FAST FORM



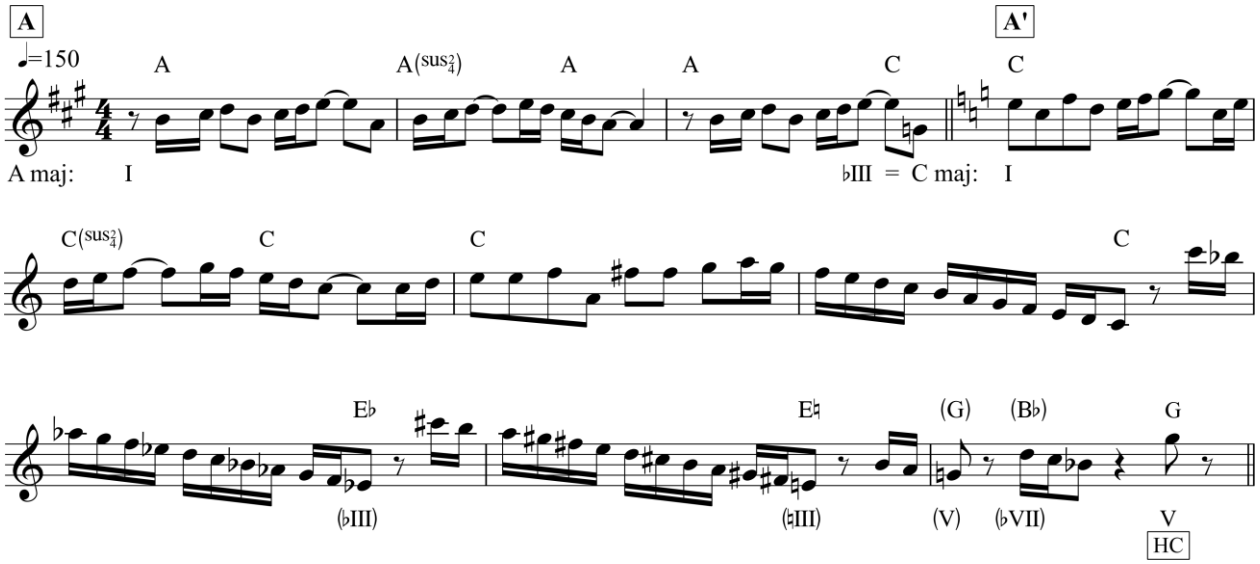
SLOW FORM
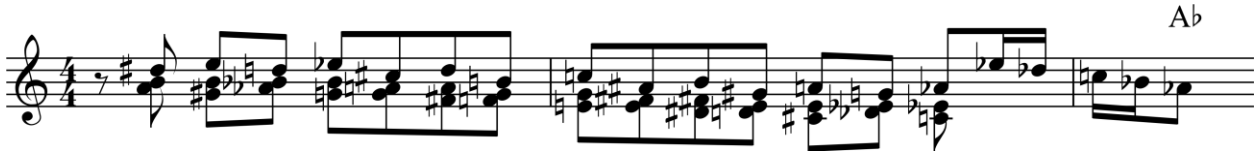


MUTT

Examples transcribed from KOTCS 5m39 and 8m59.
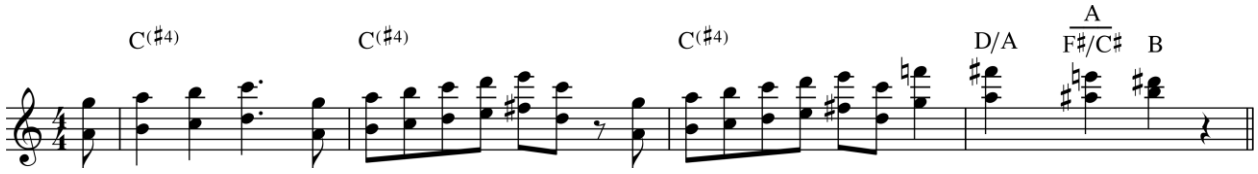
Minor theme from *KOTCS* Jungle Chase (5m39) accompanying Mutt Jones' (Shia Labouf) fencing fight. Notable for being expanded into concert piece (8m59 "Adventures of Mutt," later "Swashbucklers"). Theme suggests melodic & rhythmic deconstruction of **Raiders March A**. Supplemented by two auxiliary motifs; first also appearing in 2m19, the second restricted to concert arrangement.
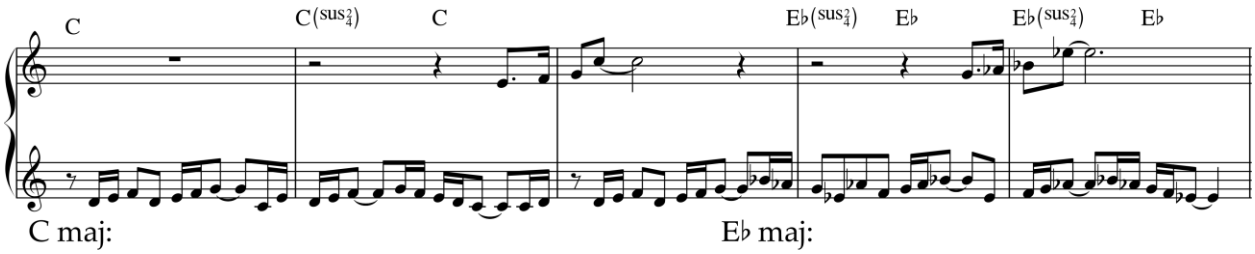


MUTT AUXILIARY MOTIF 1



MUTT AUXILIARY MOTIF 2
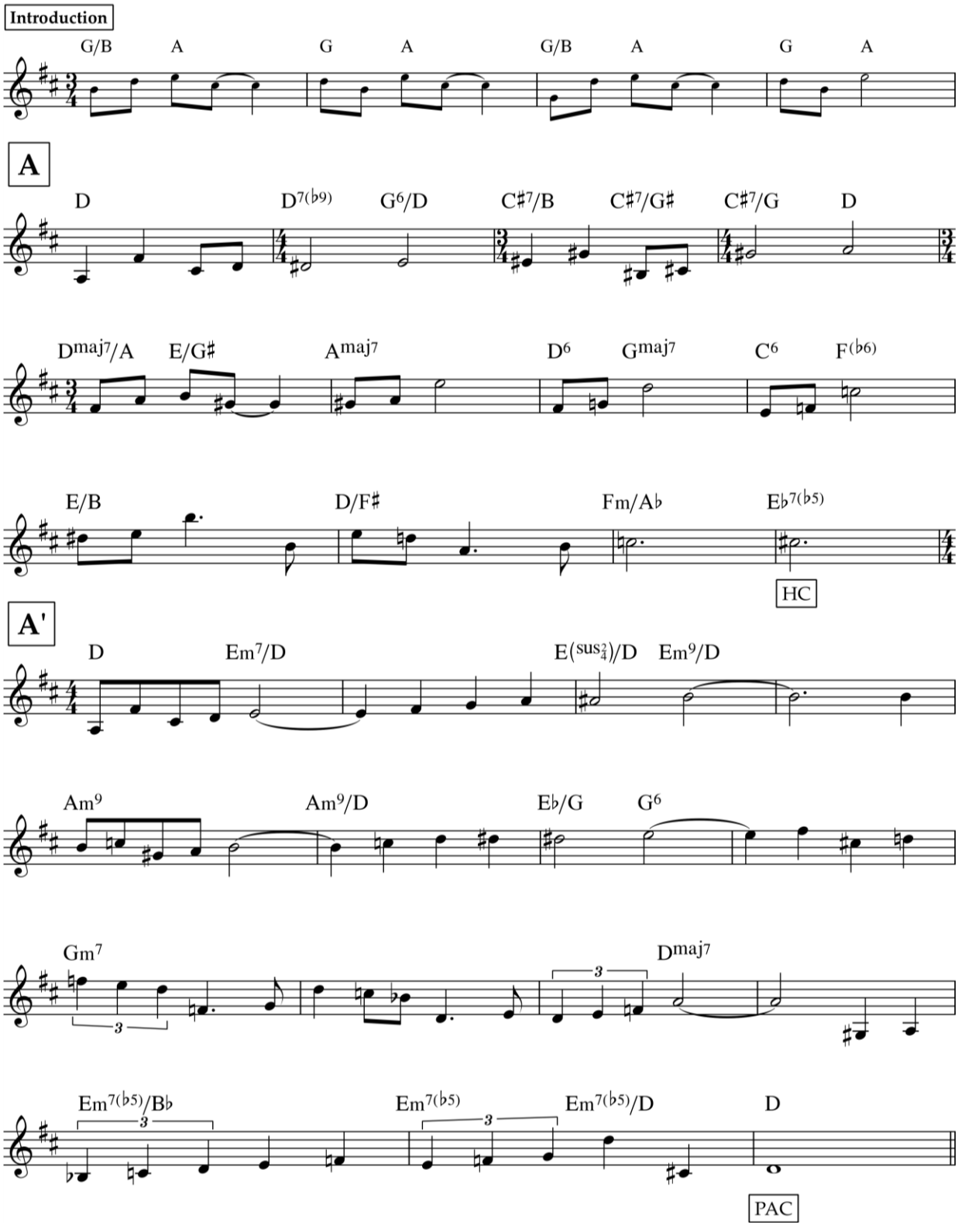


MUTT & INDY



HELENA
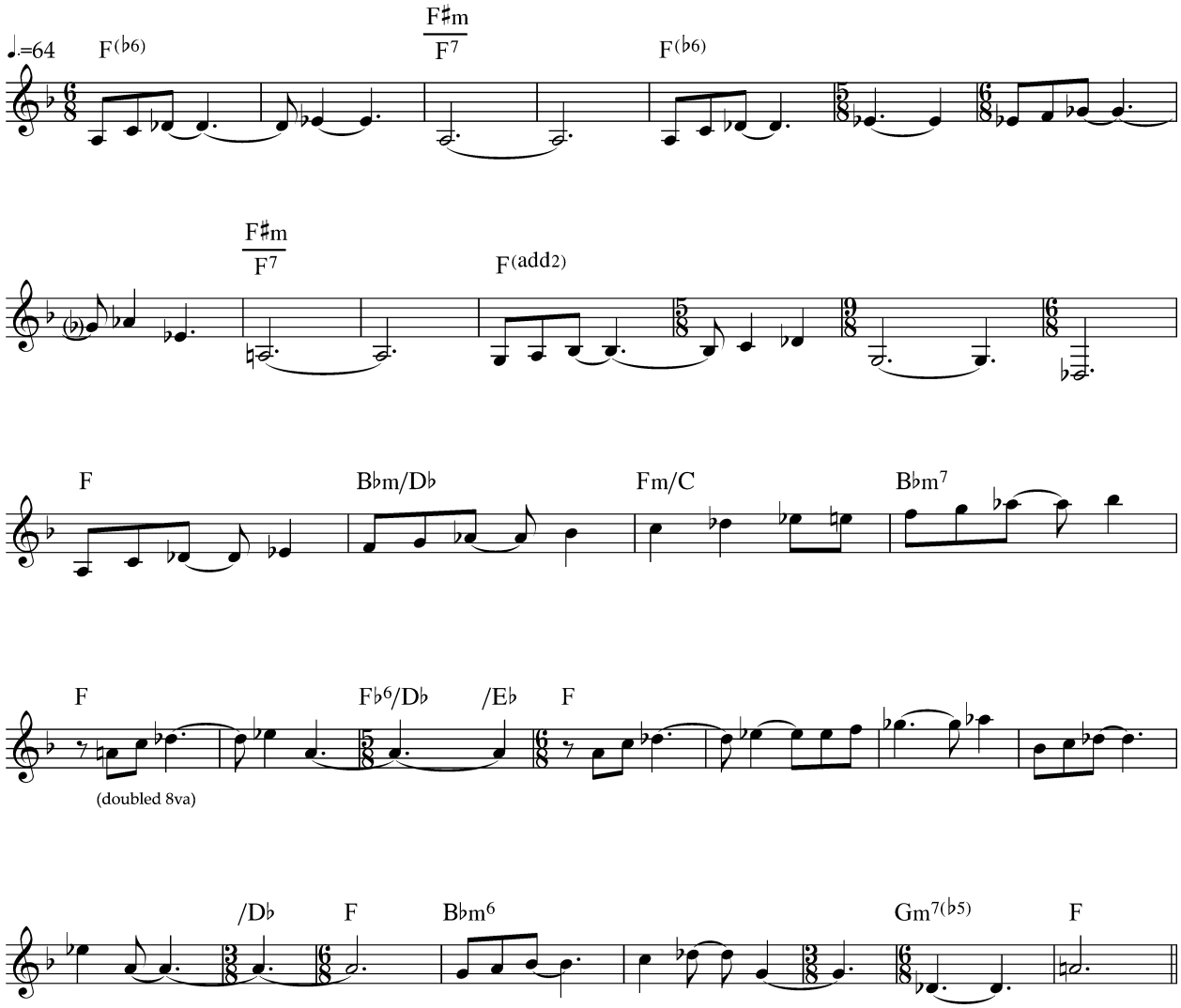
Transcribed from Hollywood Bowl performance 9/2/2022

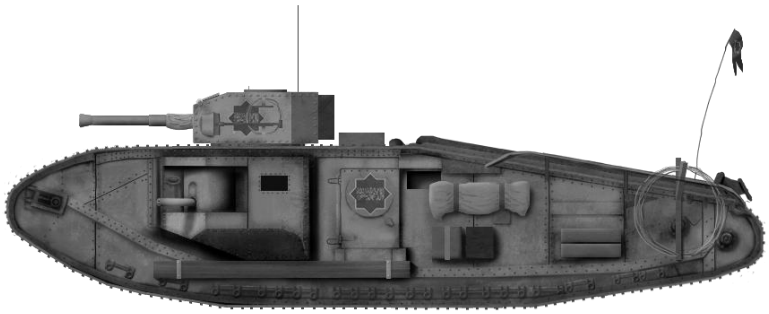
Major Theme for Indiana Jones's goddaughter, Helena (Phoebe Waller-Bridge), described by Williams as "an adventuress, also a femme-fatale, and many, many things," garnering "lyrical music like an old movie star." Most guises in-film much less overtly romantic, more sly or action-oriented. Several subcomponents and alternative forms of main melodic ideas.



ARCHIMEDES

Example transcribed from DOD "Prologue"





II. VILLAINS & HENCHMEN
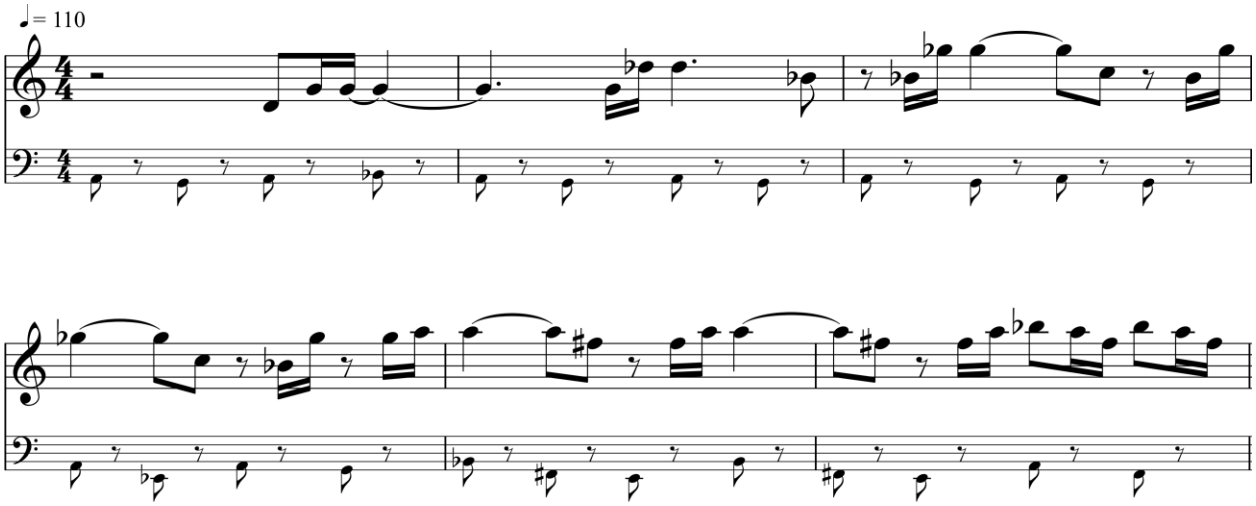
The antagonists in the Indiana Jones series are generally less strongly characterized compared to the heroes: only one specific character, Irina, has a theme for herself. The Nazis, villains in two of the four films, are depicted mostly through characteristic harmonies and textures in *Raiders*, though a relatively inconspicuous octatonic motif does accompany some of their deeds; a much memorable and prominent Nazi theme totally replaces this motif in *TLC*. The Thuggee cult in *TOD* and its figurehead Mola Ram, garner a cluster of themes (Temple of Doom chant, Pankot Palace, their derivatives). The Nazis in *DOD* are treated to a plethora of new themes and motifs; their individual musical tasks and differences are not always clearly articulated.

In *TOD*, *KOTCS* and *DOD*, the villain themes are "defeated" in a matter of speaking during their films' respective climactic cues. By comparison, the Nazi motifs in *ROTLA* and *TLC* do not play a major role in their movie's final acts, more or less being "used up" after their big truck/tank action set-pieces.

THE NAZIS – MOTIF

Example transcribed from ROTLA 9m1

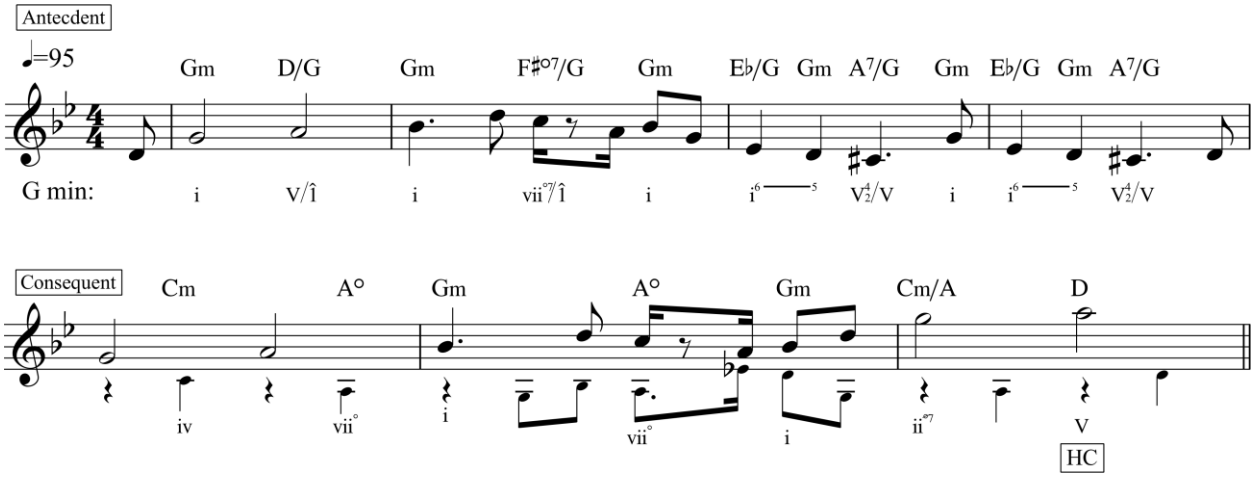
Minor theme from *ROTL* for the Nazis, octatonic construction. used in four cues: 6m3 (only hinted), 8m5 and 9m1, 10m6. An alternative, more rhythmic figure for Nazis appears in 6m5 and 10m5. Other characteristic but non-thematic material for Nazis in 3m3, 3m4/4m1, 7m1, etc.



THE NAZIS – THEME

Example transcribed from TLC 10m1

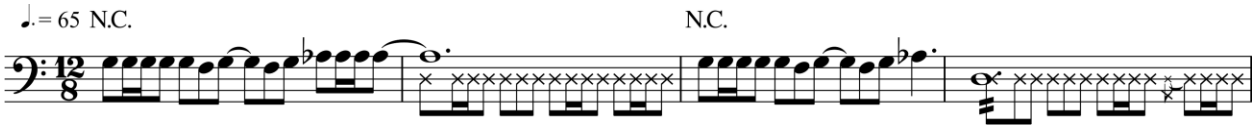
Major Theme. Prominent but relatively undeveloped new leitmotif for Nazi antagonists in *TLC*. Completely replaces Nazi motif from *ROTLA*. Invariably ends on a half-cadence.



GOONS

Example transcribed from ROTLA 6m2
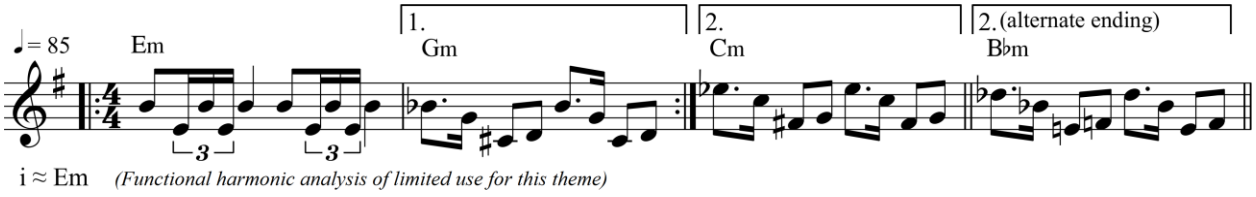
Extremely minor musical idea from *ROTL* 6m2 for the Nazis, but promoted to recurring 'goon' motif when reused, with modest expansion in *KOTCS* 1m5.



THE THUGGEES / PANKOT PALACE

Example distilled from TOD 4m3
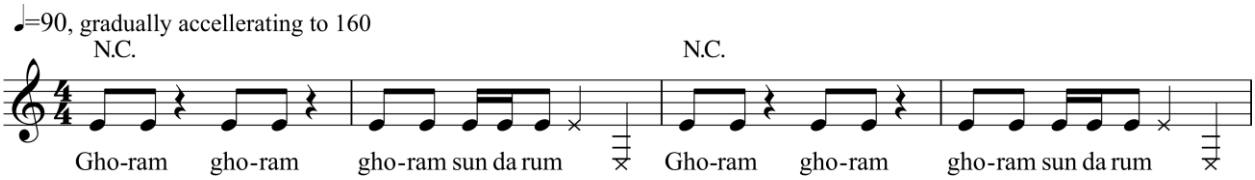
Minor but prominent and highly variable motif from *TOD* representing Pankot Palace and the Thuggee Cultists. Pantriadic. A handful of alternative endings. Motif from bar 2 detachable, heard in 10m4/11m1.



THE THUGEES / TEMPLE OF DOOM / MOLA RAM

Example transcribed from TOD 7m1
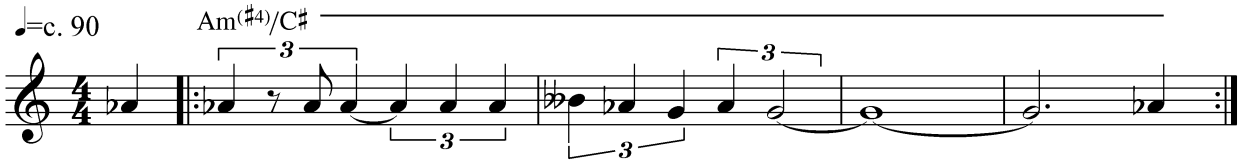
Quasi-diegetic Sanskrit chant associated with Mola Ram (Amrish Puri) and Thugee Cultists. Sample phrase shown below; actual chant more varied, multi-sectional, with complex percussion, vocal writing.



PANAMA HAT

Example transcribed from TLC 1m4/2m1

Minor and easily missed motif from TLC representing tertiary antagonist "Panama Hat."

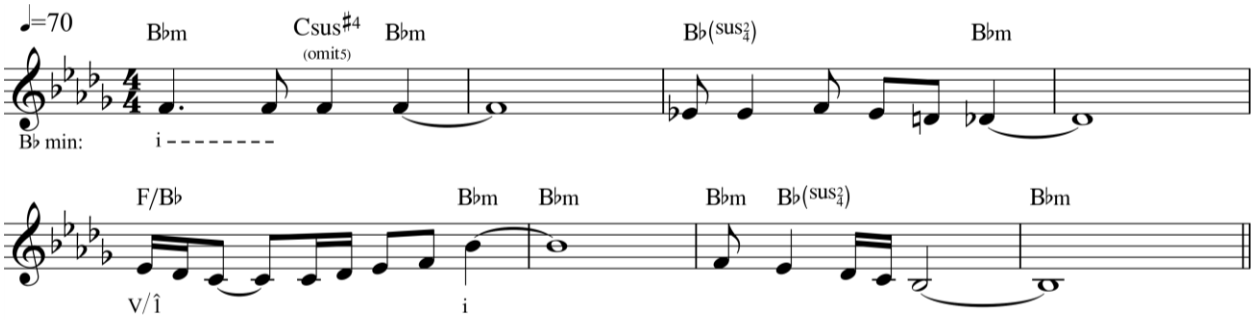


THE RUSSIANS

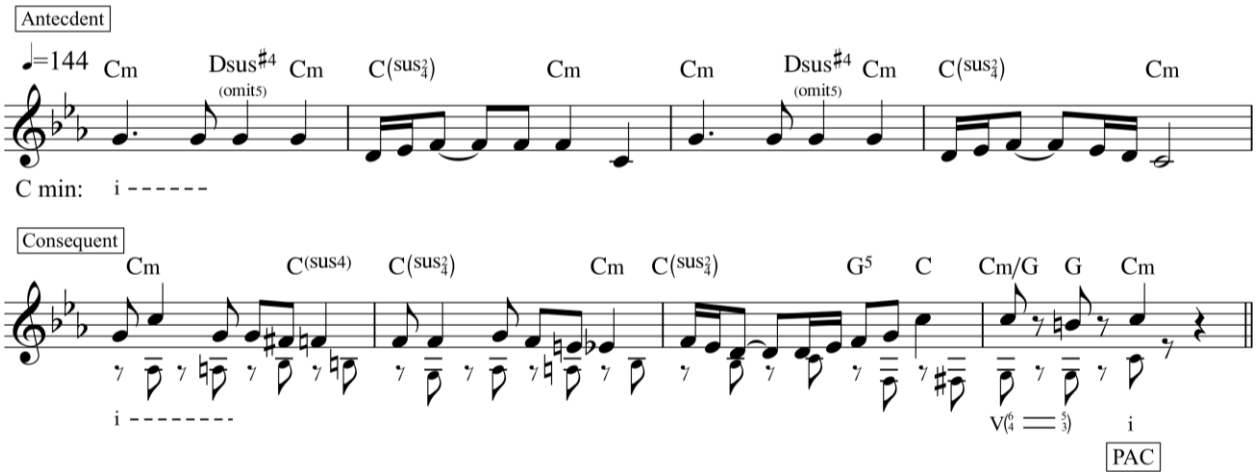
Examples transcribed from KOTCS 1m3 and 5m38.

Major theme. Tuneful, vaguely Slavic sounding theme for Russian antagonists in *KOTCS*, and primary heavy Dovchenko in particular. Occurs in both slow, ominous and fast, more energetic forms. Extended treatment in End Credits comes with substantial quasi-cadenza passage (no pictured) for clarinet and accordion. An additional, more Shostakovichian musical idea, totally unconnected to the main leitmotif, is used solely at the beginning of the film (1m3) in conjunction with Soviet incursion into Area 51.

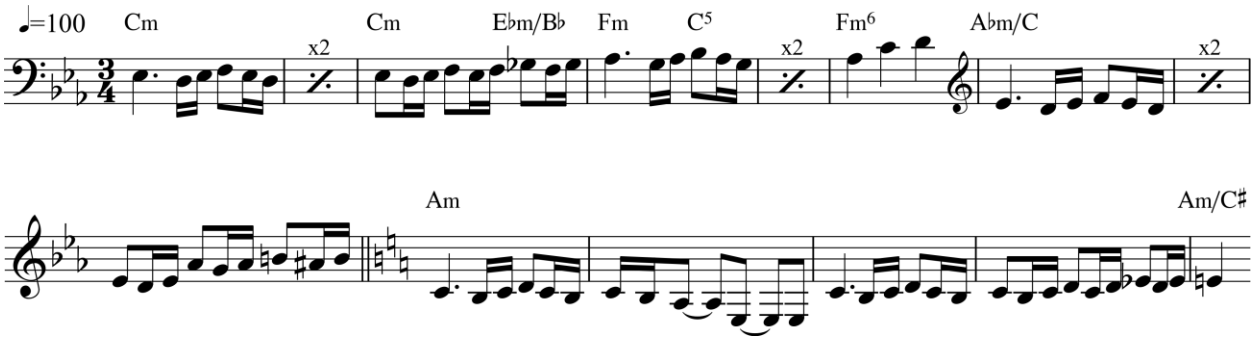
SLOW FORM



FAST FORM
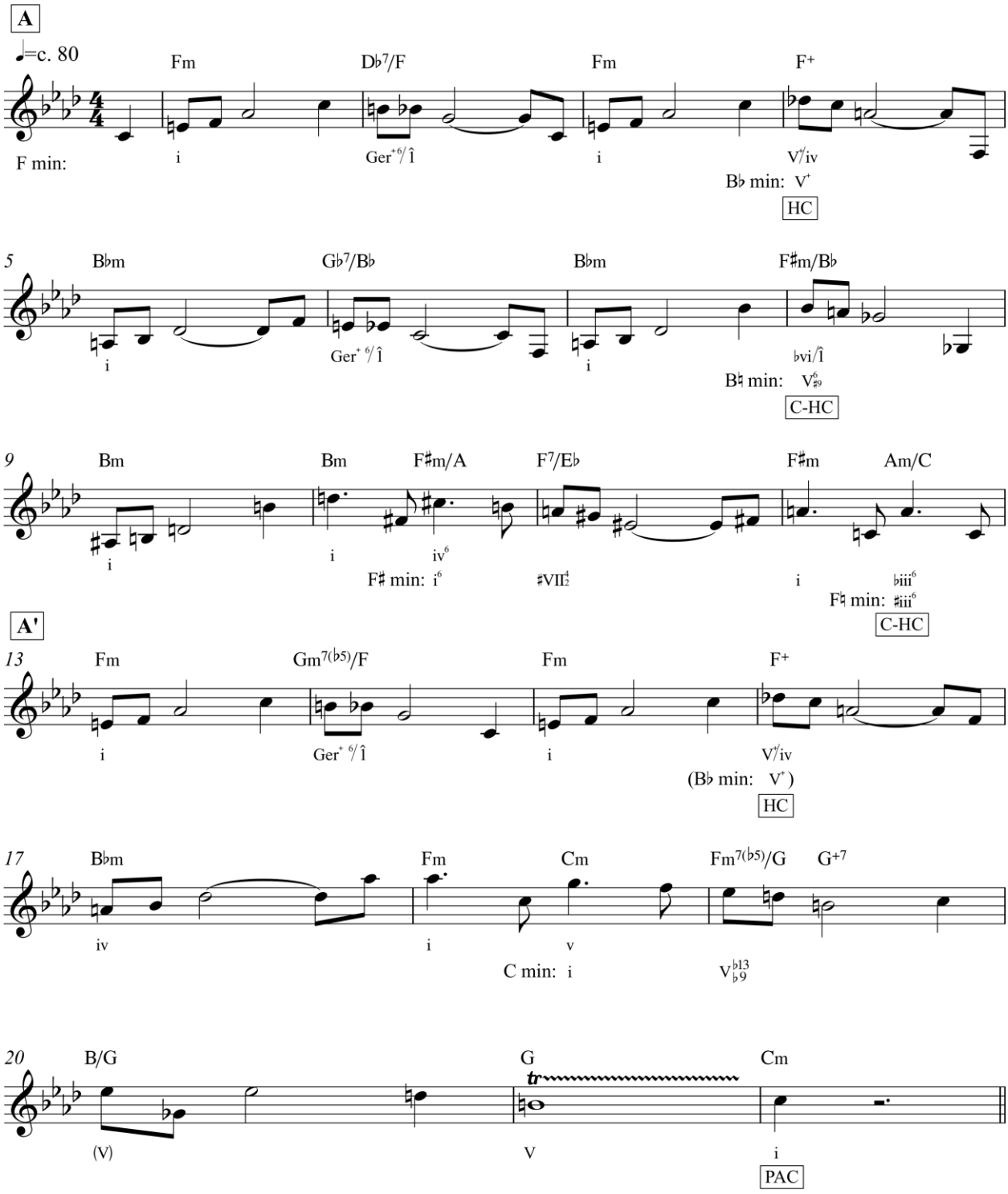


RUSSIAN INCURSION



IRINA

Example transcribed from KOTCS "Irina's Theme"

Major theme. Noirish melody for primary villain Irina Spalko (Cate Blanchett). Prone to internal chromatic modulations; full 22 measure melody only heard in End Credits and concert arrangement; most uses in film involve just first two or four measures. See Conor Power (2022) "Swordsmen and Femme Fatale" for a more in depth exploration.
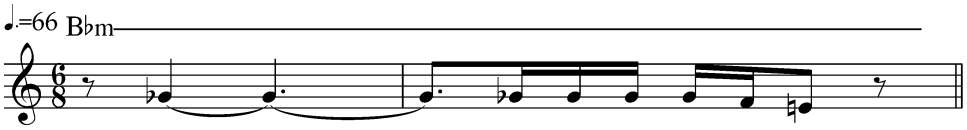


VOLLER AND THE NAZIS

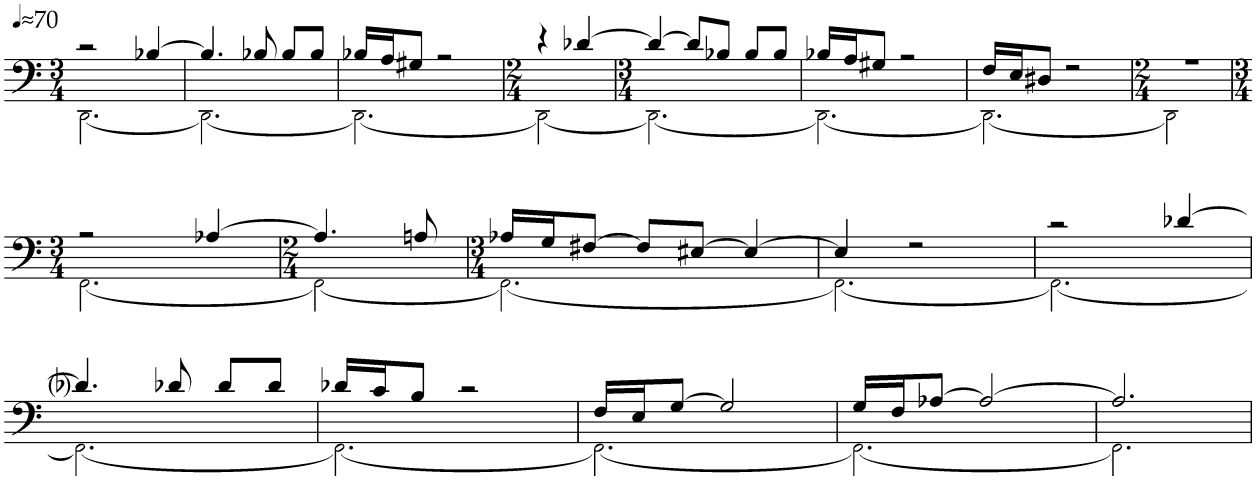
Examples transcribed from DOD "Prologue," "The Airport"

Major theme cluster. Set of motifs, submotifs, and sub-submotifs, all connected to antagonists of *Dial of Destiny*, led by secret (and eventually not-so-secret) Nazi Jürgen Voller (Mads Mikkelsen). **Voller** has his own motif, **Bad Guys A**, derived from the descending chromatic figure at the end of **Bad Guys 2**. The most extended idea, **Bad Guys B**, **Melody**, has two guises, enough to suggest a single underlying theme from different angles. The former has a balanced two-phrase structure with light melodic similarities to TLC's Nazi Theme—namely ♭$\hat{6}$-$\hat{5}$-♯$\hat{4}$ cell, which is as often heard as an autonomous motif. **Bad Guys 3**, **Exotic and Furtive**, has a devious quality and could be confused with a MacGuffin or Locale theme. The chorale-like **Bad Guys 4 Anthem** firmly connected with the Nazis when they're "out in the open."

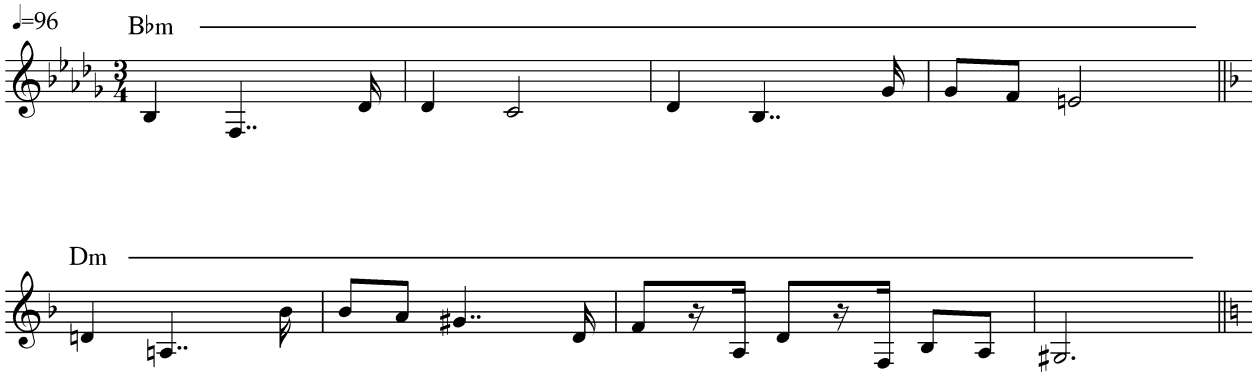
BAD GUYS A: VOLLER (SHORT)



BAD GUYS B: VOLLER (LONG)

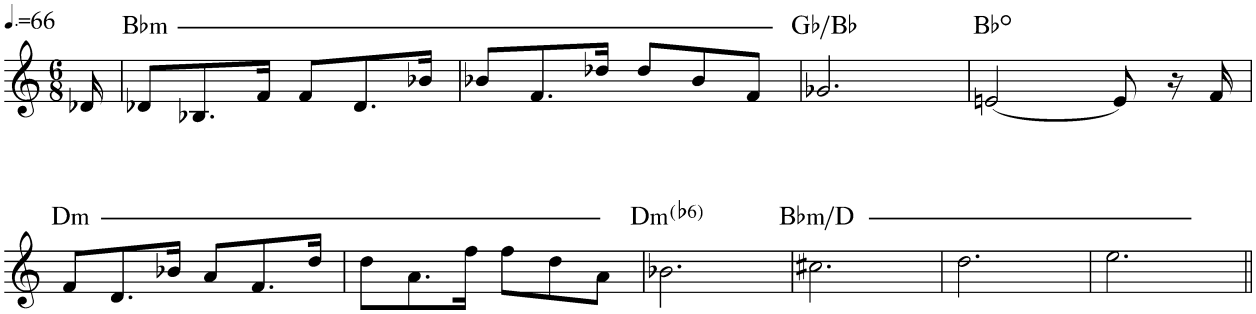


BAD GUYS B: MELODY (FORM 1)

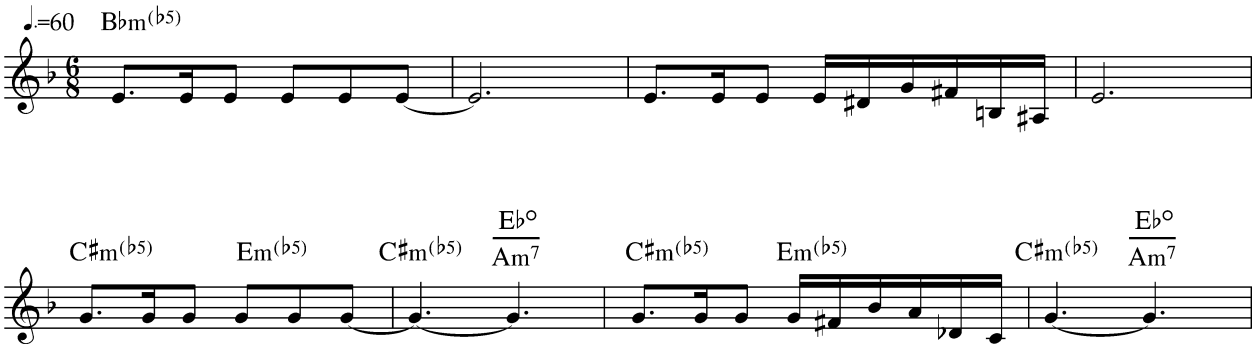


VOLLER AND THE NAZIS CONT.

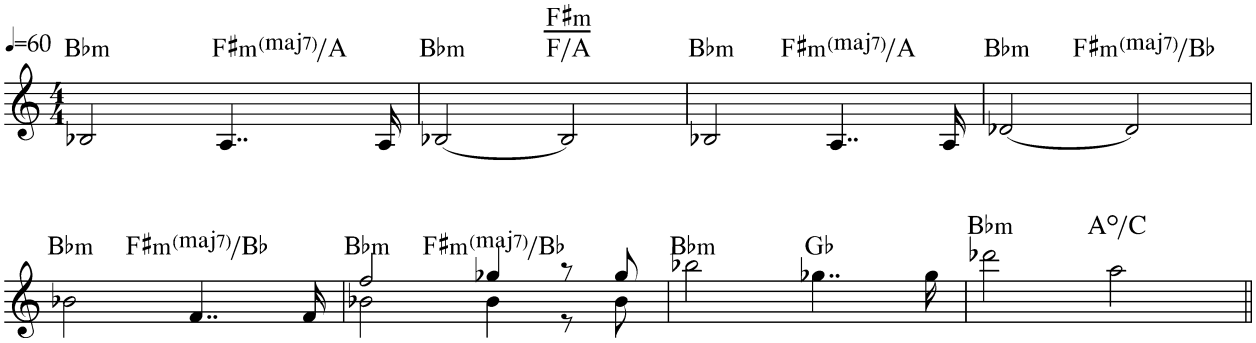
BAD GUYS B: MELODY (FORM 2)



BAD GUYS C: SCHEMING AND FURTIVE



BAD GUYS D: ANTHEM





MacGuffins & Artifacts

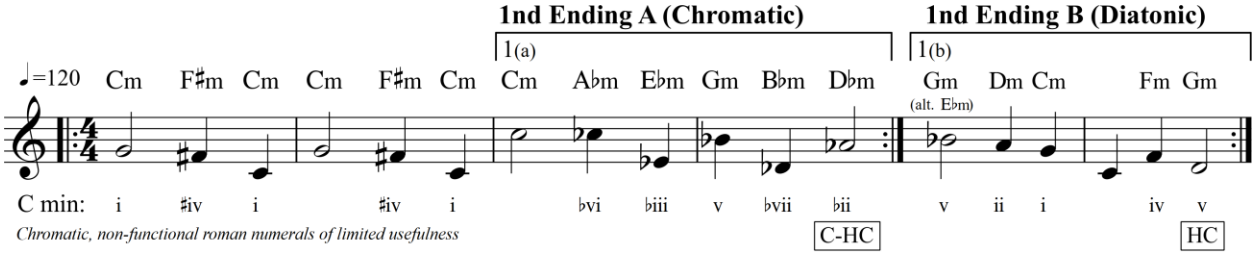
Themes for the artifacts sought by Indy and allies are among the most important musical elements of each *Indiana Jones* score. The mysterious object around which a given film's narrative primarily revolves ("MacGuffin") is always strongly characterized by a recurring theme, and secondary MacGuffins often garner their own signature tunes (e.g. The Medallion, Cross of Coronado). These themes suggest the character of their respective totems through a variety of musical means, often antique or bizarre harmony, exotic melodic contours, and marked orchestration. The Sankara Stones in *TOD* are unusual in being initially assigned a striking leitmotif whose presence in the score essentially disappears after a big central statement, its symbolic task subsequently reassigned to the more versatile The March of the Slave Children.

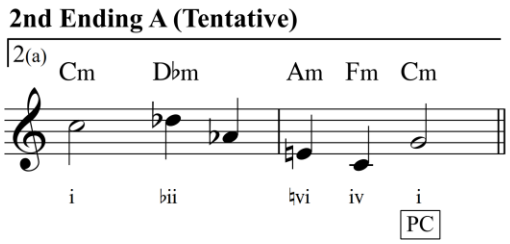
MacGuffin themes tend to be heavily chromatic and tonally nonfunctional—markers in Williams's style, and much Hollywood music besides for otherworldliness and sublimity. The completely atonal Crystal Skull theme(s) from *KOTCS* is the most strikingly opposed to the norms of functional diatonicism and centric tonality. MacGuffin themes invariably undergo some kind of musical development, beginning with a tentative or suggestive initial statement, and eventually leading to a true musical apotheosis in the films' climax, during which the melody is presented in its most prominent and fully-realized form.

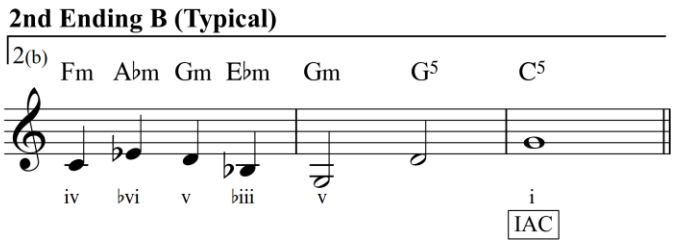
THE ARK OF THE COVENANT

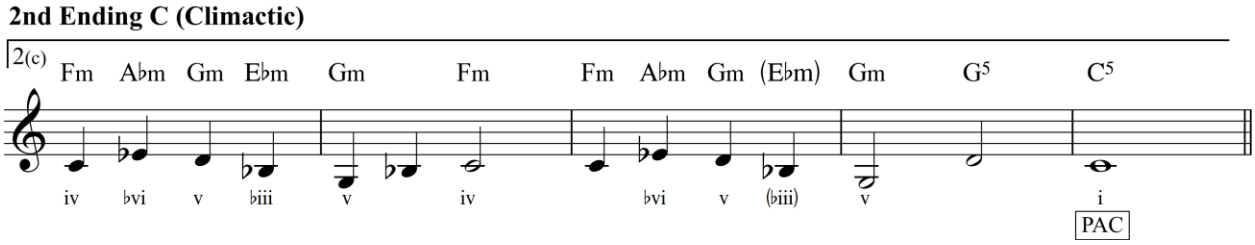
Example condensed from 3m1 (Ending 1a), 3m3 (Ending 1b), 6m2 (Endings 2b, 2c)

Major theme. Leitmotif for Ark of the Covenant and the awesome power contained within. Thoroughly chromatic, emphasizing non-diatonic root relationships, oscillations between minor triads, archaic cadences. Several possible continuations after first two measures, use depends largely on degree of finality needed. Briefly quoted in *TLC* (4m22) and revived, with some variation in *KOTCS* (1m5, 2m8). Often coupled with triplet arpeggios. Apotheosis section from "Map Room: Dawn" (6m2) also depicted.

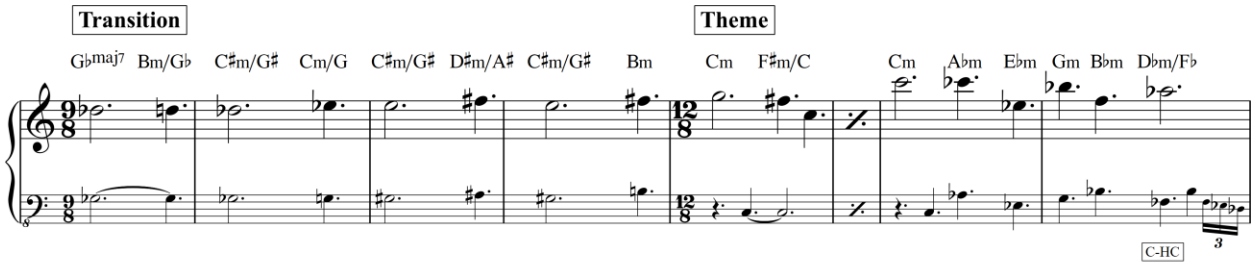


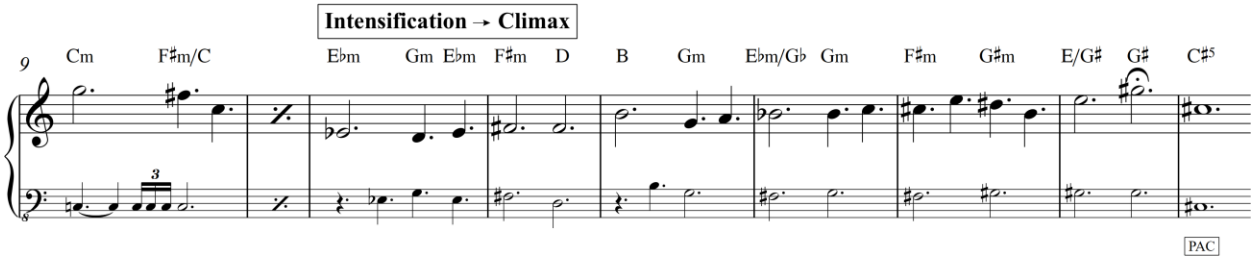






APOTHEOSIS

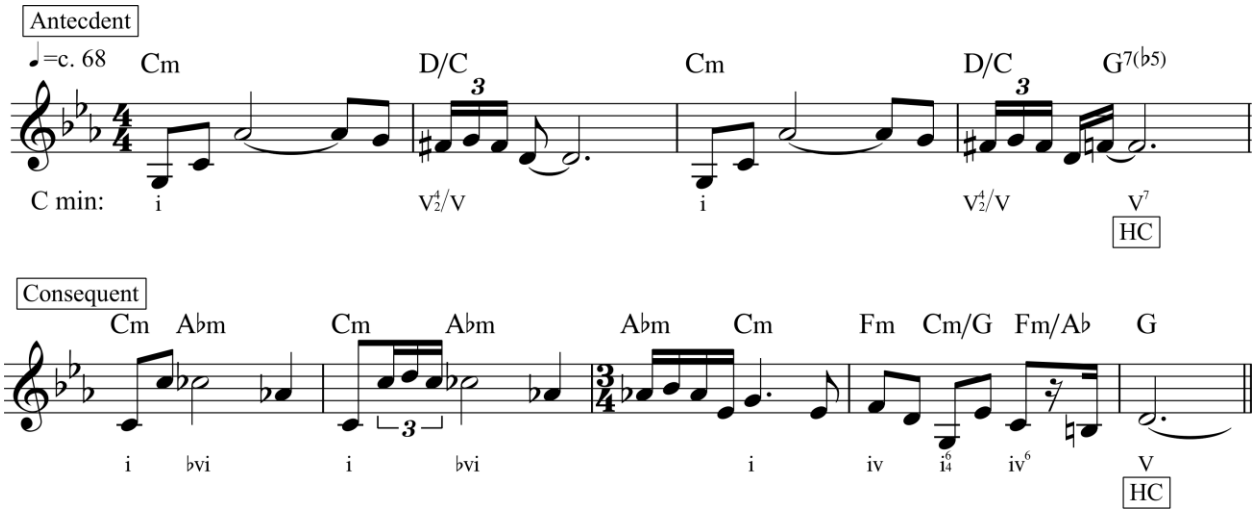




THE MEDALLION

Example transcribed from 3m4/4m1
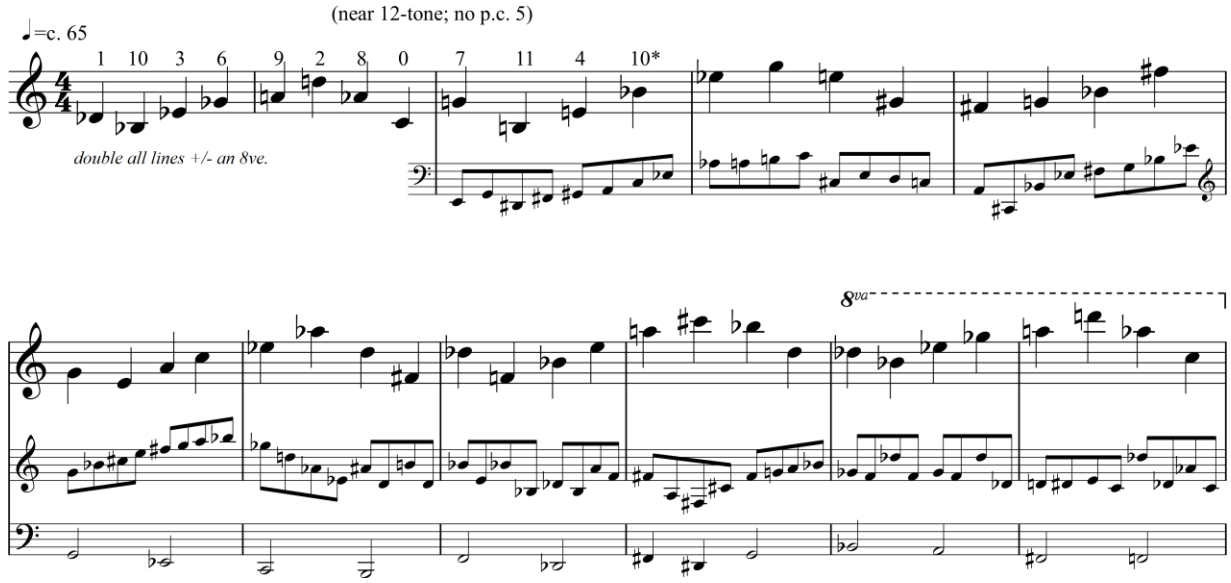
Minor but distinctive theme from *ROTLA* for the Ravenwood family Medallion; opening intervallic leaps (P4, m6) particularly characteristic. Strongly affiliated with Ark Theme in harmony and melodic structure; consequent phrase (mm. 5-9) even used as melodic continuation for Ark in 11m1.



THE IDOL

Example transcribed from ROTLA 1m2
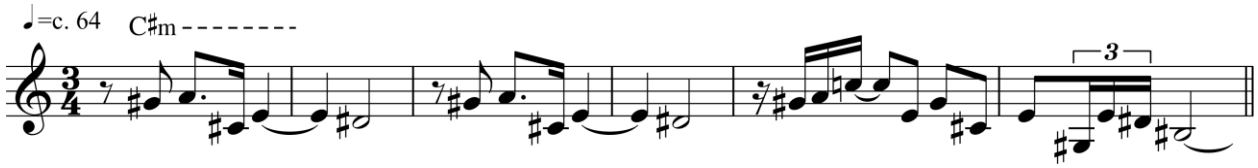
Minor theme from *ROTLA* accompanying Jones's careful approach of golden fertility idol, later cited during Map Room sequence. Arching melody its snaking accompaniment extremely chromatic, non-triadic in construction, with constantly shifting sense of key. Main melody nearly a twelve-tone row.



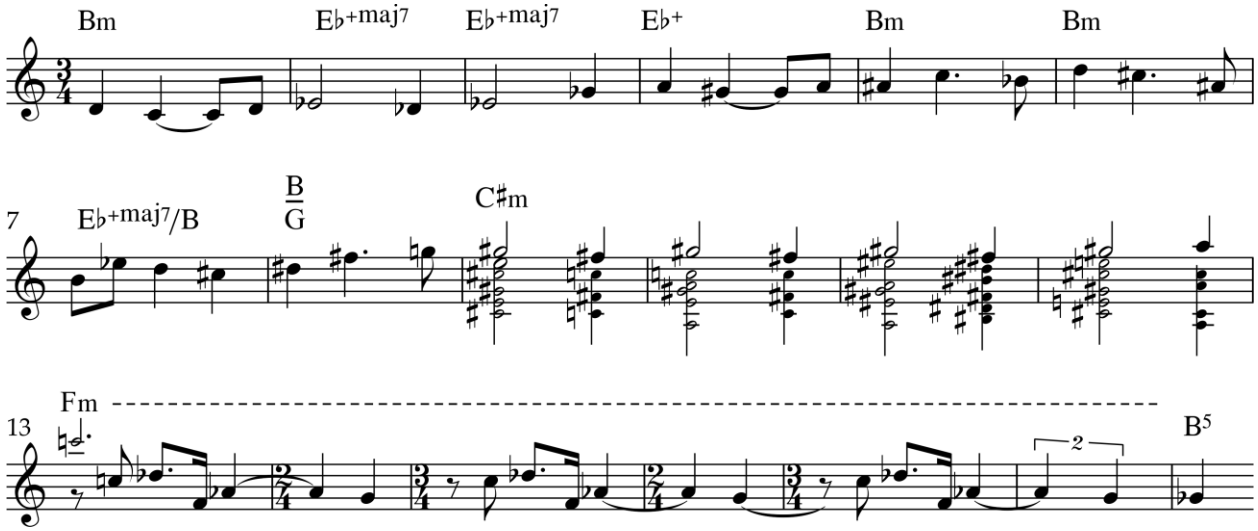
THE SANKARA STONES

Example transcribed from TOD 4m2
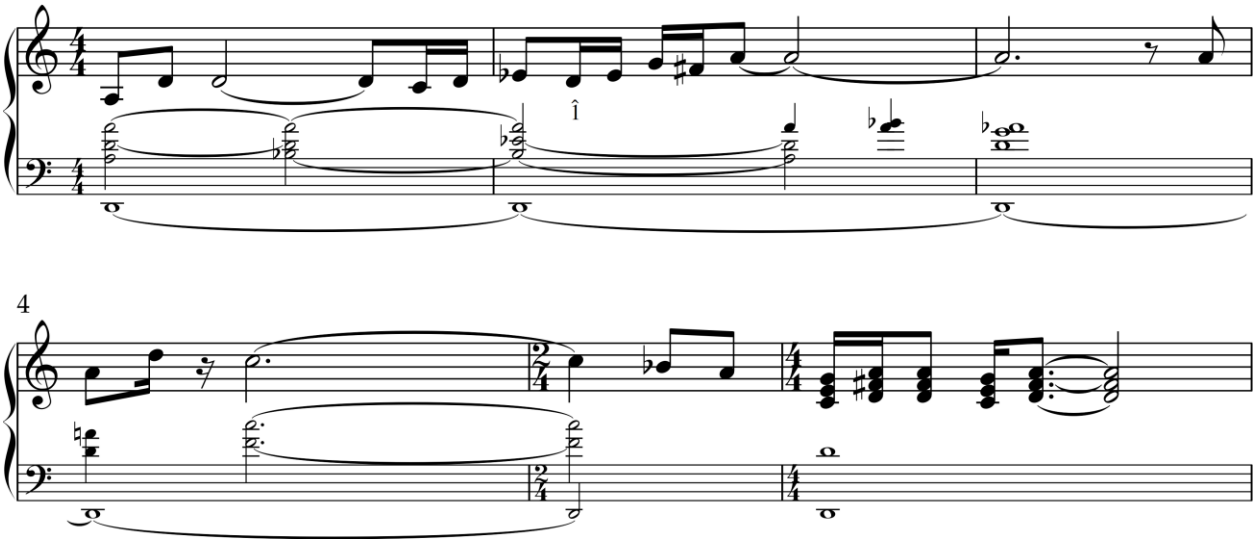
Minor but striking, exotic theme for Sankara stones*;* essentially supplanted by March of Slave Children after 7m3. Anticipates Kylo Ren's motif. Thematic apotheosis follows lengthy choral build-up in 7m3. Also pictured: apotheosis of March of the Slave Children in 11m4/11m5, at which point that leitmotif has fully taken on task of musically characterizing the Sankara Stones.



APOTHEOSIS 1: SANKARA STONES MOTIF



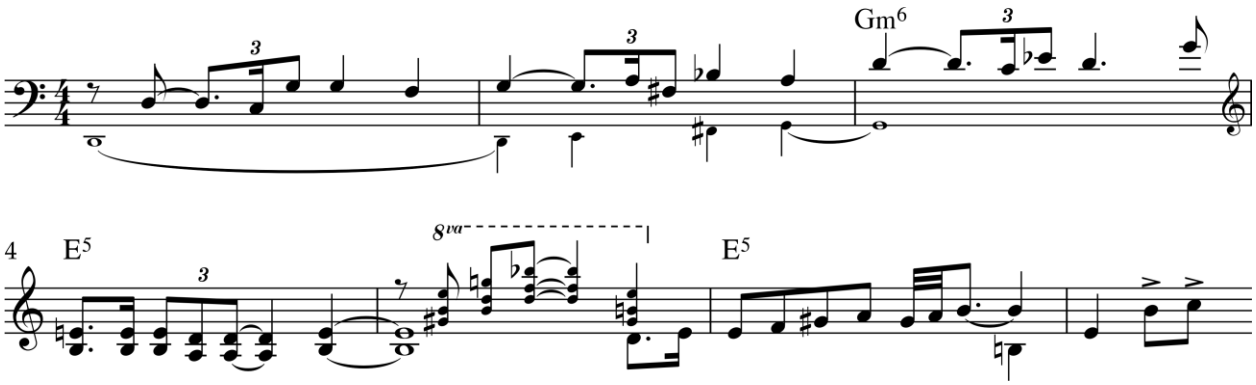
APOTHEOSIS 2: MARCH OF THE SLAVE CHILDREN



NURHACI

Example transcribed from TOD 1m5

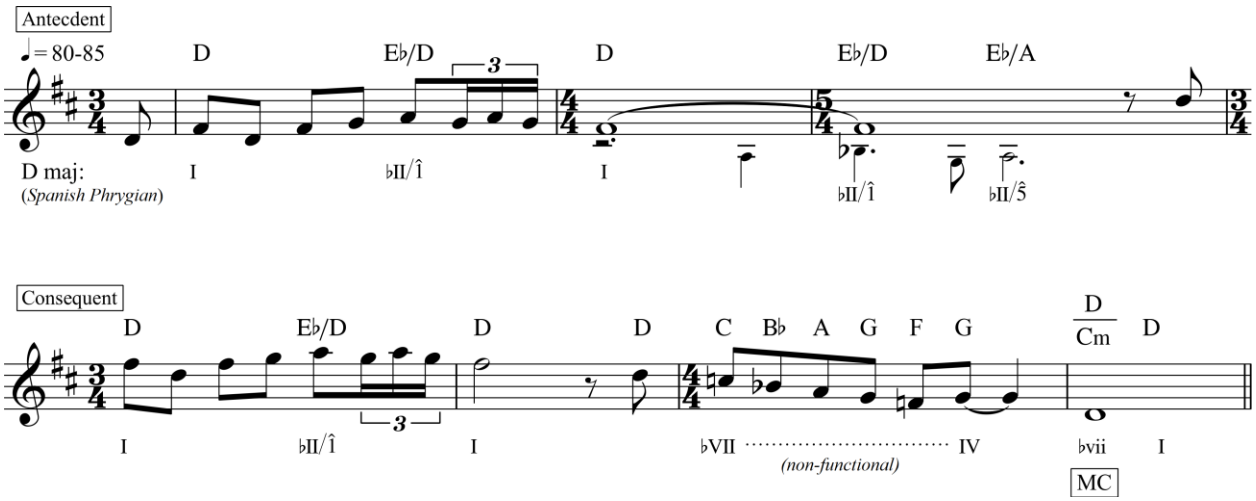
One-off musical characterization of remains of Emperor Nurhachi in *TOD* – strictly *not thematic*.



THE CROSS OF CORONADO

Example transcribed from TLC 1m2 or 1m3 (?)
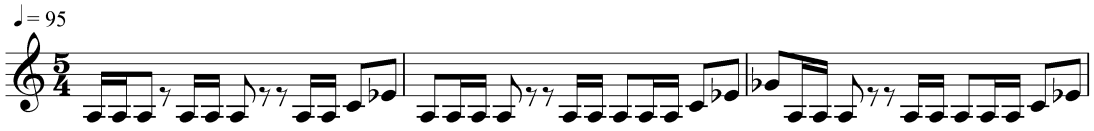
Minor but characteristic theme for Coronado's Cross in prologue of *TLC*; conspicuous musical "Spanish tinge."



TOMB RAIDING

Example transcribed from ROTLA 1m2

Minor motif from *ROTLA* used in Idol temple scene and later developed in Well of Souls sequence.

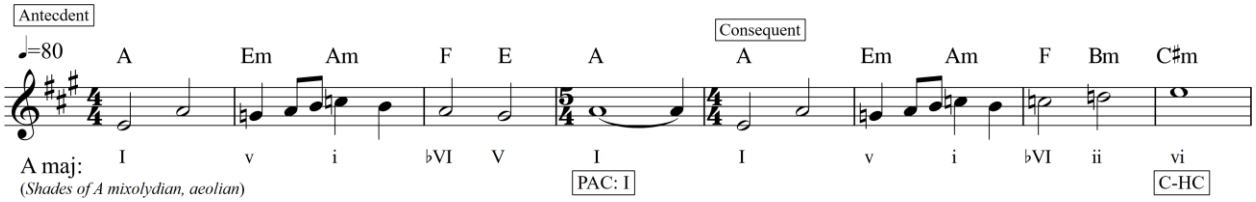


THE HOLY GRAIL

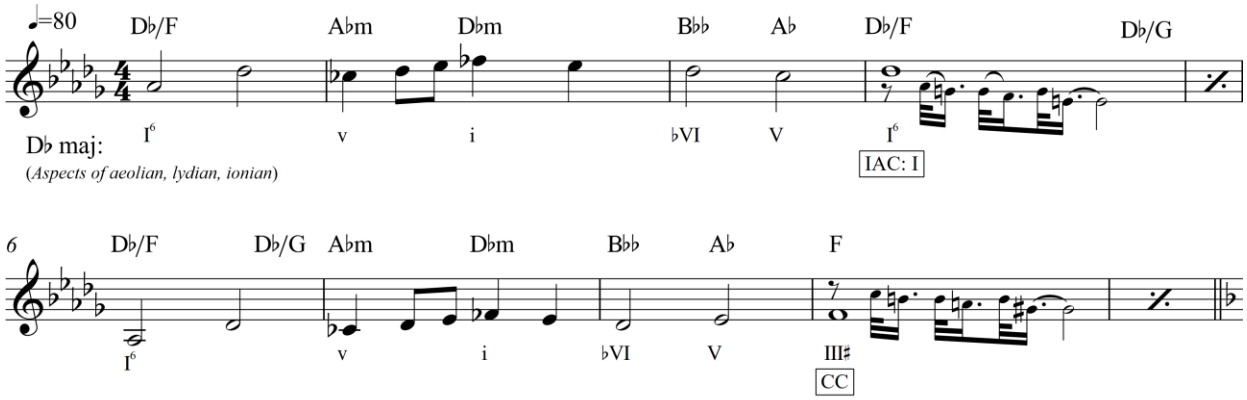
Examples transcribed from TLC 3m2a, 3m3, 8m7, 11m4, 13m3

Major theme. Leitmotif for the Holy Grail and its powers in *TLC*. Notable for its modal flexibility, both across variations and within individual variations. Marked by strong, ecclesiastical-sounding cadences, which sometimes proceed in unexpected order or to surprising tonal destinations. Given the number of differences across variations in terms of harmonic/modal orientation, several versions depicted below.

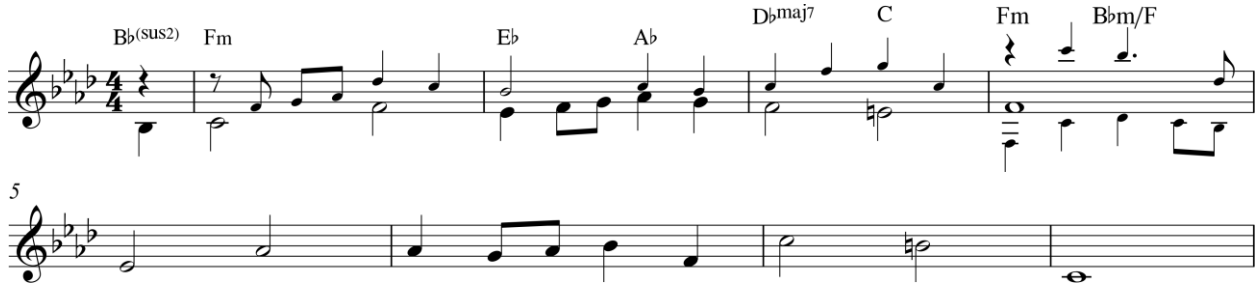
PRELIMNARY VERSION



MYSTERIOUS VERSION
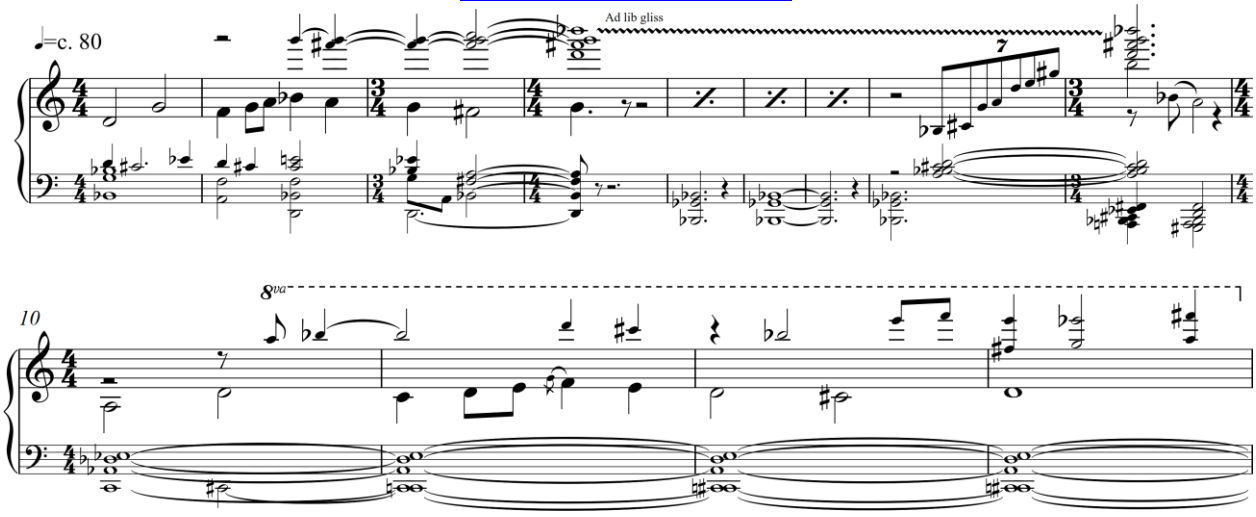


SUBTLE VERSION (CHORALE)
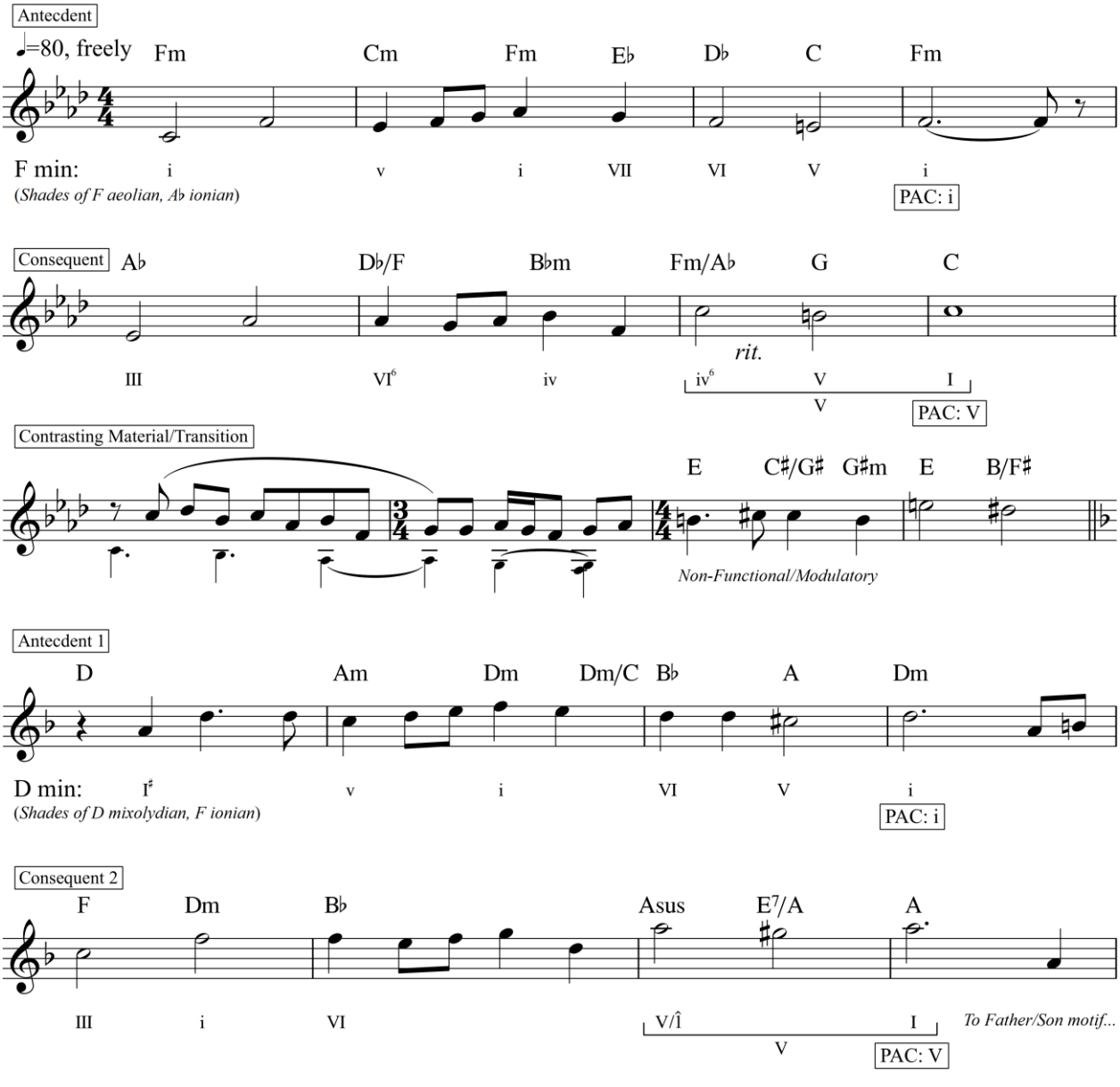


The Holy Grail Cont.

Dissonant Version



Apotheosis

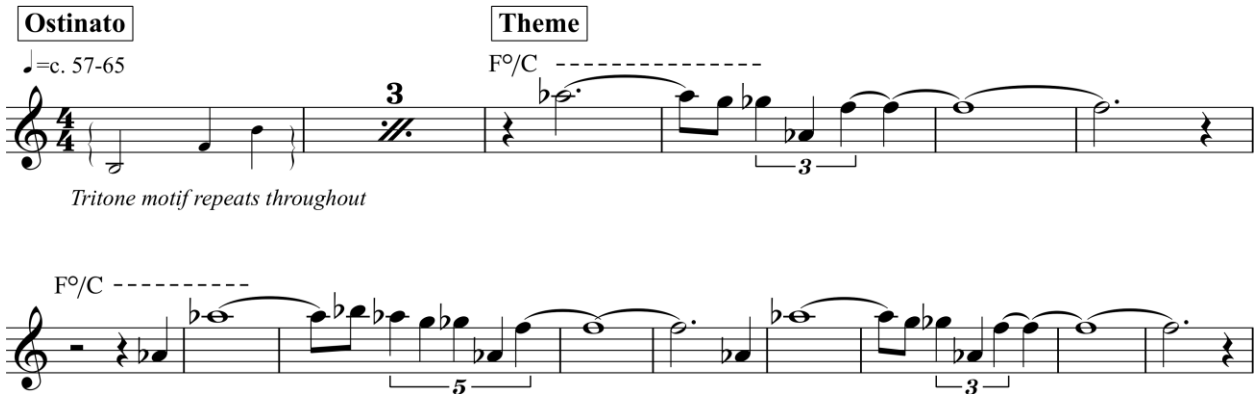


THE CRYSTAL SKULL
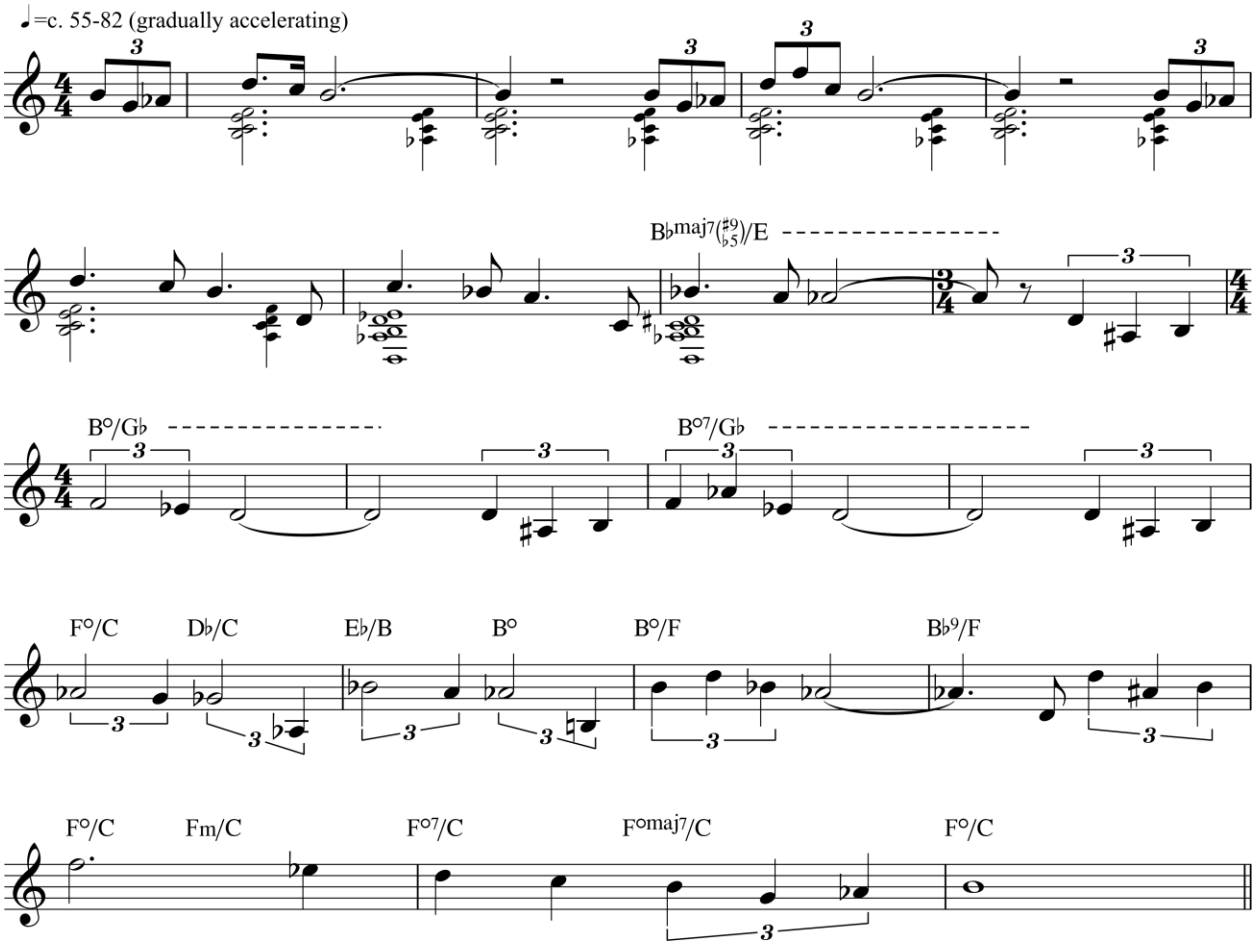
Examples transcribed from KOTCS

Major theme. Leitmotif for the Crystal Skull and its powers in *TLC*. Two distinct sub-components, six-note **A motif** and repetitions, and more mysterious, tuneful **B Theme**. Only the former used extensively. Sole MacGuffin theme to be essentially **atonal** in harmonic structure, though does express referential pitch or interval-centers to varying extent.

CRYSTAL SKULL THEME A



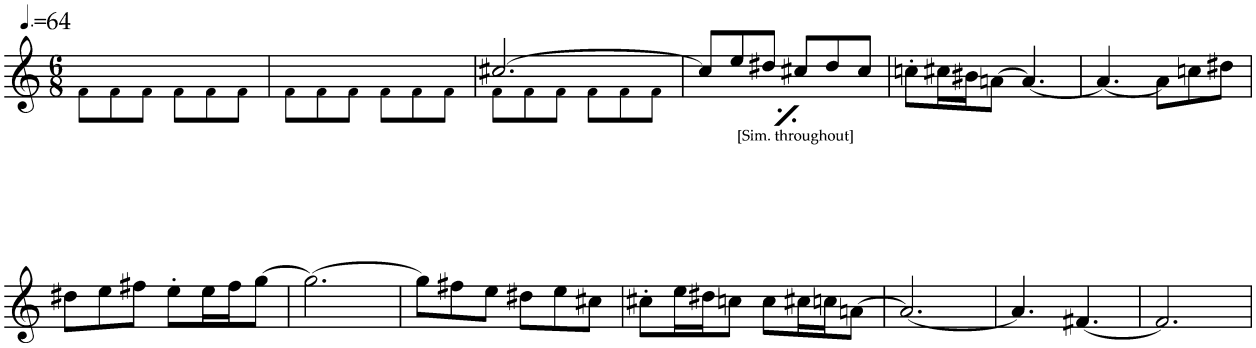
CRYSTAL SKULL THEME B



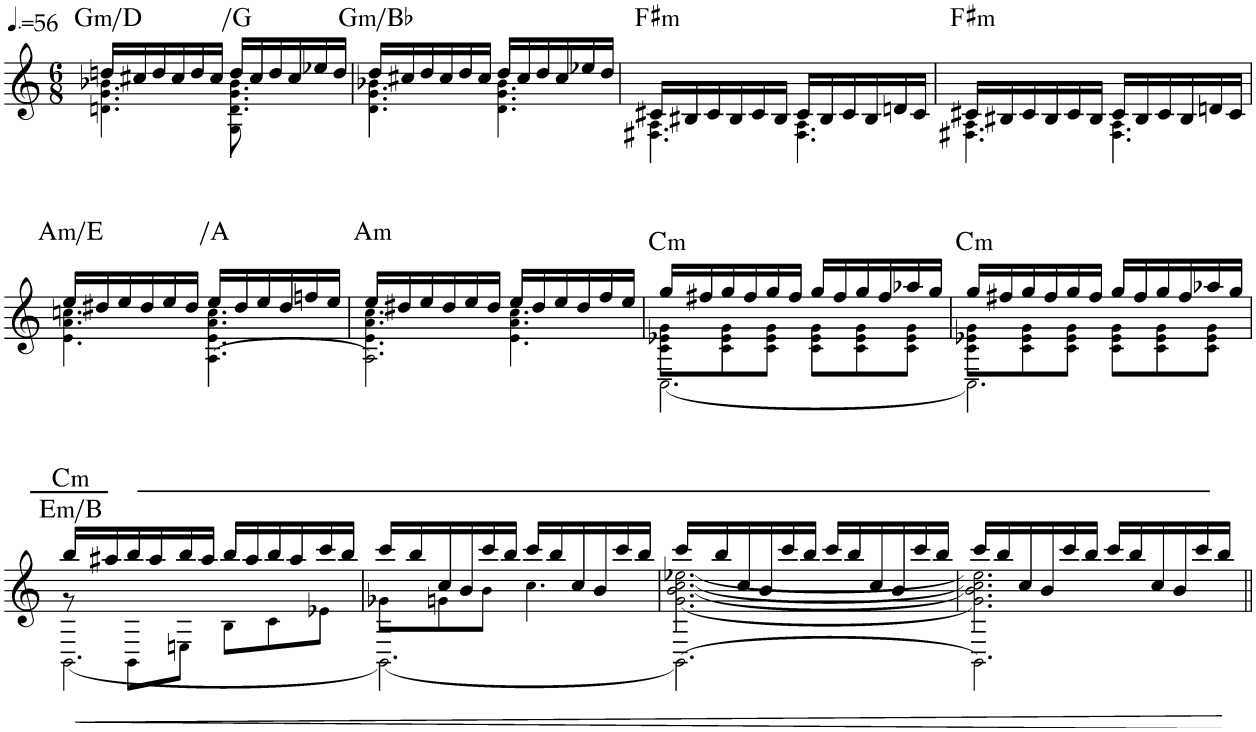
THE ANTIKYTHERA

Example transcribed from DOD "Prologue"
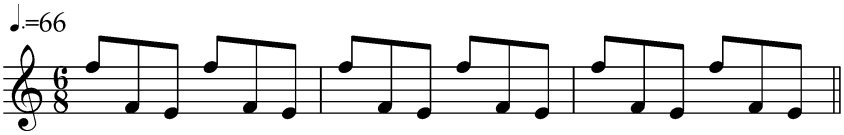
DIAL THEME A: MELODIC



DIAL THEME B_1: TEXTURAL/HARMONIC

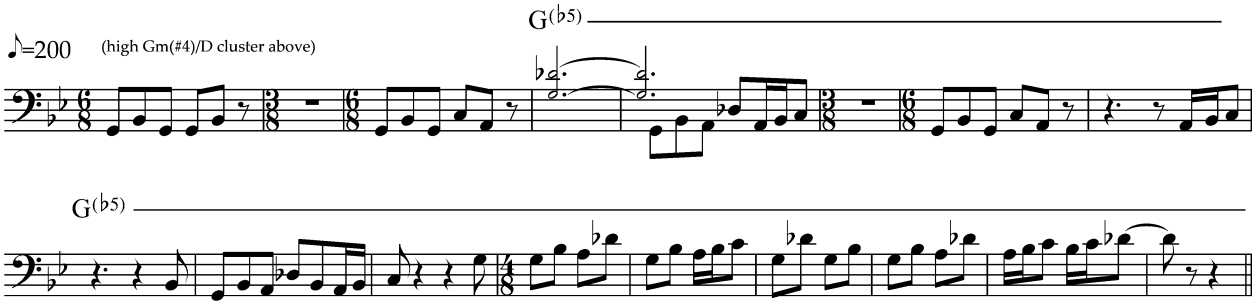


DIAL THEME B_2: PIANO MOTIF



BATTLE OF SYRACUSE

Example transcribed from DOD "Syracuse"





IV. CHASES, FIGHTS, & ESCAPES

Much of the most memorable and compositionally impressive music in the series stems from the action sequences that populate each film. Indy's exciting set-pieces revolve around three narrative-musical archetypes: a chase in which the hero is pursuing something, an escape in which the hero is themselves being pursued, or a fight where the hero is actively engaged in combat. Many *Indiana Jones* set-pieces move between or combine these archetypes.

With a few exceptions, the original themes and motifs for these sequences are restricted to singleton cues or cue-complexes, where they chart the protagonists' death-defying adventures in alternation with various leitmotifs and more thematically unmarked tension music or mickey-mousing. Despite routinely featuring the intricate orchestration and virtuosic demand on their performers, action cues in this series are seldom audible in their full detail within their respective scenes, being in constant competition with explosive sound effects.

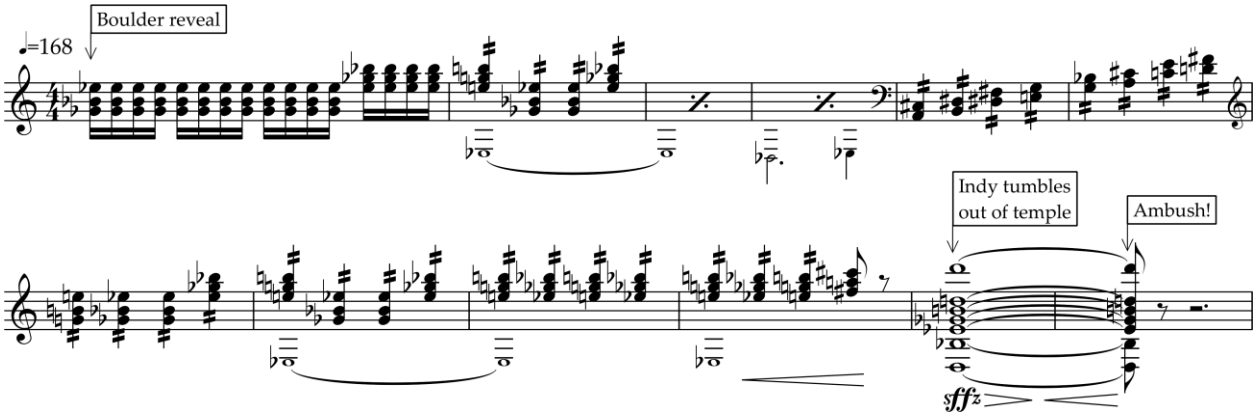
The musical material that comprises **Scherzo for Motorcycle and Orchestra** from *Last Crusade* is unique in its properly leitmotivic status, occurring in substantial and extensive form across three distinct cues in *The Last Crusade*. Aspects of **The Adventures of Mutt** from *Crystal Skull*, whose main motivic components are included in the HEROES AND SIDEKICKS section of this catalogue, occur in several discrete cues; however, only in "The Jungle Chase" (5m38 through 5m40) are they clearly articulated as thematic *per-se*. A few smaller passages are recalled across multiple films, including a sight-gag in *Temple of Doom* (11m2) repurposed from *Raiders*' 4m5/5m1.

A substantially amount of *The Dial of Destiny*'s action music is reworked directly or modeled on cues from earlier entries in the franchise (as well as *Minority Report, War of the Worlds,* and *The Adventures of Tin Tin*); these references are not currently noted.

The examples catalogued below showcase cue-defining passages of selected action cues—not just recurring themes but prominent ostinati and, in a few cases, iconic but basically athematic gestural segments. An attempt is made to convey as much notational information as possible, though given the sometimes extravagant level of orchestrational and contrapuntal & rhythmic complexity at play, **detail is necessarily compromised in favor of clarity** for some reductions.

THE ROLLING BALL (RAIDERS)
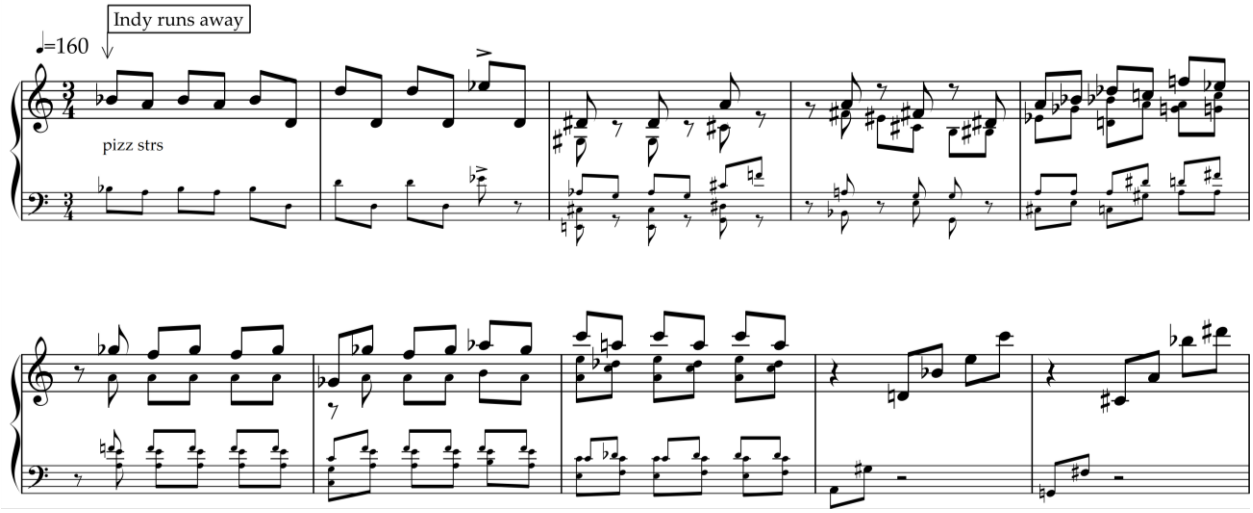
Example transcribed from ROTLA 1m3
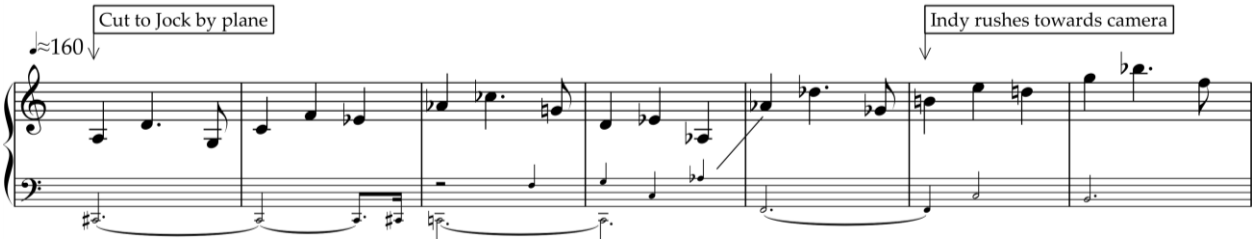


FLIGHT TO FREEDOM (RAIDERS)

Examples transcribed from ROTLA 2m2

PERUVIAN PIZZICATO POLKA



JOCK'S ANGLING INTERLUDE

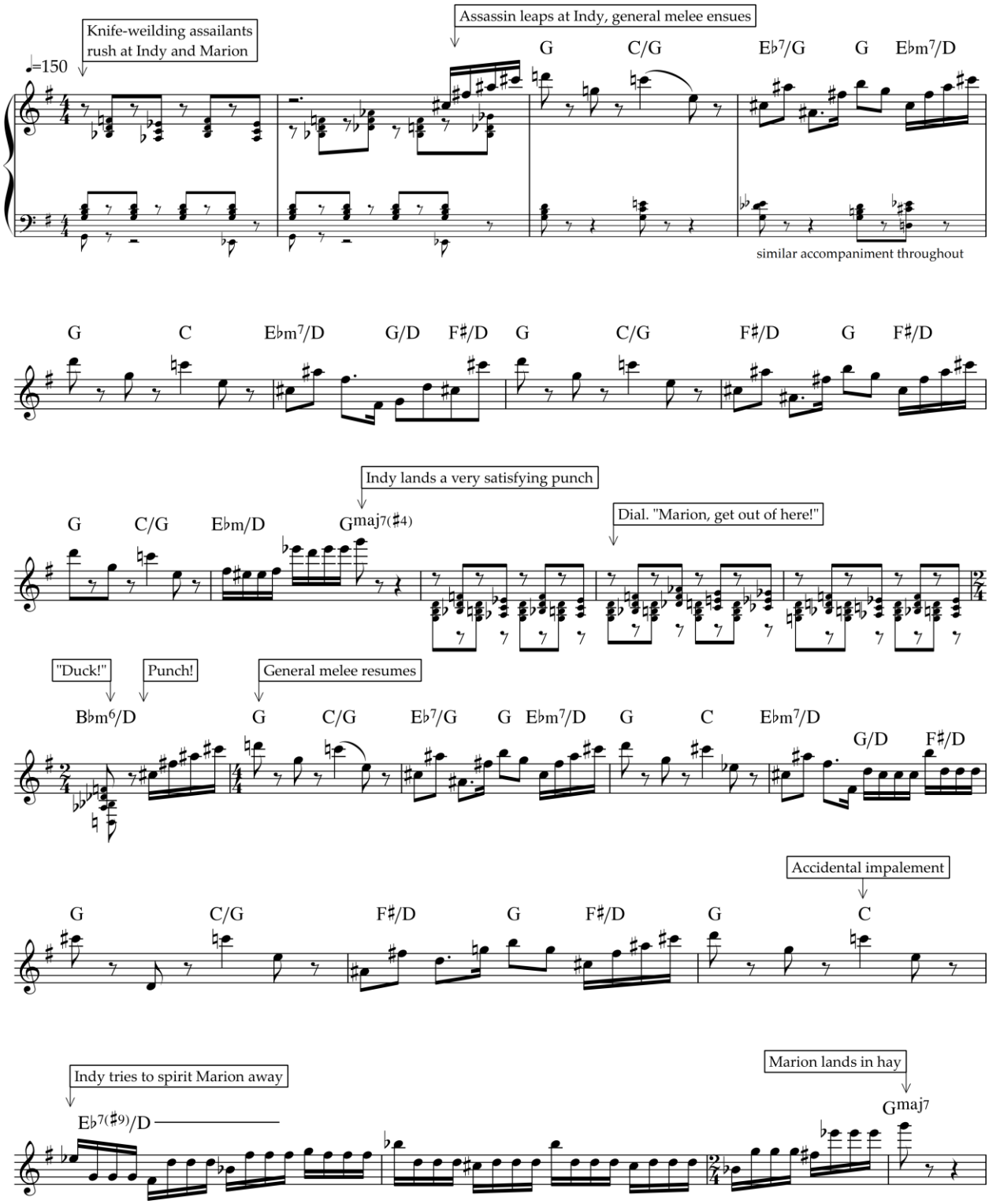


ESCAPE IN THE ALLEYS (RAIDERS)

Examples transcribed from ROTLA 4m5/5m1

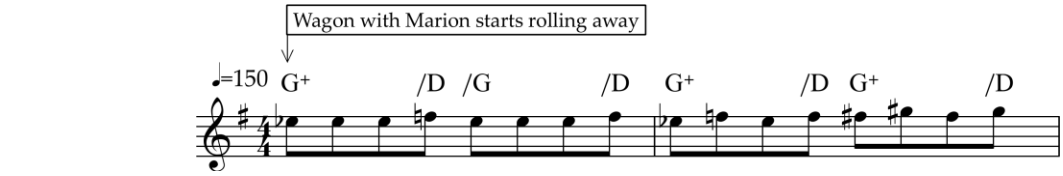
The first true action set-piece cue in the series, involving several recurring musical components in a loosely rondo-like structure. Strikes a mostly comedic and light tone until the end; the antic quality captured in **Main Theme**, a jerky Prokofievian melody with a symmetrical period structure (and amenable to augmentation—see 8 mm. before **Sabre to a Gunfight** episode). Portions recur in TOD as humorous call-back.

BASKET CHASE MAIN THEME

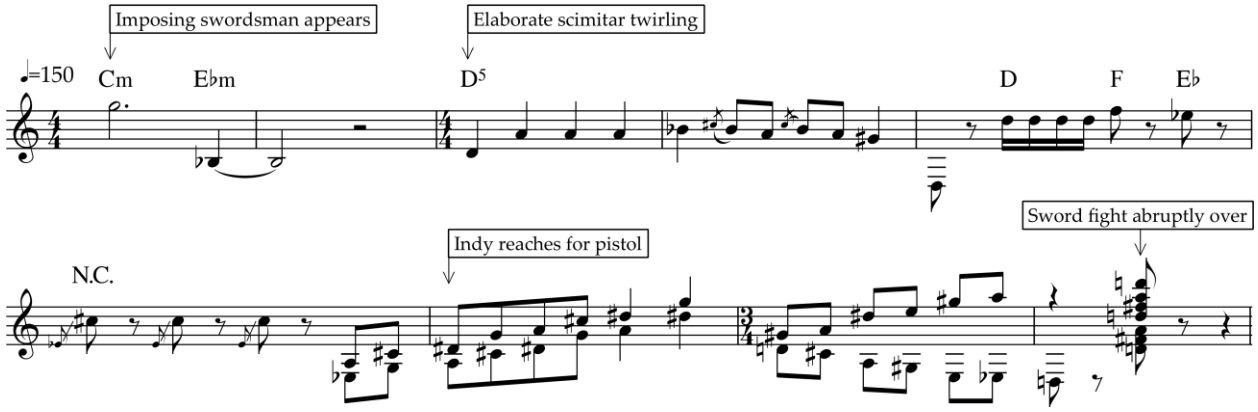


Escape in the Alleys (Cont.)

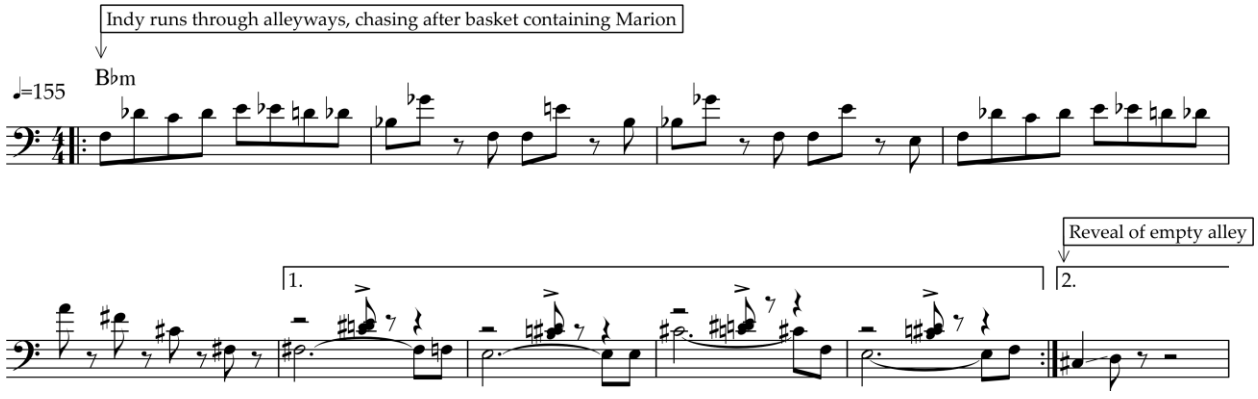
Basket Chase Ostinato



Sabre to a Gun Fight



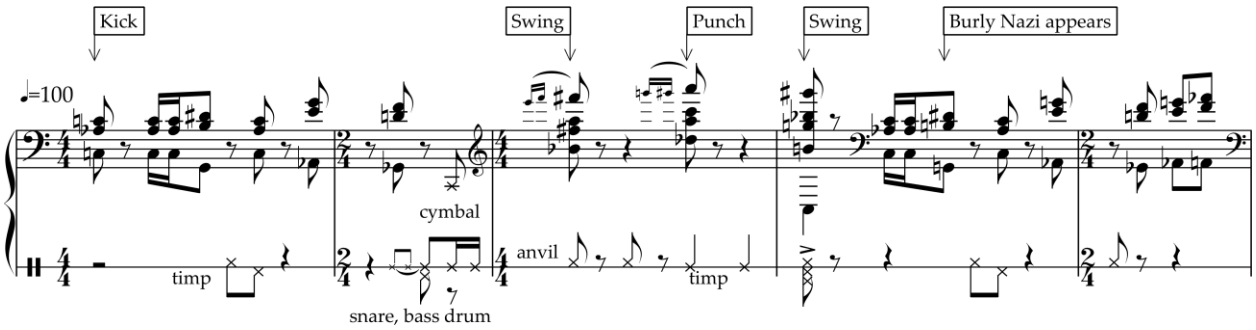
Back Alley Pursuit



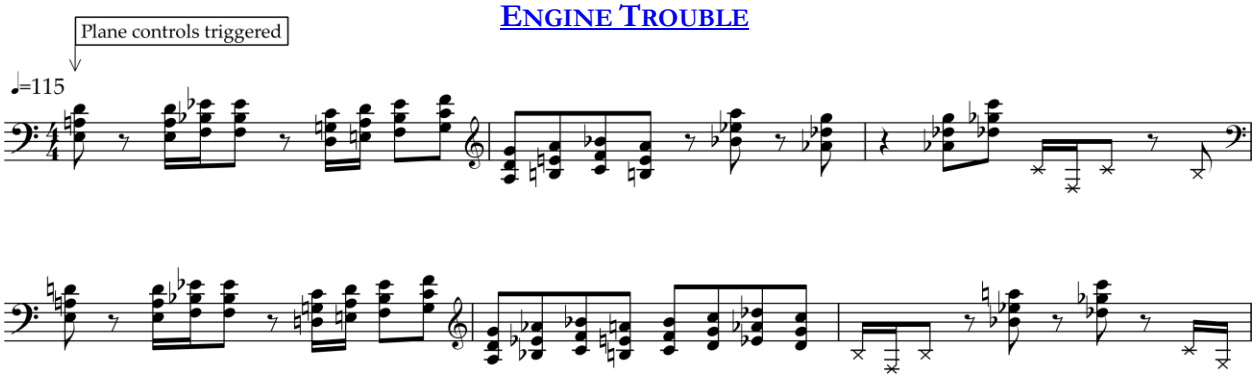
Flying Wing Fight (Raiders)

Examples transcribed from ROTLA 8m5

Punch Chords



Engine Trouble

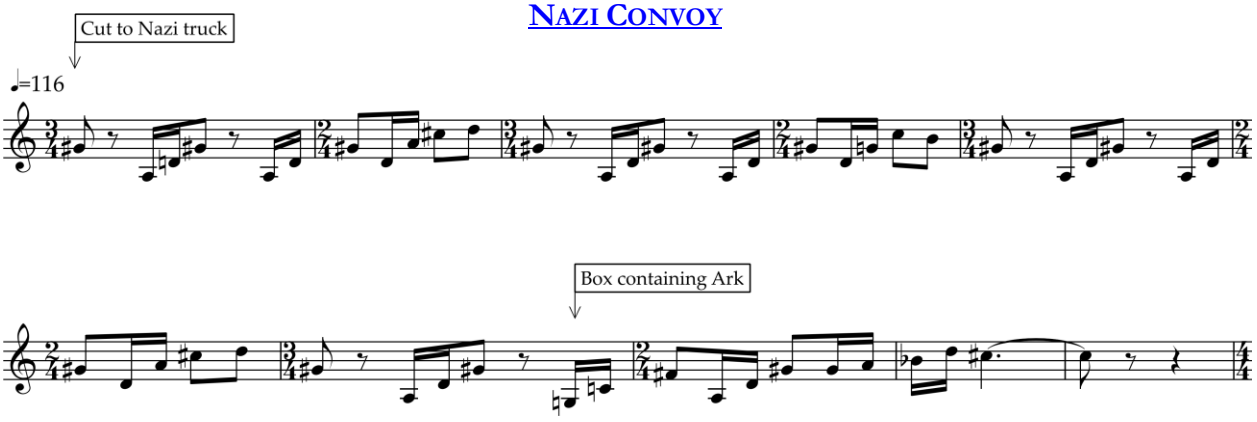


Desert Chase (Raiders)
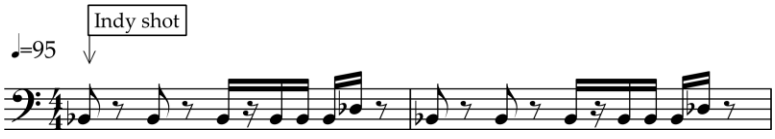
Examples transcribed from ROTLA 9m1, 9m1A

[See David McCauley 2018 for additional analysis]

Nazi Convoy
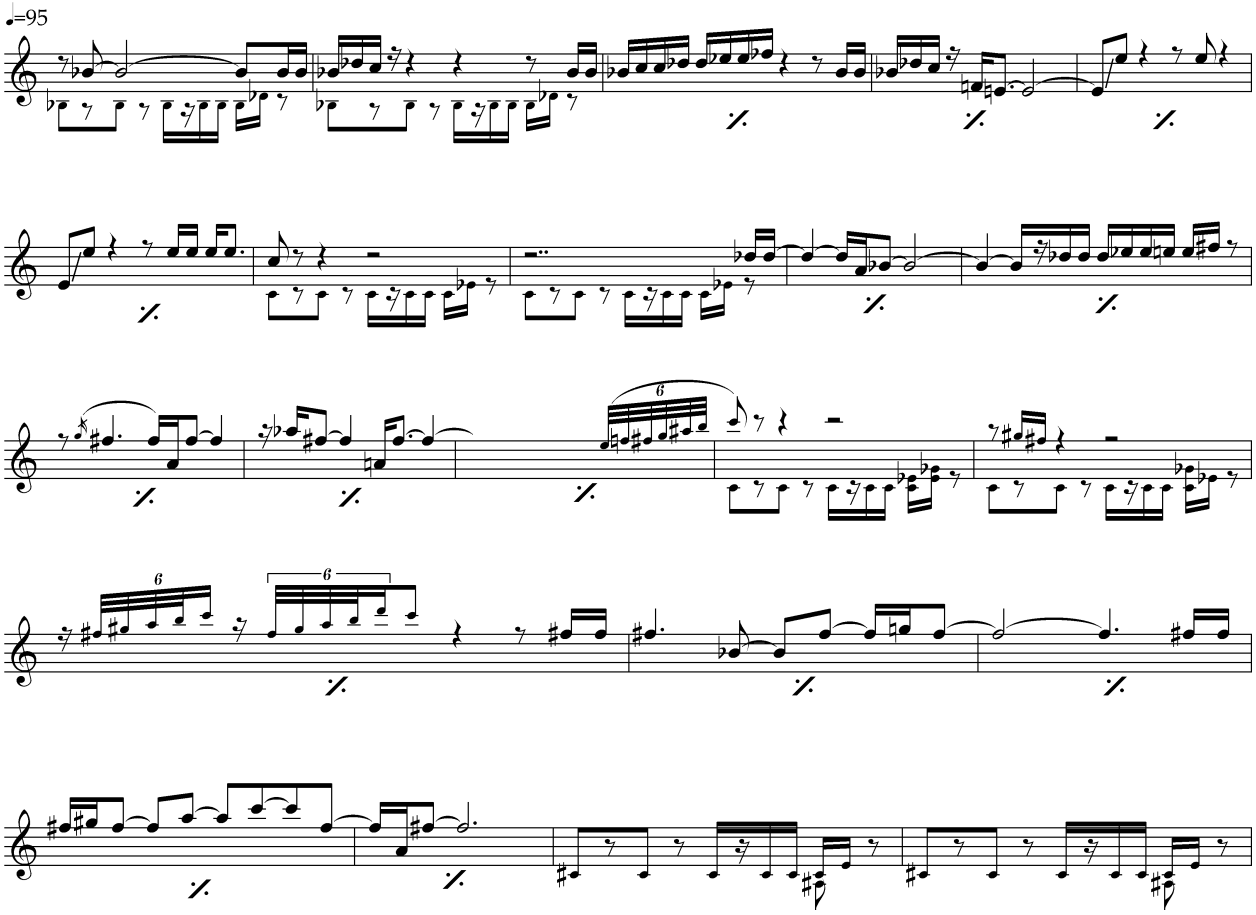


Climactic Ostinato



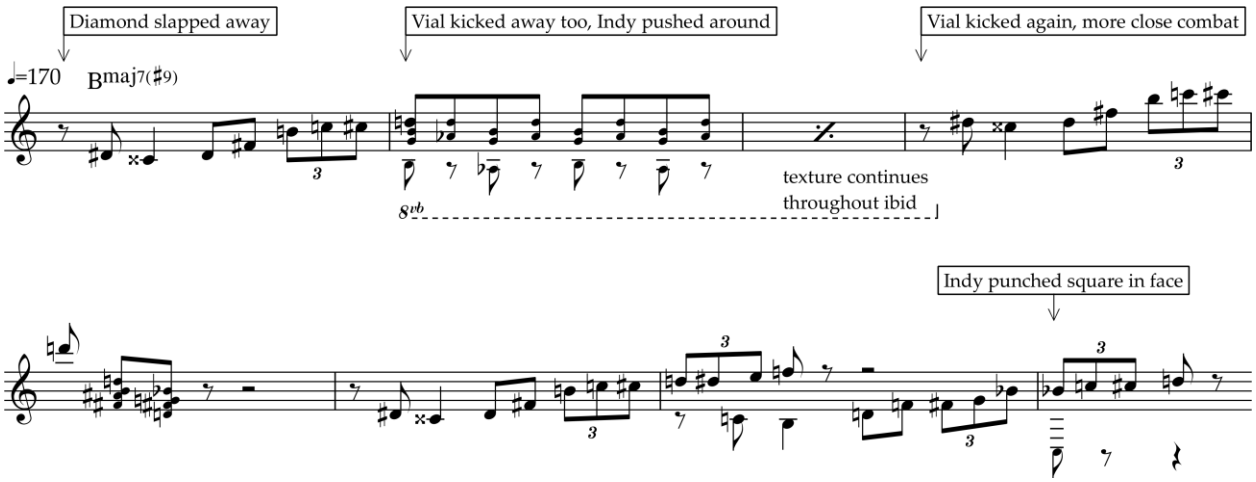
DESERT CHASE (CONT.)

TREATISE ON PUMP-UP MODULATIONS
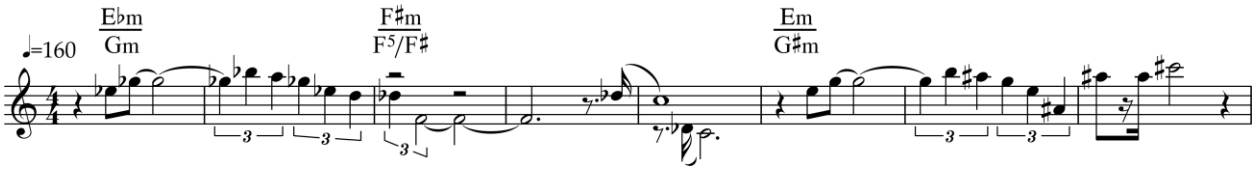


NIGHTCLUB BRAWL (TEMPLE OF DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 1m6 [See Dominic Sewell 2022 for additional analysis]
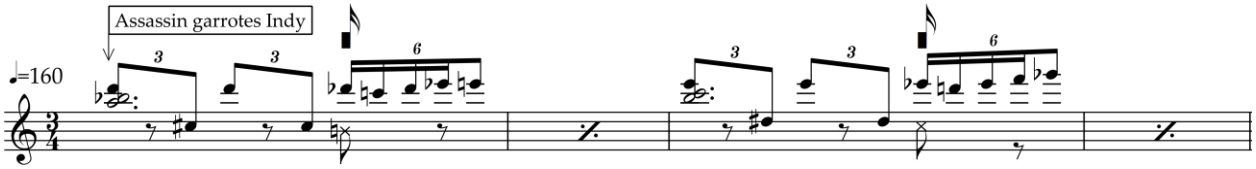


STREET CHASE (DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 1m7/2m1



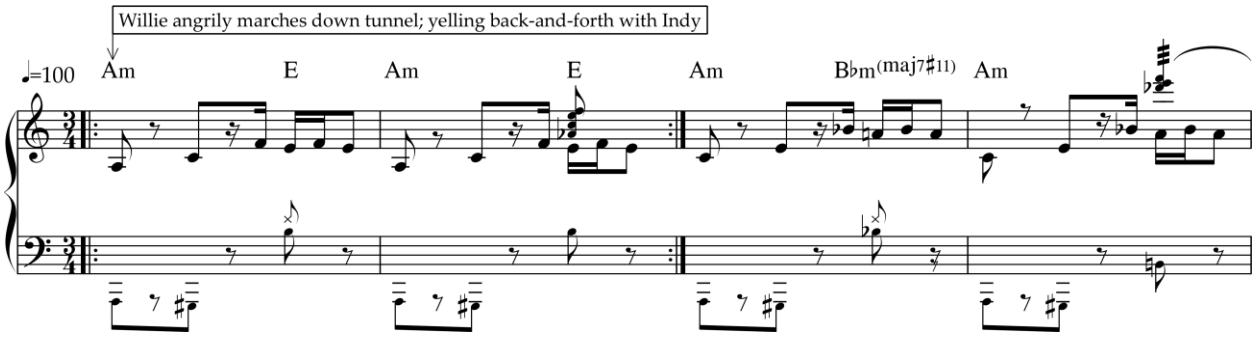
STRANGLE HOLD (DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 5m4/6m1



BUG TUNNEL AND DEATH TRAP (TEMPLE OF DOOM)
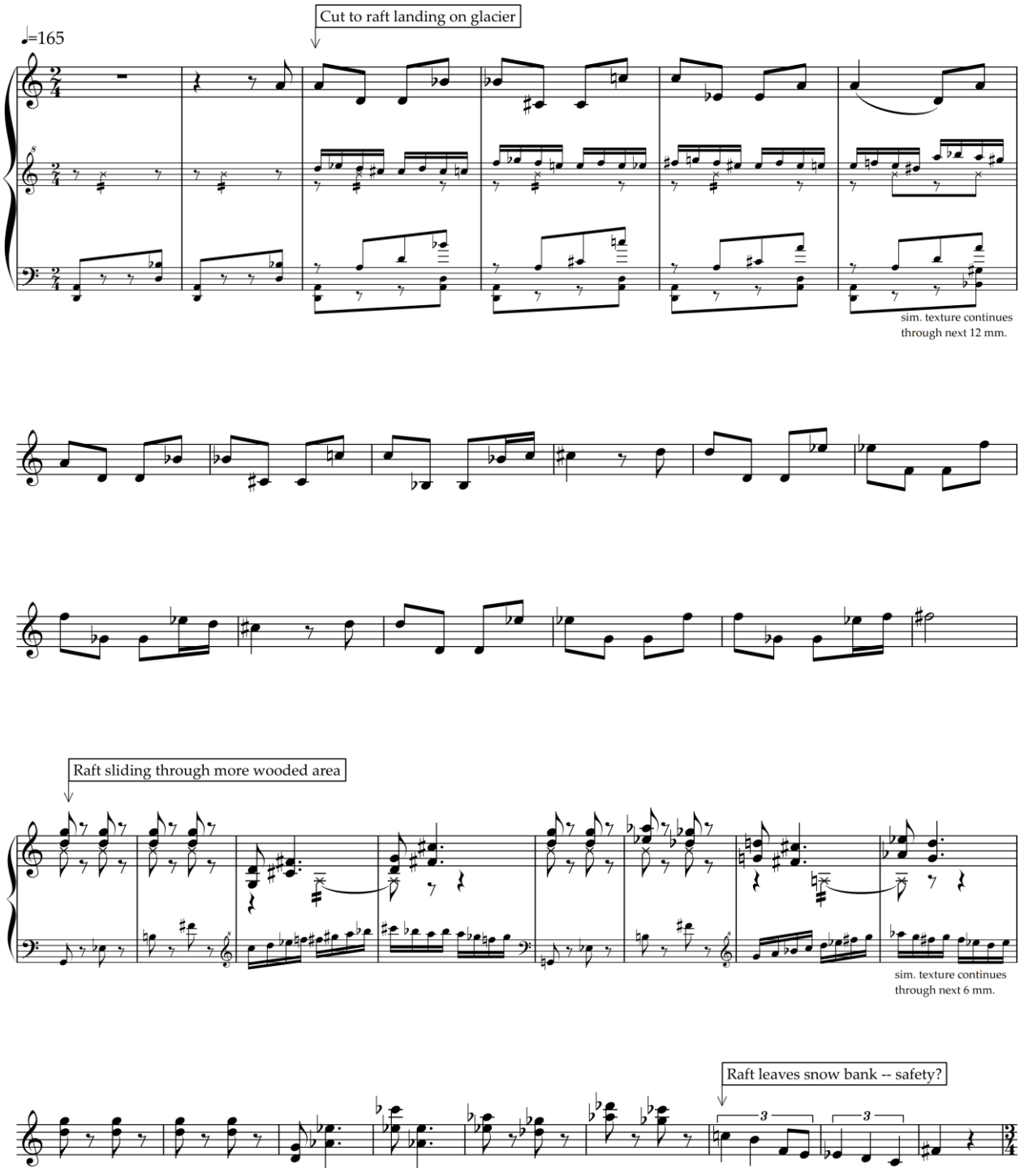
Example transcribed from TOD 6m3



DOWN THE SNOWBANK (DOOM)
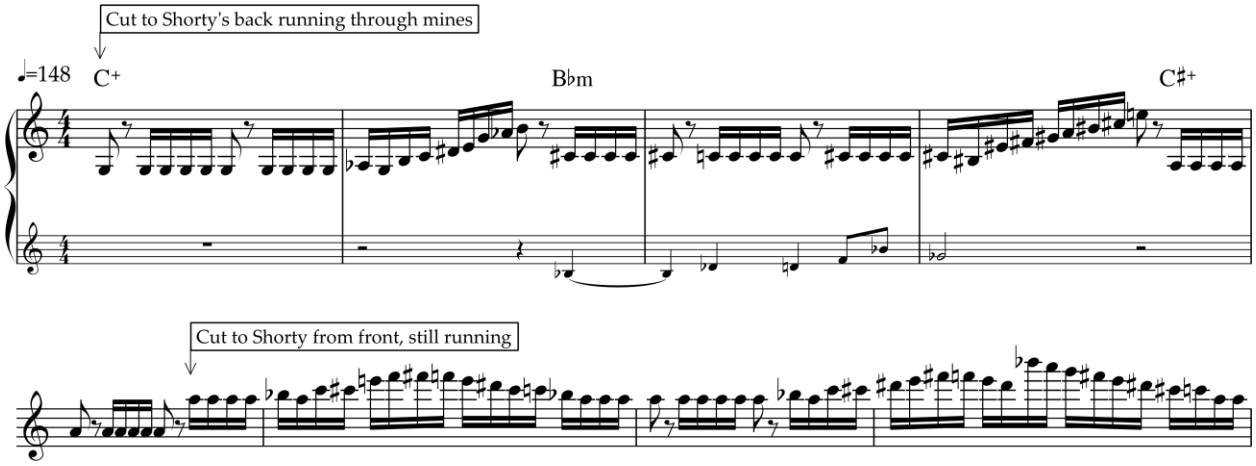
Examples transcribed from TOD 2m3

A spectacular fandango for the slide down the slopes of Mount Humol. Quite short, but crams in a memorable theme amidst urgent variants of Indy, Short-Round, and Willie leitmotifs.
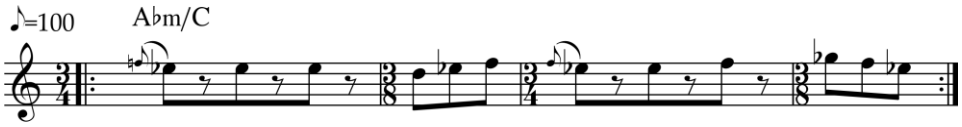


SHORT ROUND'S ESCAPE (TEMPLE OF DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 9m1



FREEING WILLIE (DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 9m3

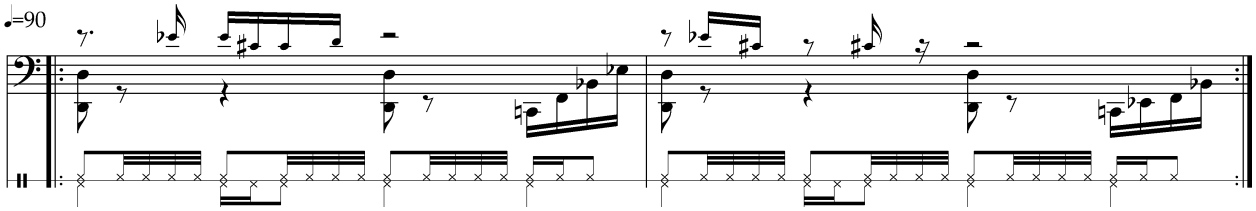


CRUSADE OF THE SLAVE CHILDREN (DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 9m7/10m1

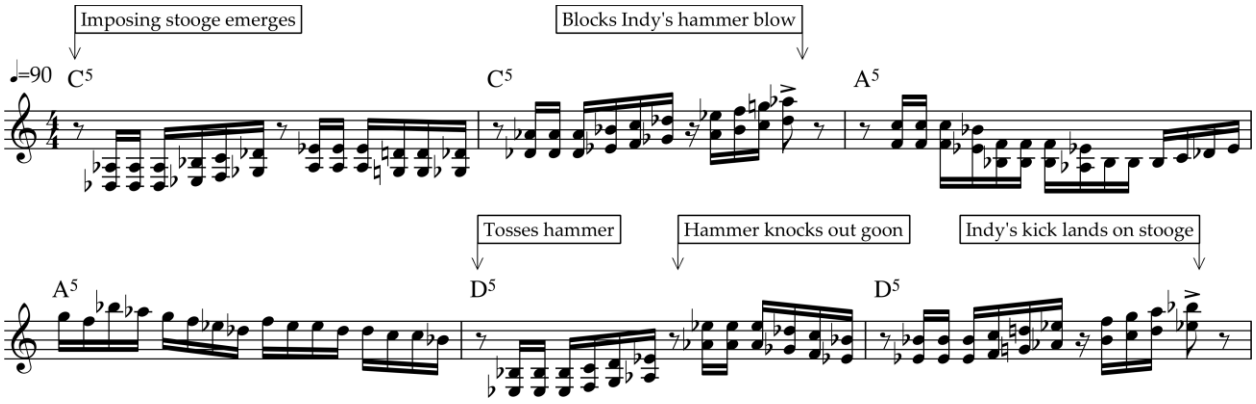
The longest and most thematically elaborate action set-piece in TOD. Revolves primarily around March of the Slave Children. Immediately following cues draw heavily on Raiders March and Shorty's Theme as well.

INTRODUCTORY MARCH OSTINATO



Crusade of the Slave Children (Cont.)

Perilous Fifths
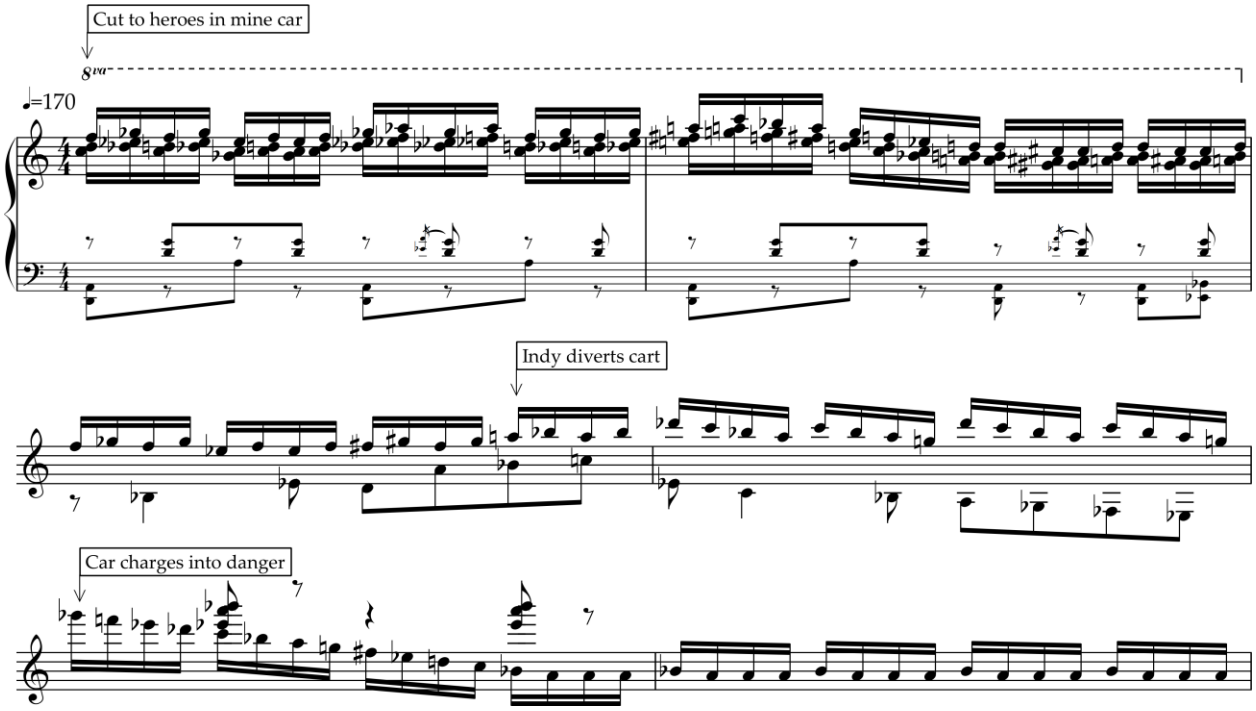


Mine Car Chase (Doom)

Example transcribed from TOD 10m4/11m1
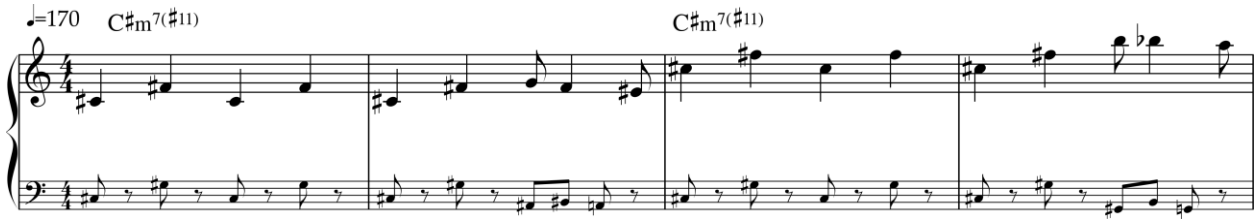
Perhaps most virtuosic action cue in the entire series, with, among other things, sustained prestissimo writing for six *divisi* piccolos. Stuffed with novel internally recurring themes, alternating with Indy, Short Round, and Thugee leitmotifs. Much of it inaudible in final film.

Piccolo Dynamo

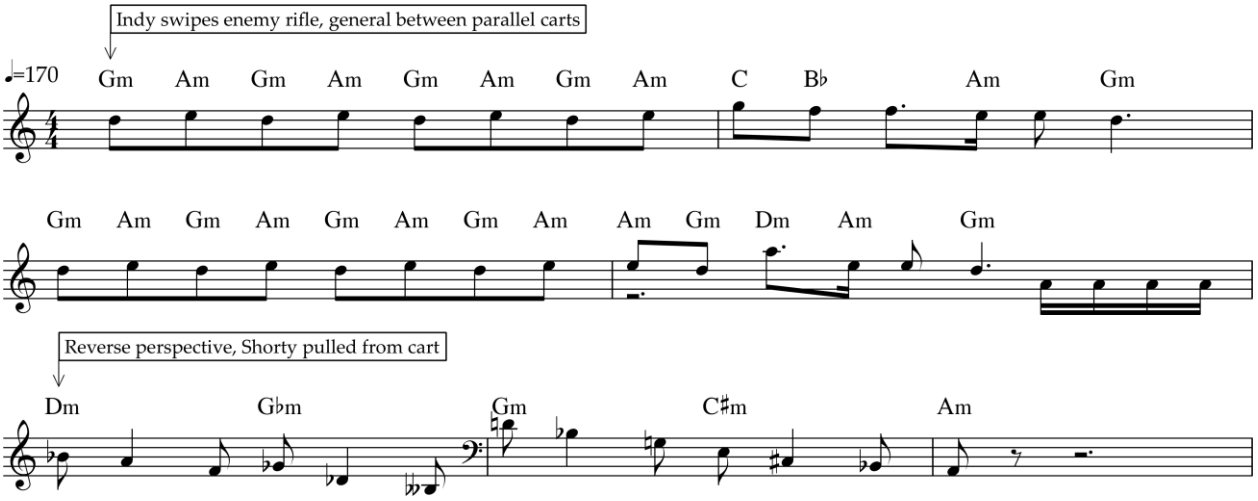


Mine Car Chase (Cont.)

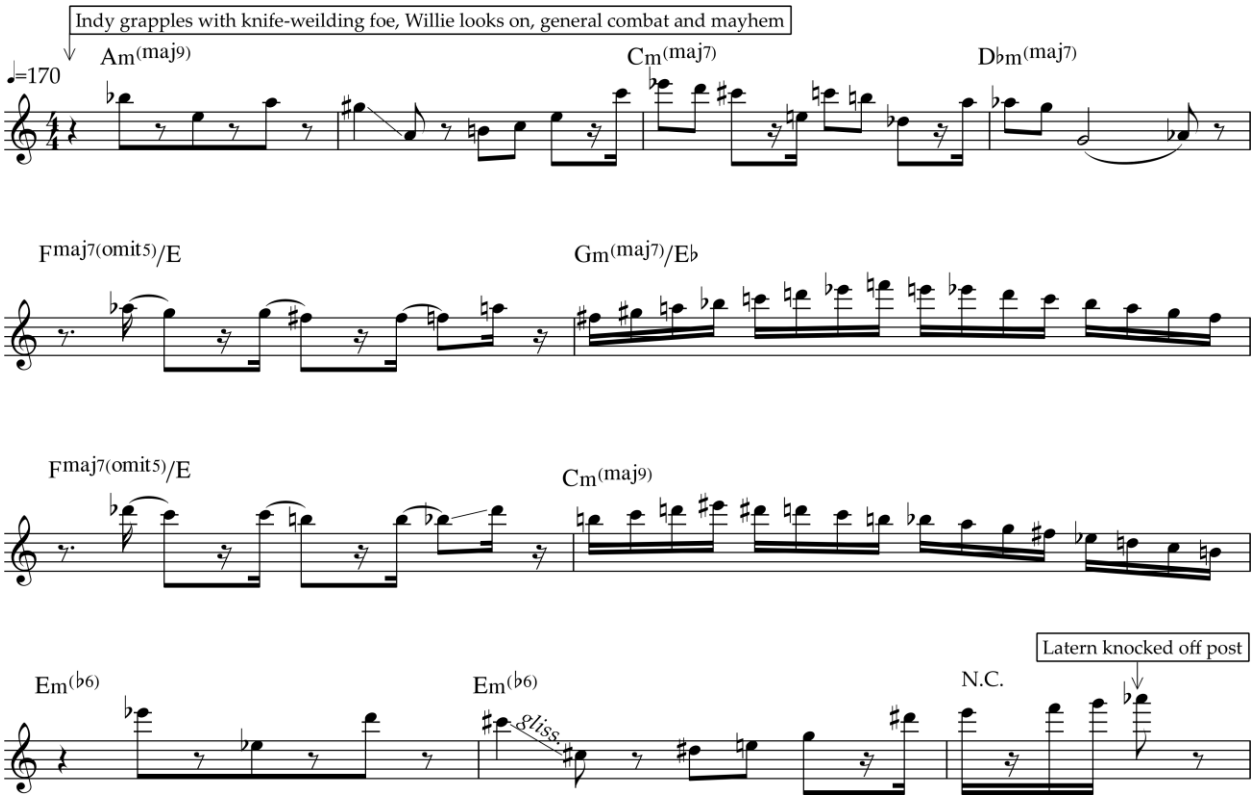
Train Track Tango



Parallel Carts, Parallel Chords
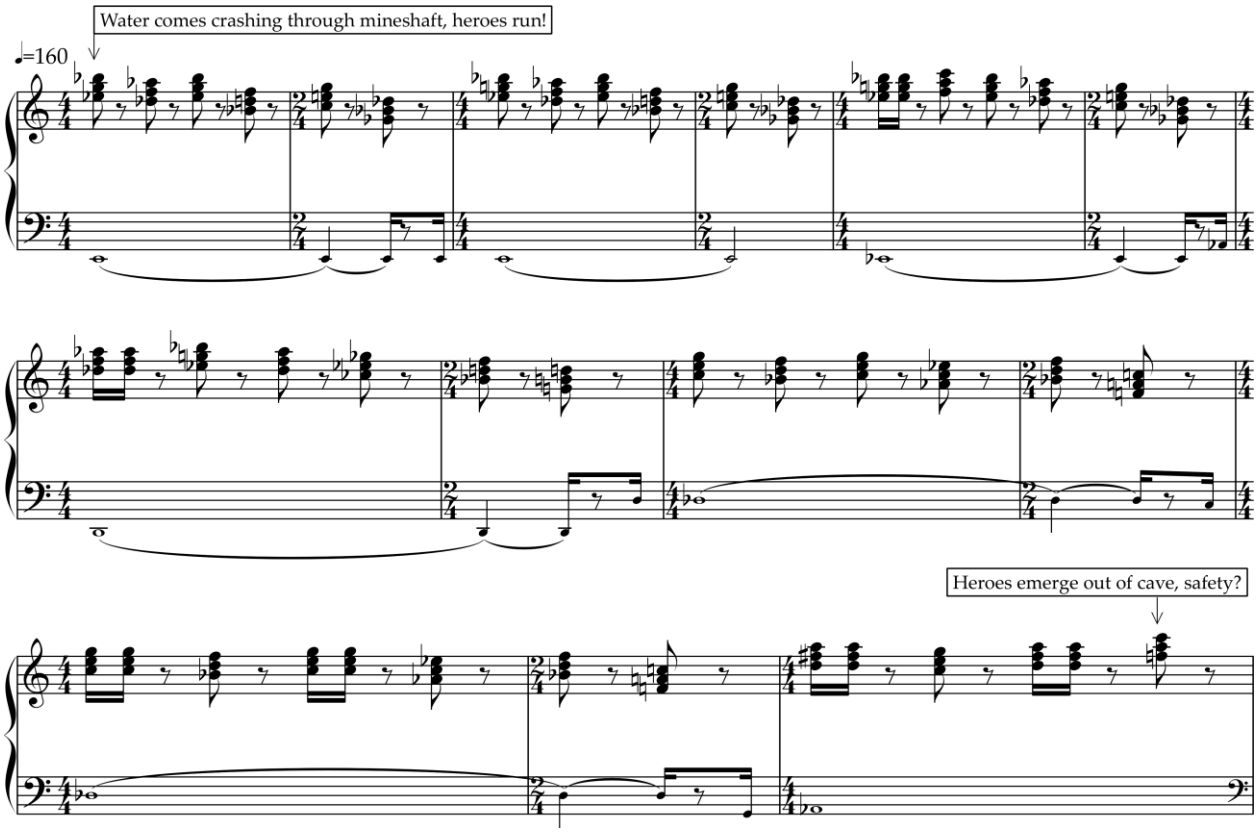


Wrong-Note Rollercoaster



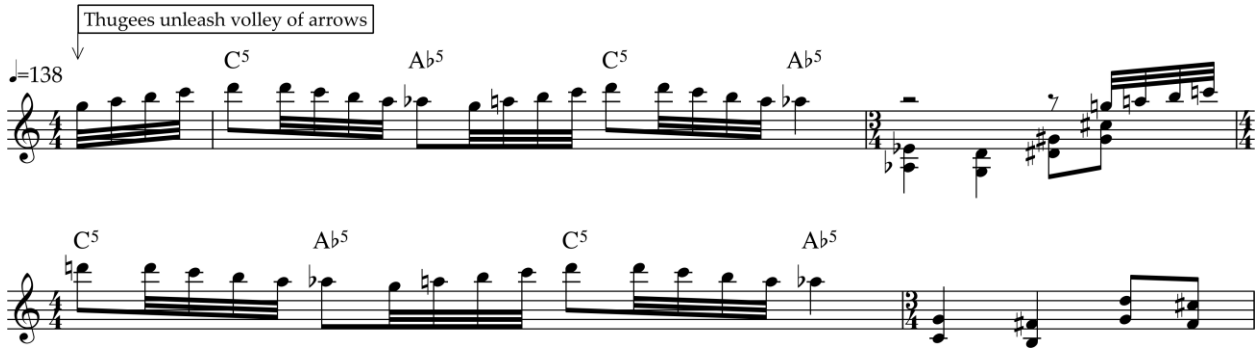
WATER! (TEMPLE OF DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 11m1



BROKEN BRIDGE (TEMPLE OF DOOM)

Example transcribed from TOD 11m4
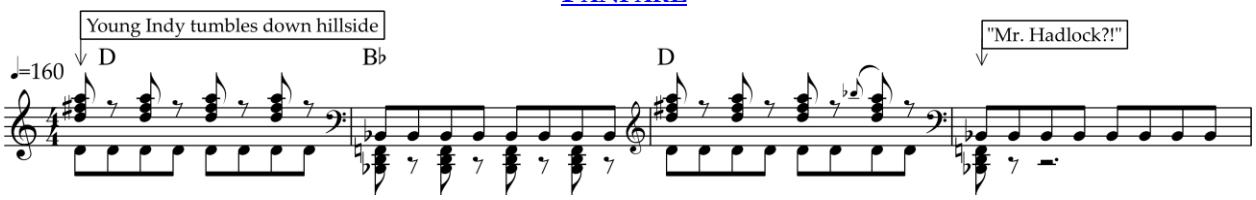


INDY'S VERY FIRST ADVENTURE (LAST CRUSADE)

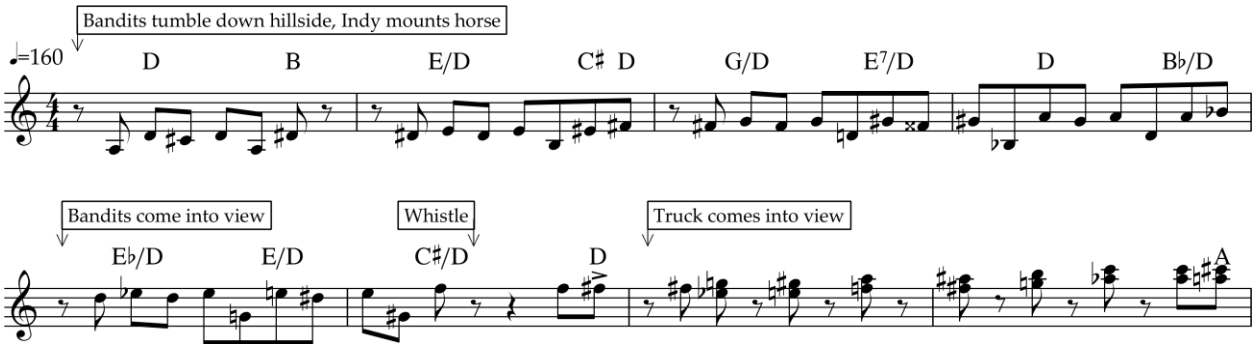
Examples transcribed from TLC 1m2-2m1

Music for the flashback to Indy's youthful exploits. Largely based on an alternation of the two **Young Indy** themes, the Cross, Panama Hat, and Raiders March, plus a rotating cast of extremely tuneful, impeccably mickey-moused melodies and episodes. Generally cartoonish and low-stakes musically speaking, but with a tremendous amount of heart, ending with a superb take on Indy's theme. See David McCauley 2020 for additional analysis.

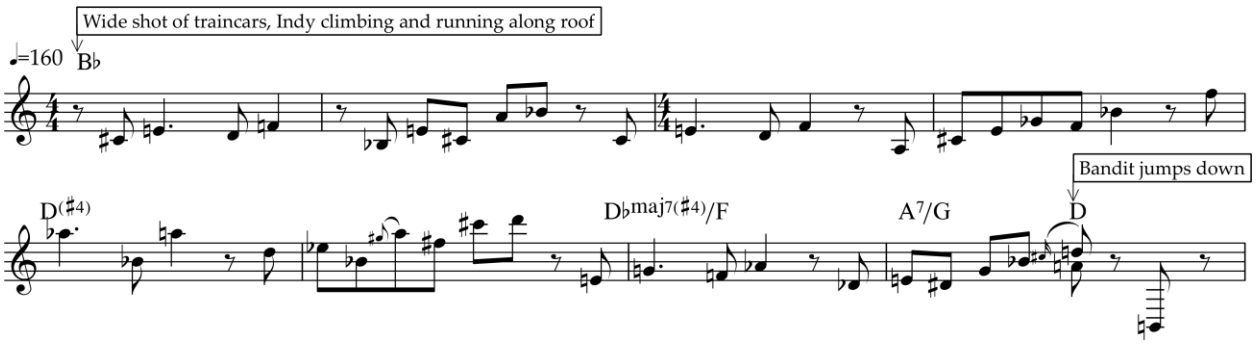
FANFARE



THE CHASE BEGINS

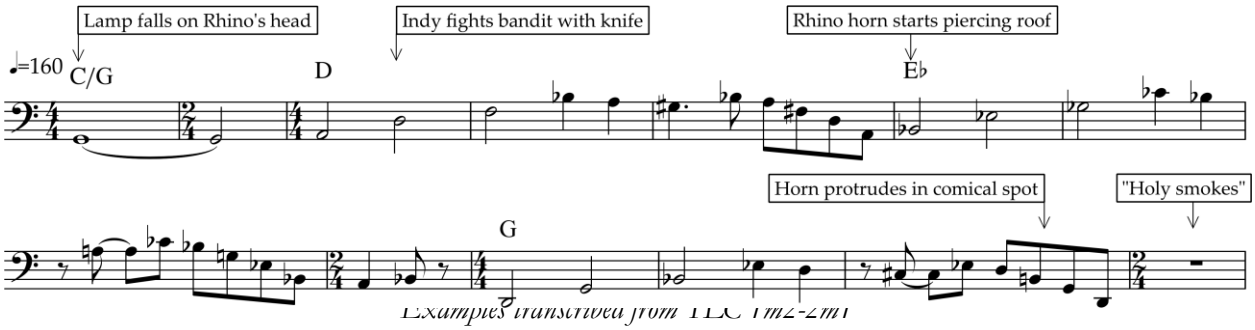


TRAIN SPOTTING



INDY'S VERY FIRST ADVENTURE (CONT.)
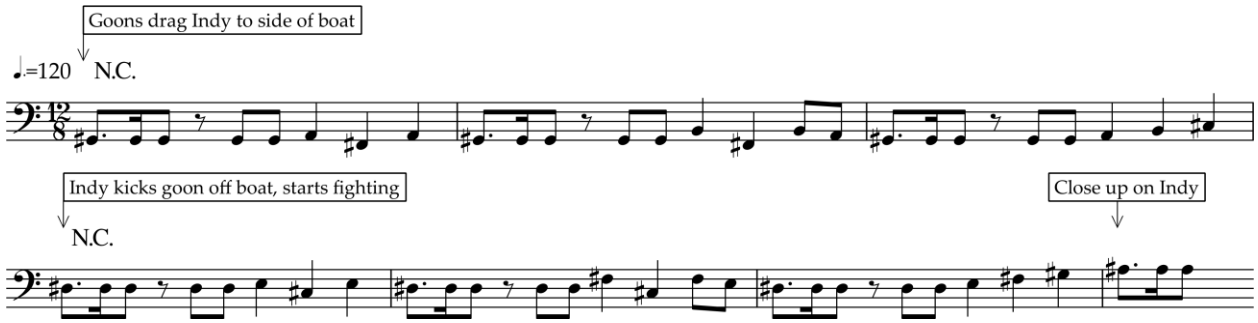
RHINO BLASTED



Examples transcribed from TLC 1m2-2m1

THE BOAT SCENE
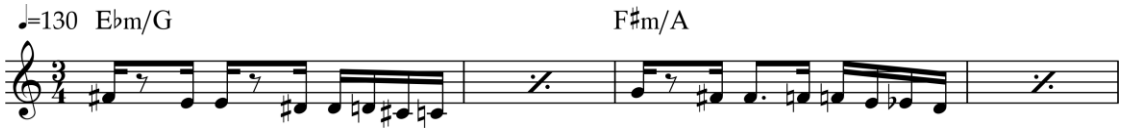
Example transcribed from TLC 2m2



CATACOMB FIRE (CRUSADE, SKULL)

Example transcribed from TLC 4m3/5m1.

Recurs in KOTCS

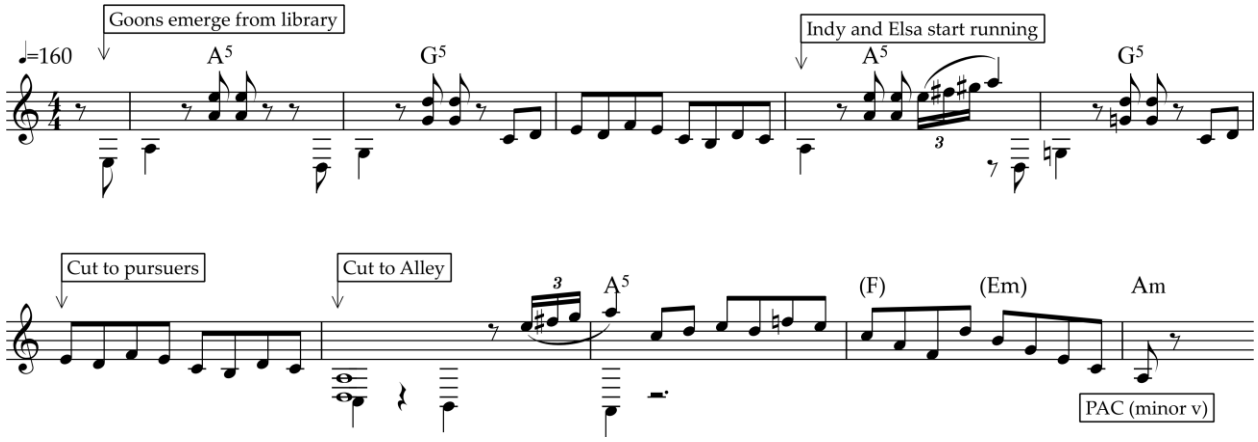


VENICE BOAT CHASE (CRUSADE)
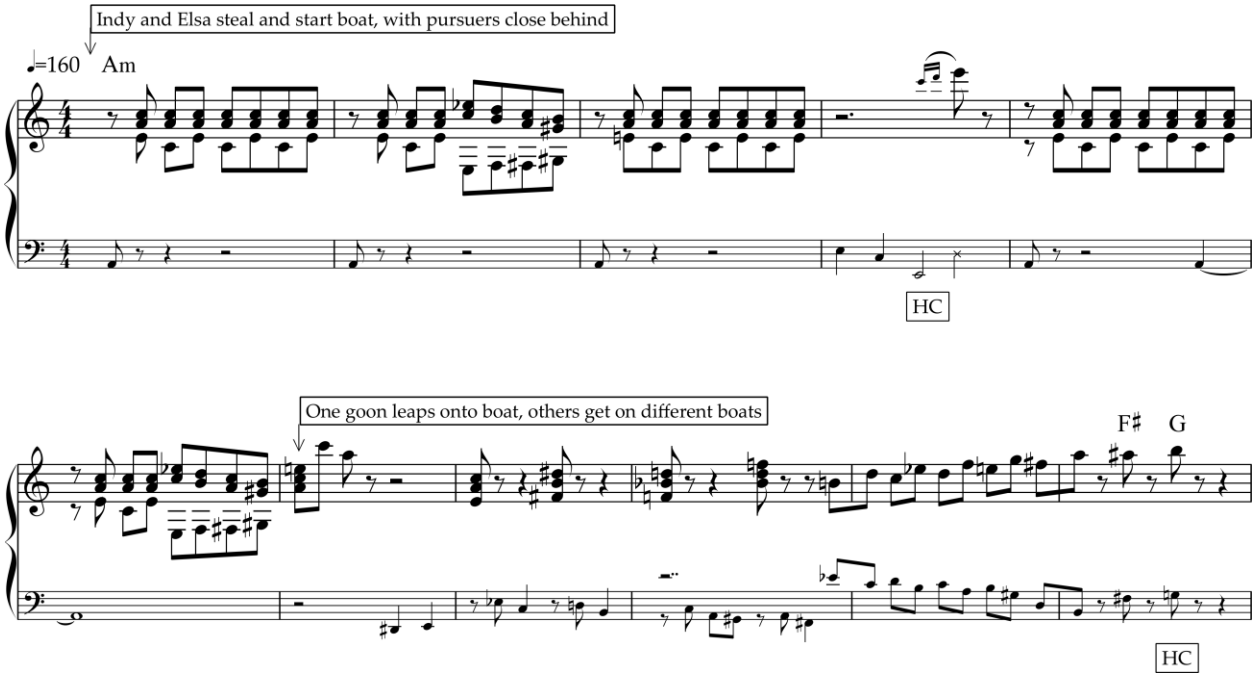
Example transcribed from TOD 11m1

First minute of this cue is, measure for measure, the most melodious set-piece in the entire series: four self-standing period melodies, each with an internal antecedent/consequent structure. Becomes more hectic and less tuneful as cue goes on, ending with a slicing ostinato.

OUT OF THE PLAZA PRESTO
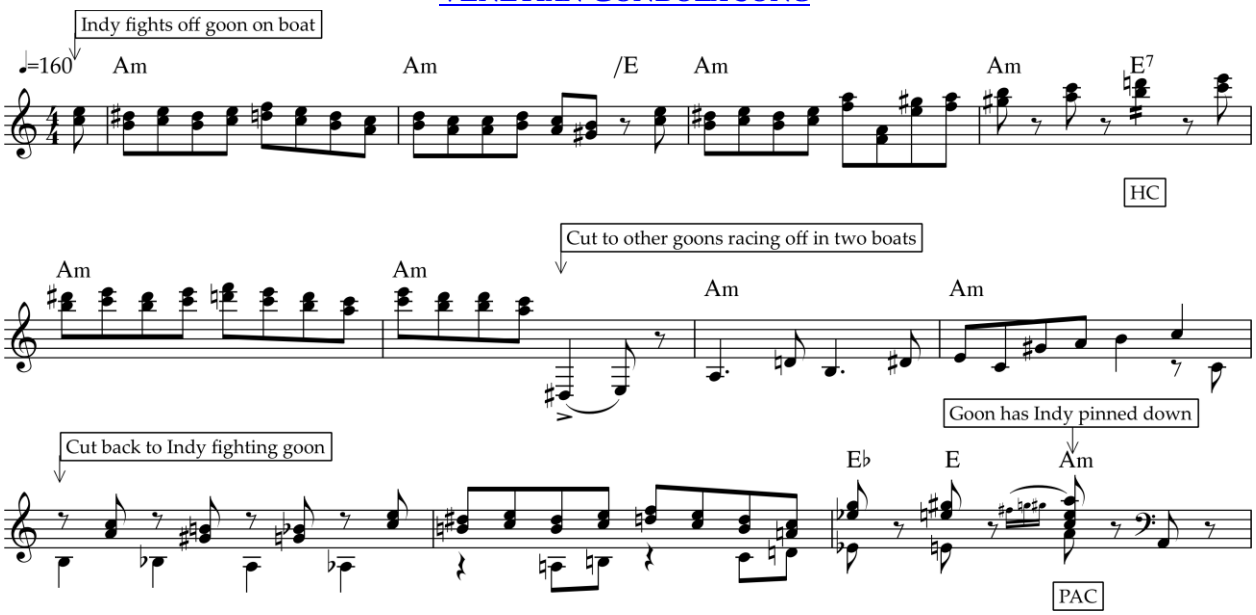


BOAT SHOPPING
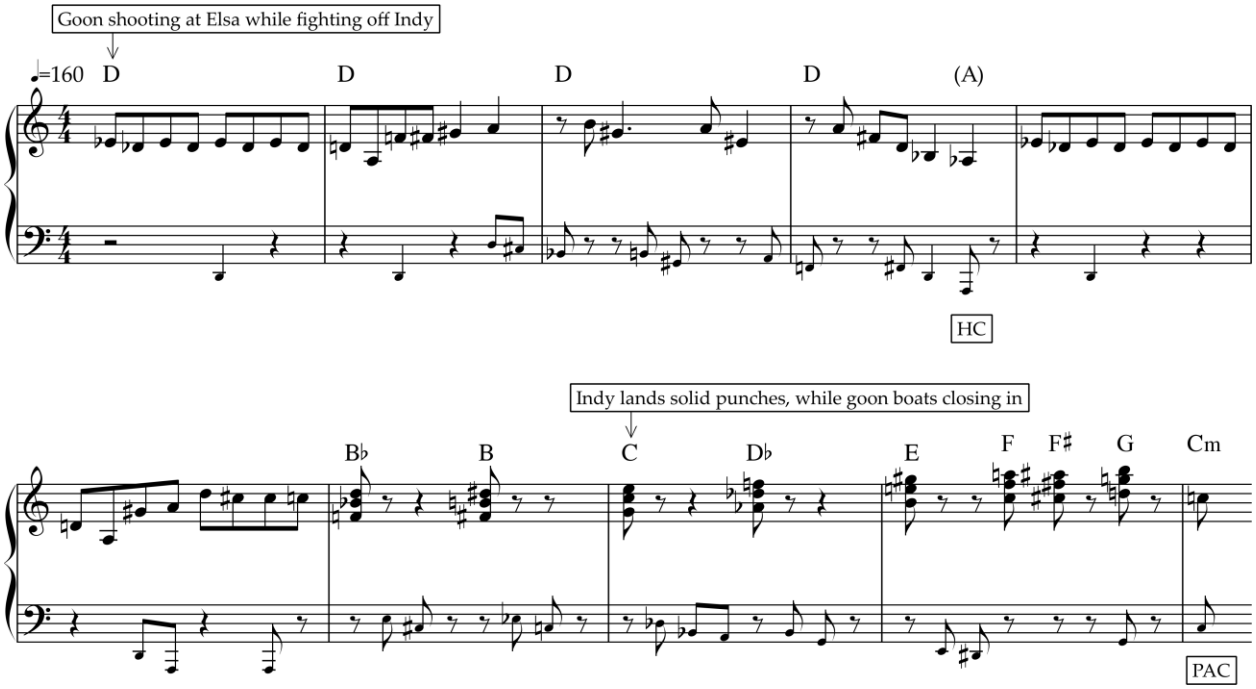


VENICE BOAT CHASE (CONT.)

VENETIAN GONDOLA SONG



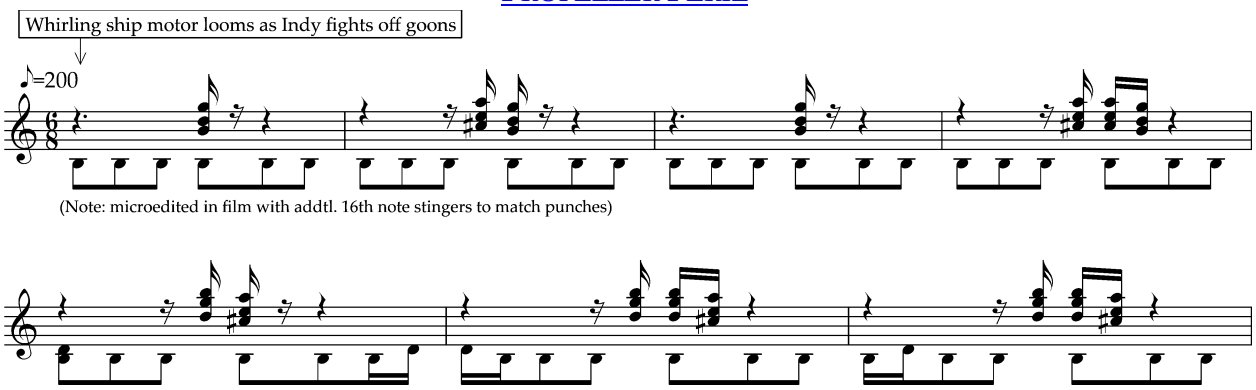
SPLASHING SCHERZO

Recurs in DOD



VENICE BOAT CHASE (CONT.)

PROPELLER PERIL



ALARM! (CRUSADE)

Example transcribed from TLC 7m2

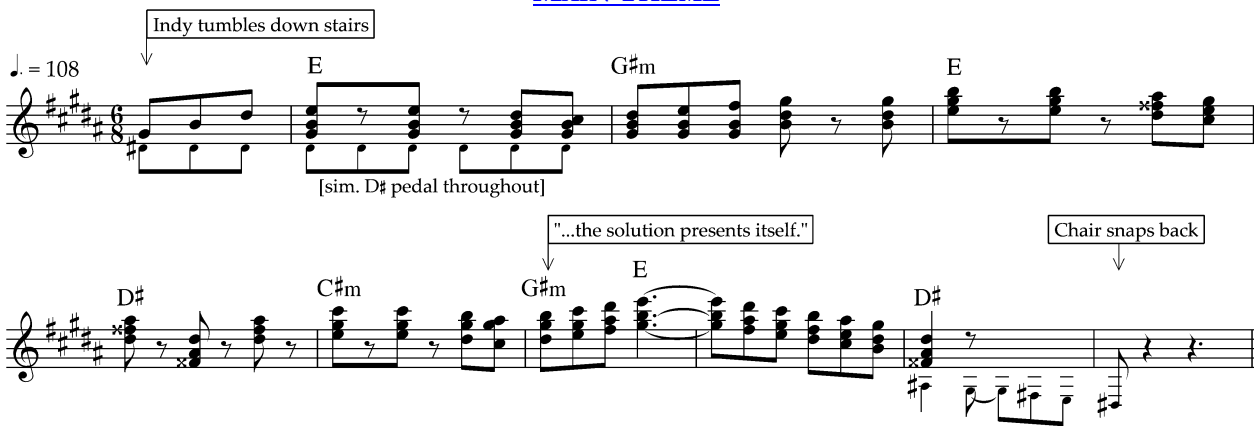


SCHERZO FOR MOTORCYCLE & ORCHESTRA (CRUSADE)

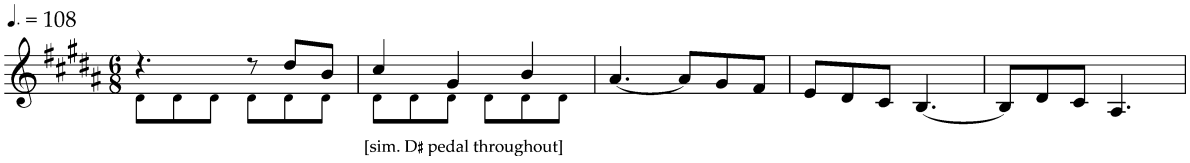
Example transcribed from TLC 7m3

The only genuinely *leitmotivic* action theme in the Indiana Jones series. Main Theme featured across four or five separate cues in Last Crusade. A true scherzo, in fast compound time with a sense of comic energy and perpetuum mobile momentum. Opening theme has harmonic ramifications in other cues beyond action scenes. Treated to a concert arrangement with several interestingly related revisions; see Lehman 2018. For additional analysis of cue itself, see McCauley 2021.
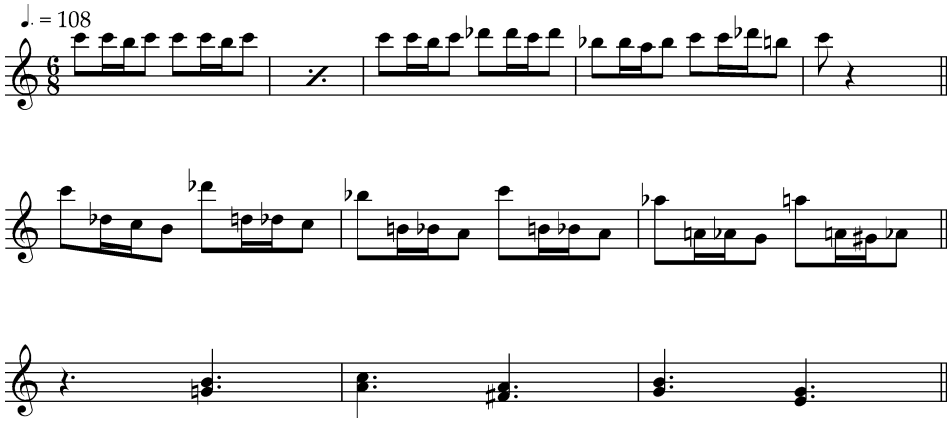
MAIN THEME



SECONDARY THEME

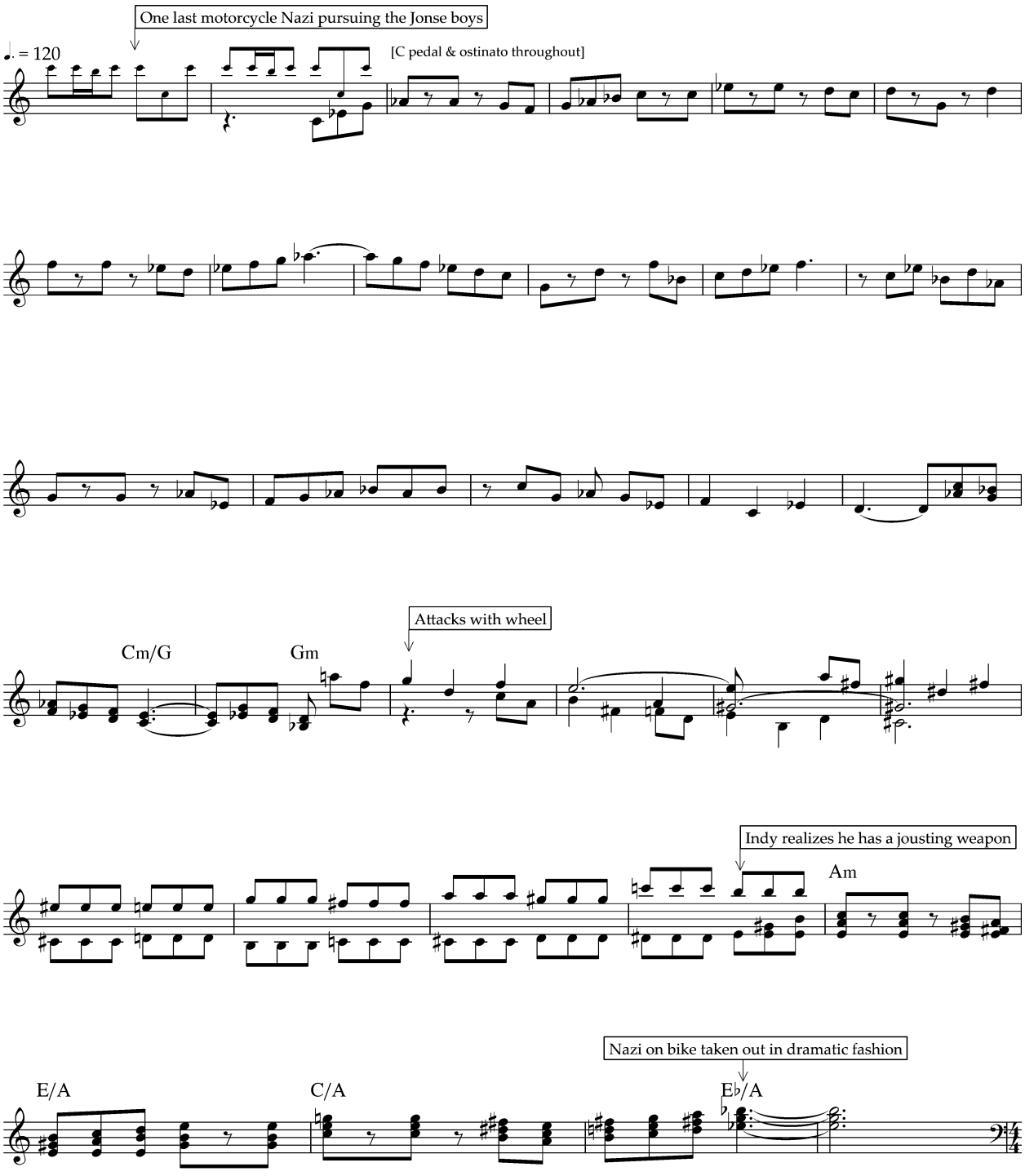


OSTINATI (VARIOUS)



SCHERZO FOR MOTORCYCLE & ORCHESTRA (CONT.)

CLIMAX
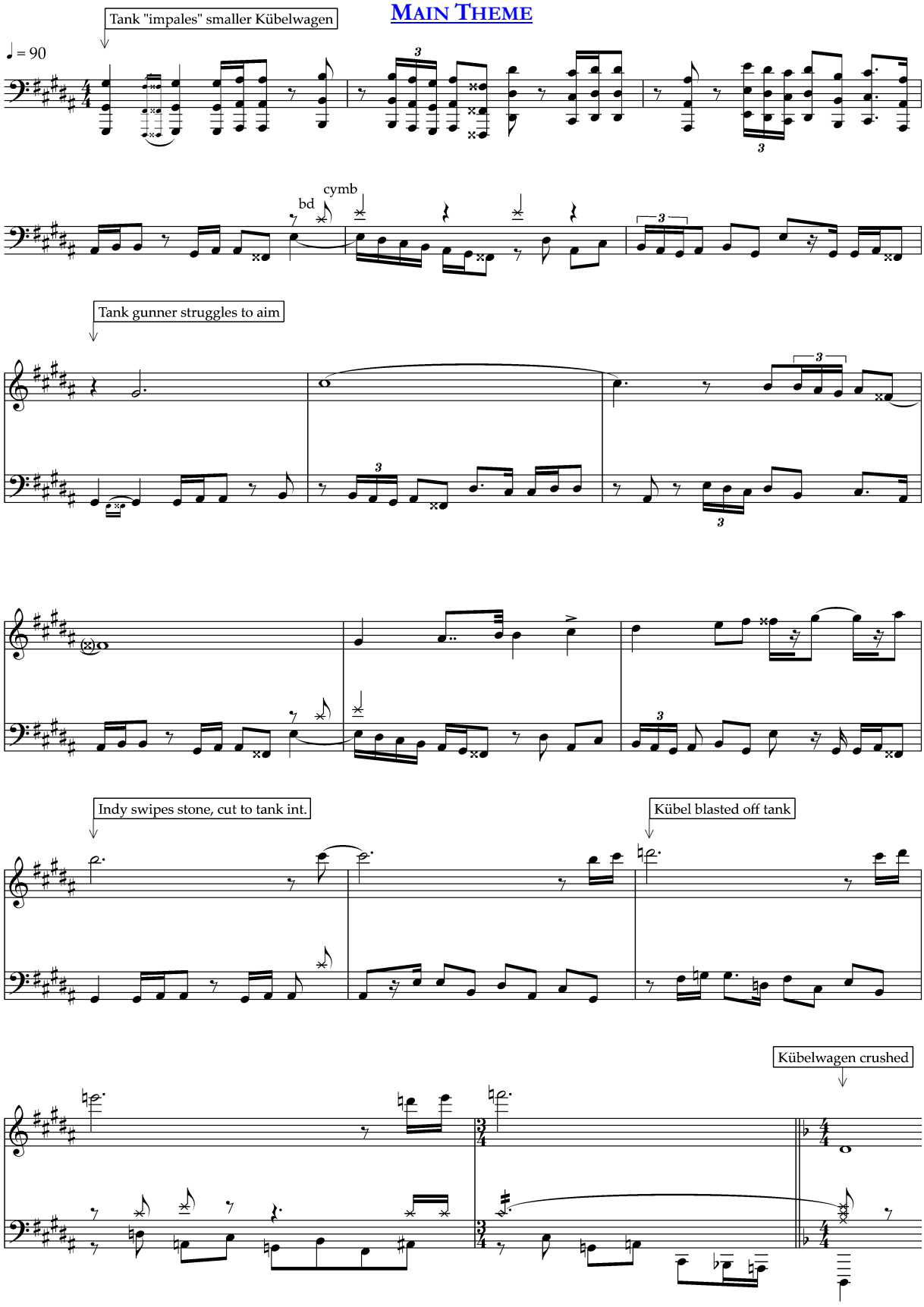


BELLY OF THE STEEL BEAST

Examples transcribed from TLC 10m1 through 11m1

The bravura climactic action sequence of TLC, built out of several interlinked cues and inserts. In some ways a revisitation of ROTLA's "Desert Chase," but perhaps more satisfying on pure musical basis
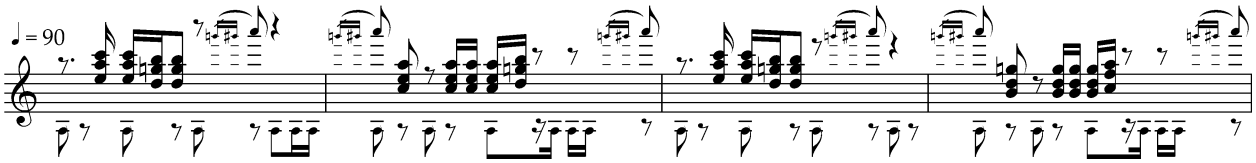
MAIN THEME
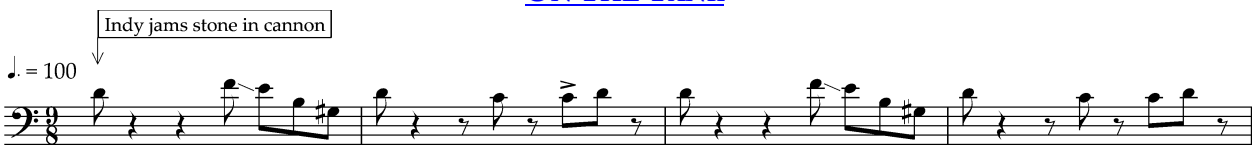


BELLY OF THE STEEL BEAST (CONT.)

Examples transcribed from TLC 10m1 through 11m1
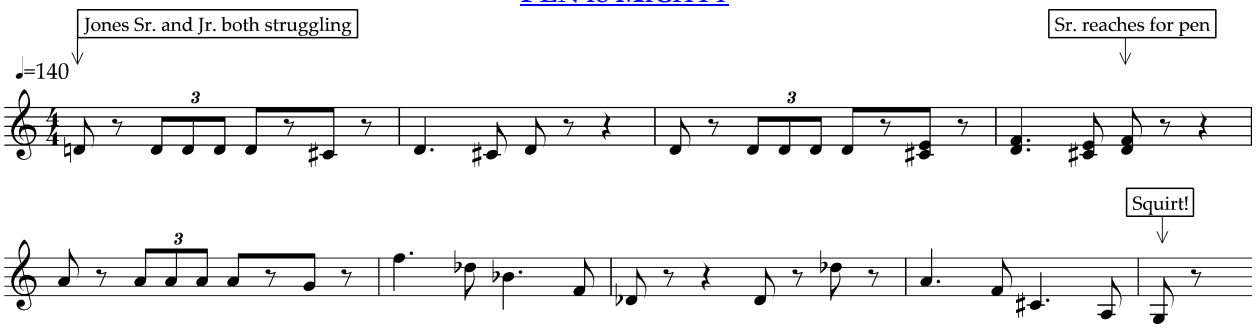
"WO IST JONES?!?"



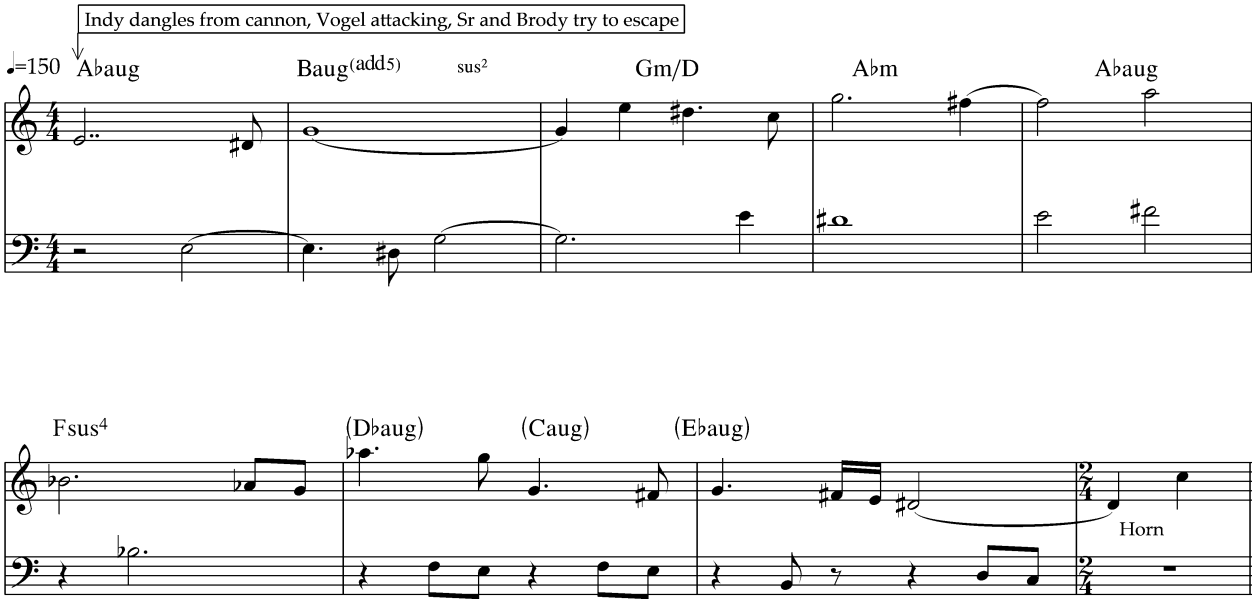
ON THE TANK



PEN IS MIGHTY



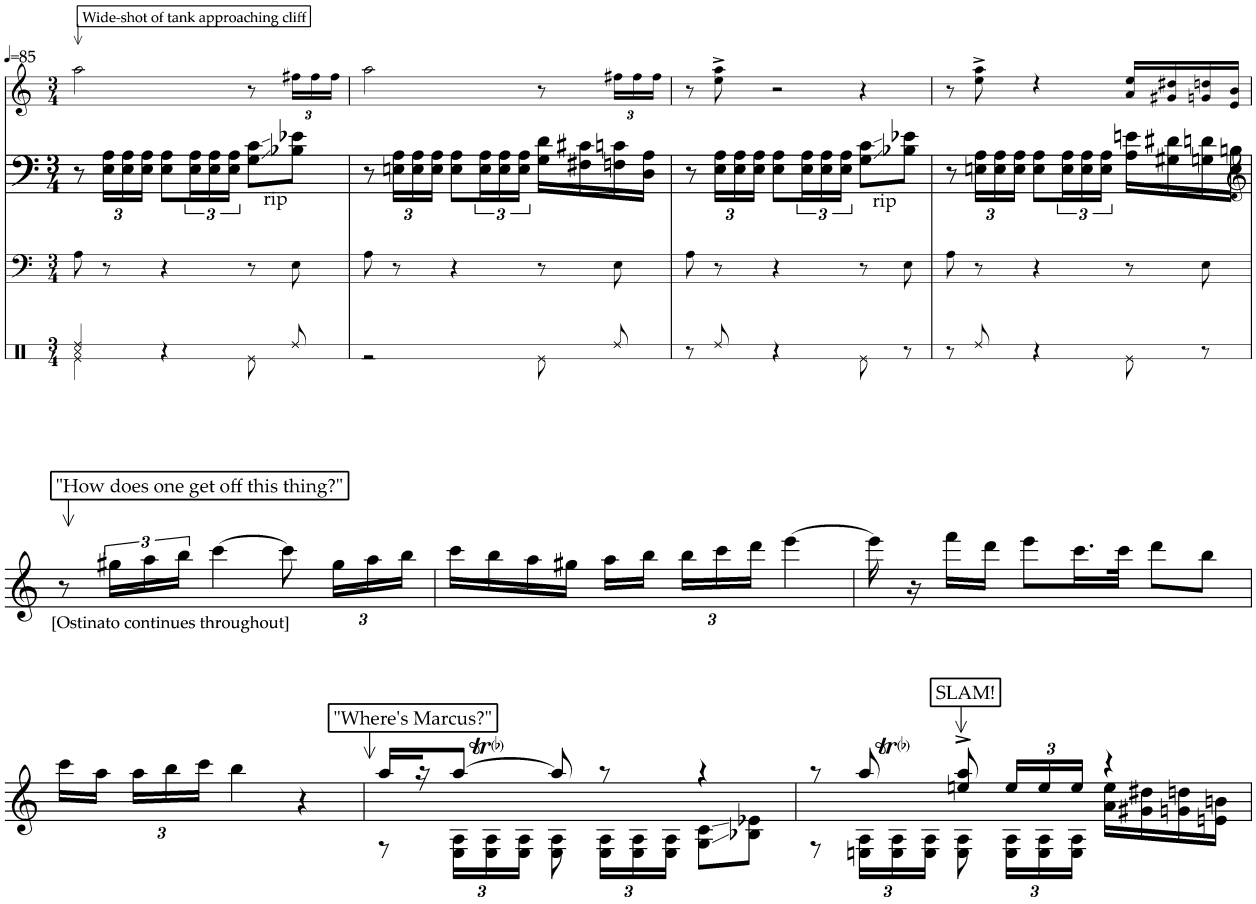
TANK CANON CANNON



BELLY OF THE STEEL BEAST (CONT.)

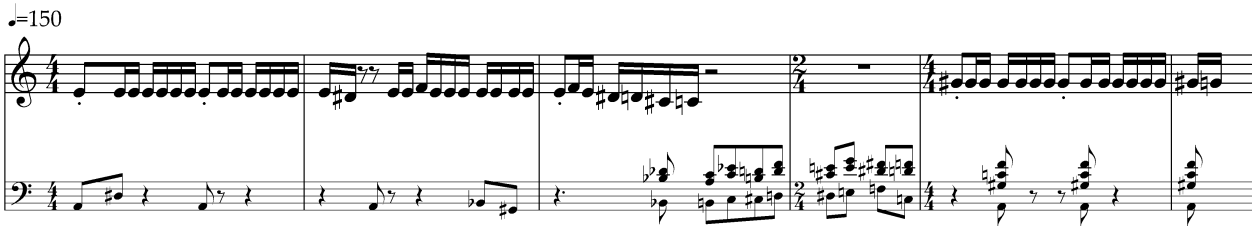
Examples transcribed from TLC 10m1 through 11m1

BRUTAL BOLERO



ESCAPE FROM THE WAREHOUSE (CRYSTAL SKULL)

Example transcribed from KOTCS 2m8B
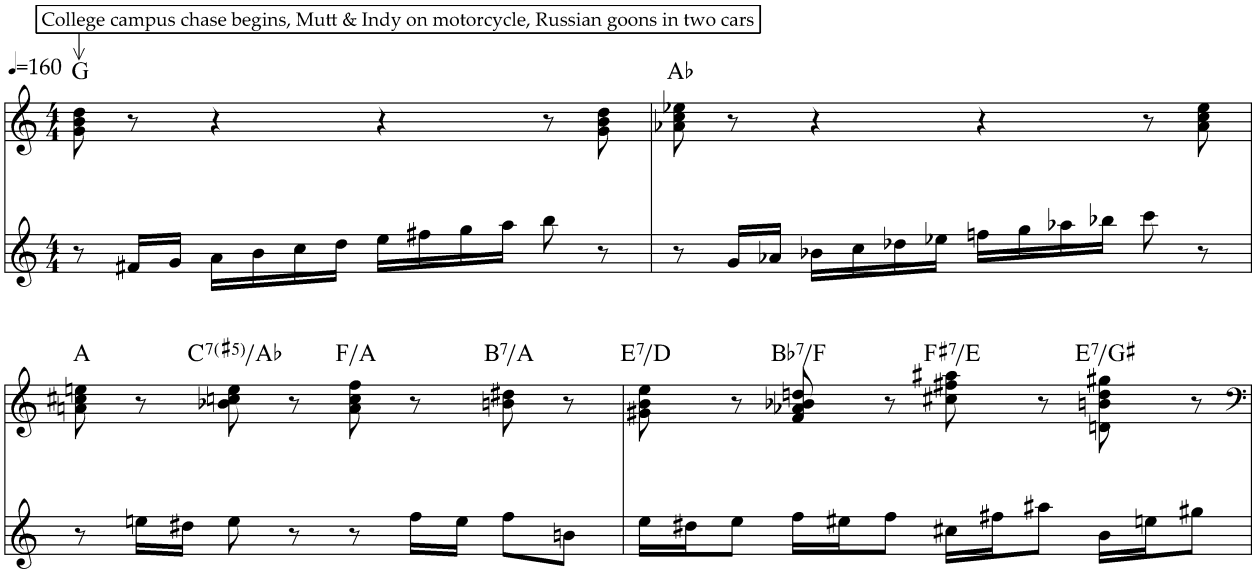


WHIRL THROUGH ACADEME (SKULL)

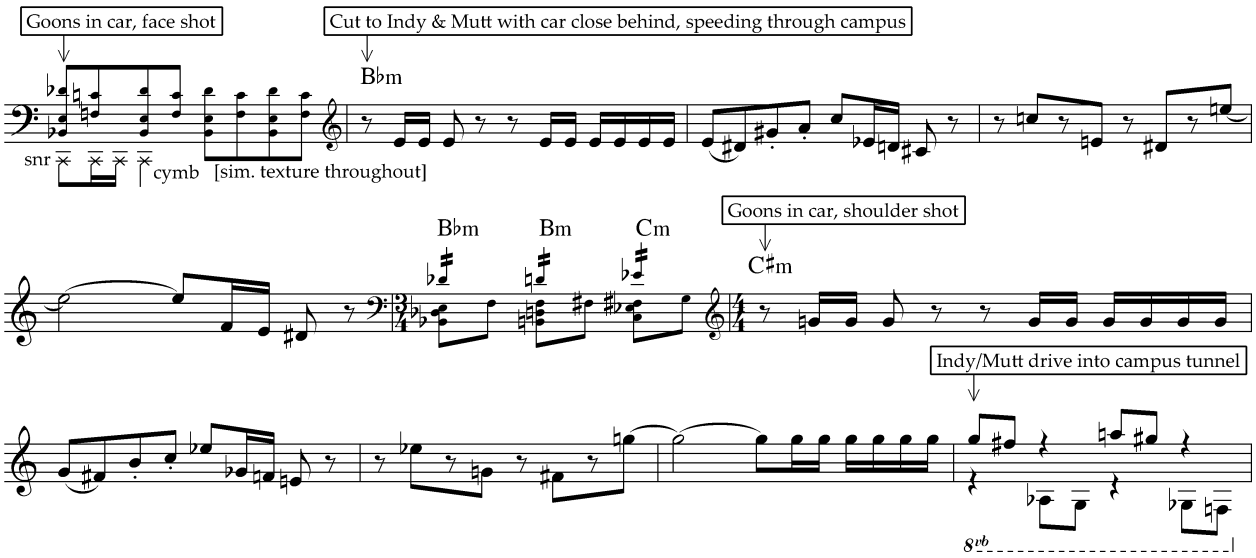
Examples transcribed from KOTCS 2m17

The standout *stand-alone* action cue from KOTCS, with something of a recurring Main Theme, subsidiary ideas, and references to both Raiders March and embryonic elements of the Adventures of Mutt complex of thematic ideas. Most thorough-going octatonicism since Raiders, plus Brahms-based easter egg at end.

FAST STREETS OF MARSHALL COLLEGE



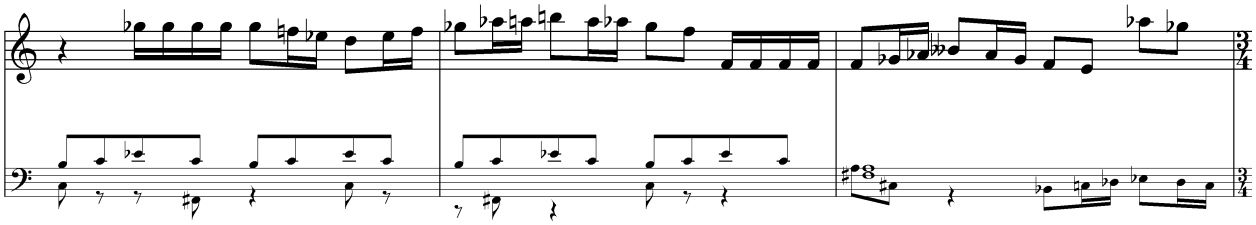
MAIN THEME
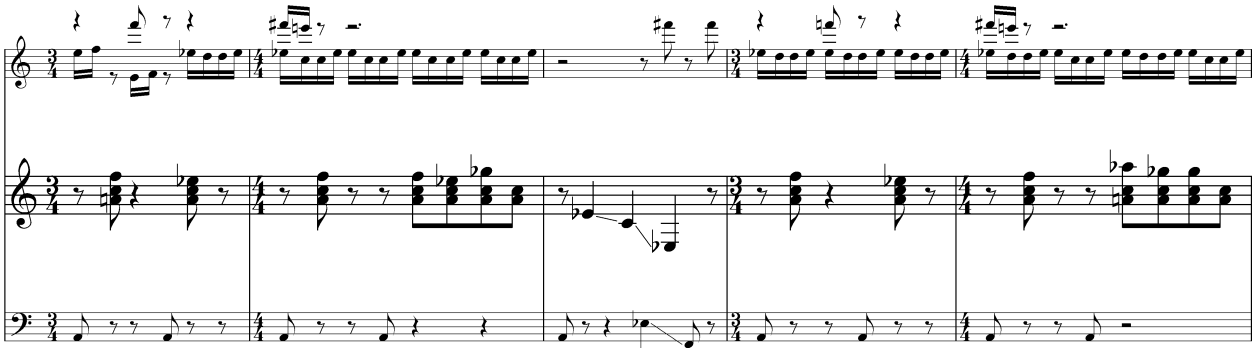


WHIRL THROUGH ACADEME (CONT.)

Examples transcribed from KOTCS 2m17

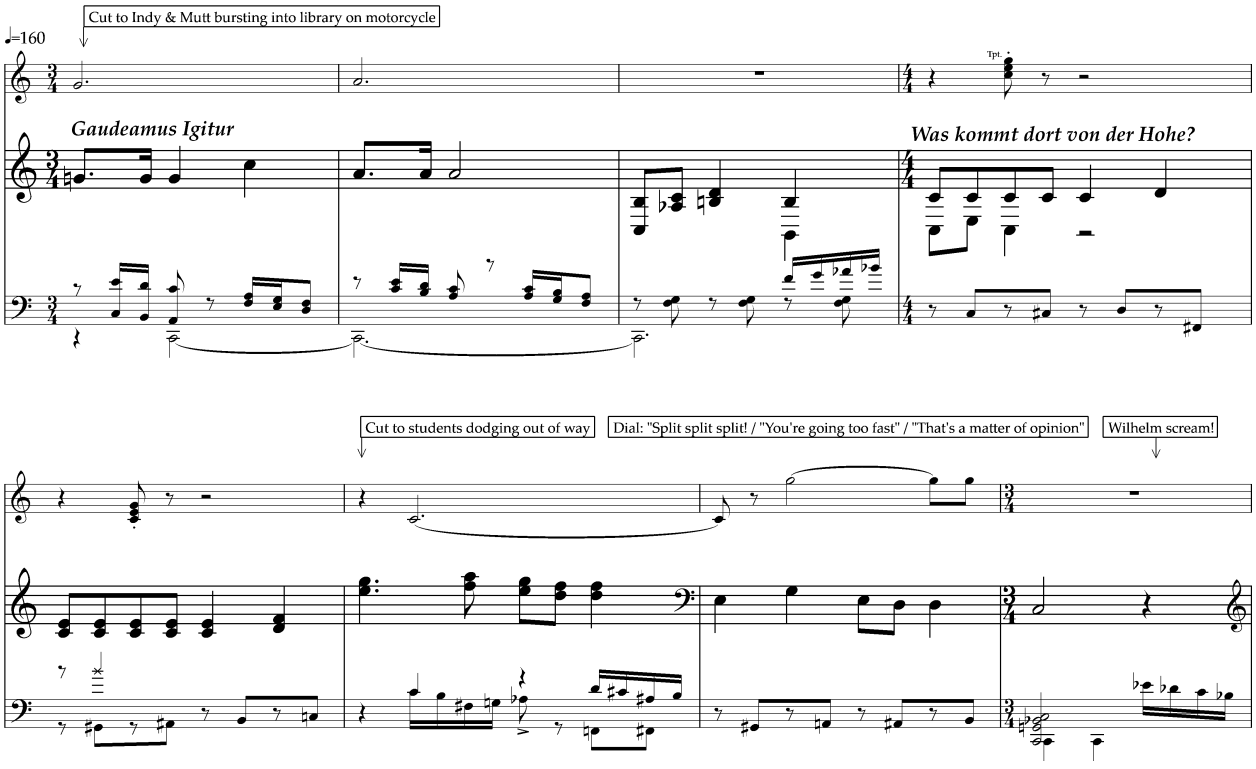
DIMINISHED SCALE DASH



OCTATONIC OBSTACLE COURSE
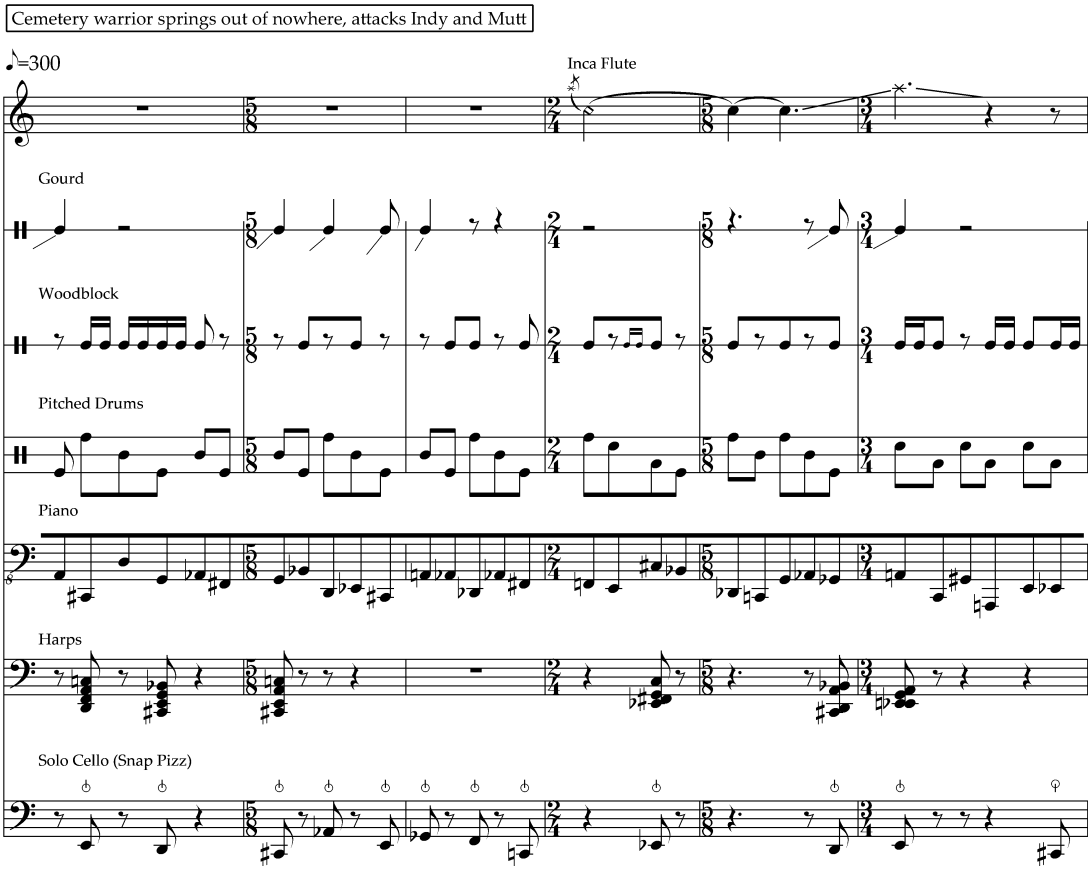


ARCHAEOLOGIC FESTIVAL OVERTURE



GRAVESIDE FIGHT (SKULL)

Example transcribed from KOTCS 3m5

A representative passage from the completely *athematic* 3m5, an action cue that is entirely texture and timbre based. Similar to 6m44 later in score, anticipated in a way by *Raiders'* 2m2.

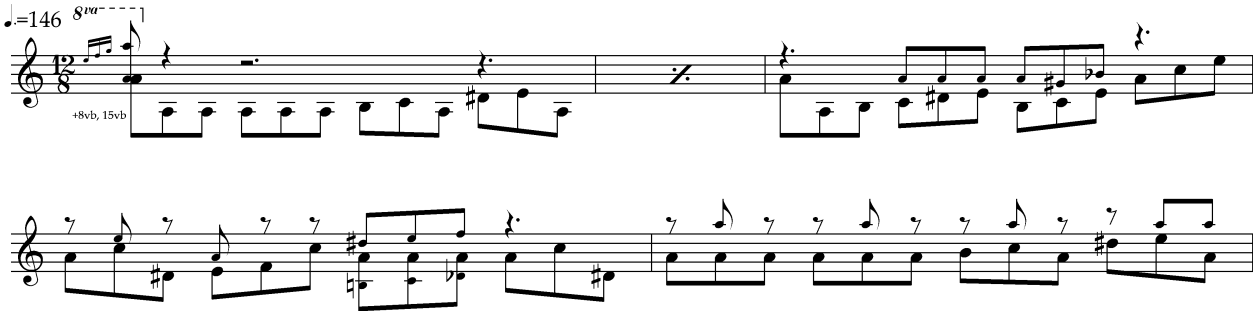


THE JUNGLE CHASE (SKULL)

Examples transcribed from KOTCS 5m38-5m40R

The big moving-vehicle-based action sequence from KOTCS. Overflowing with musical ideas and contrasting episodes, ending with martial ostinato in spirit of Raiders and TLC climactic set-pieces. All major leitmotifs of score appear within this sequence in some way. Even the monkeys get pretty remarkable music.

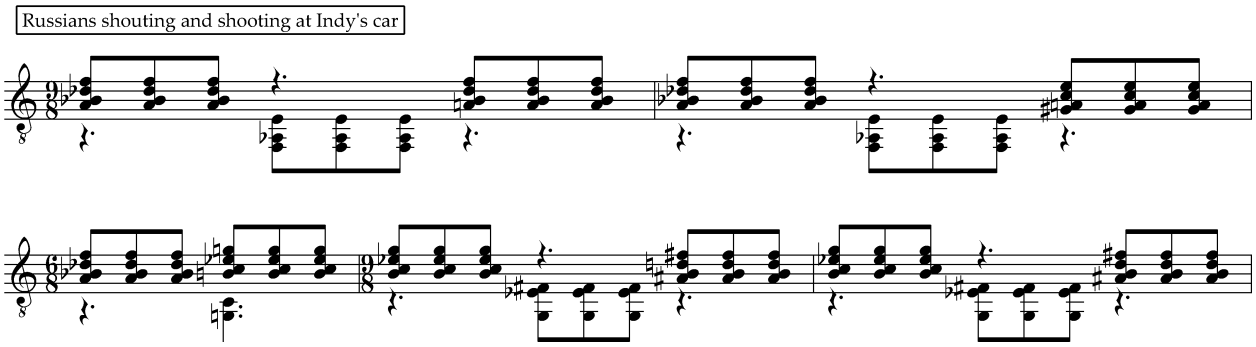
LUDLOW MOTIF, INDIANA JONES EDITION
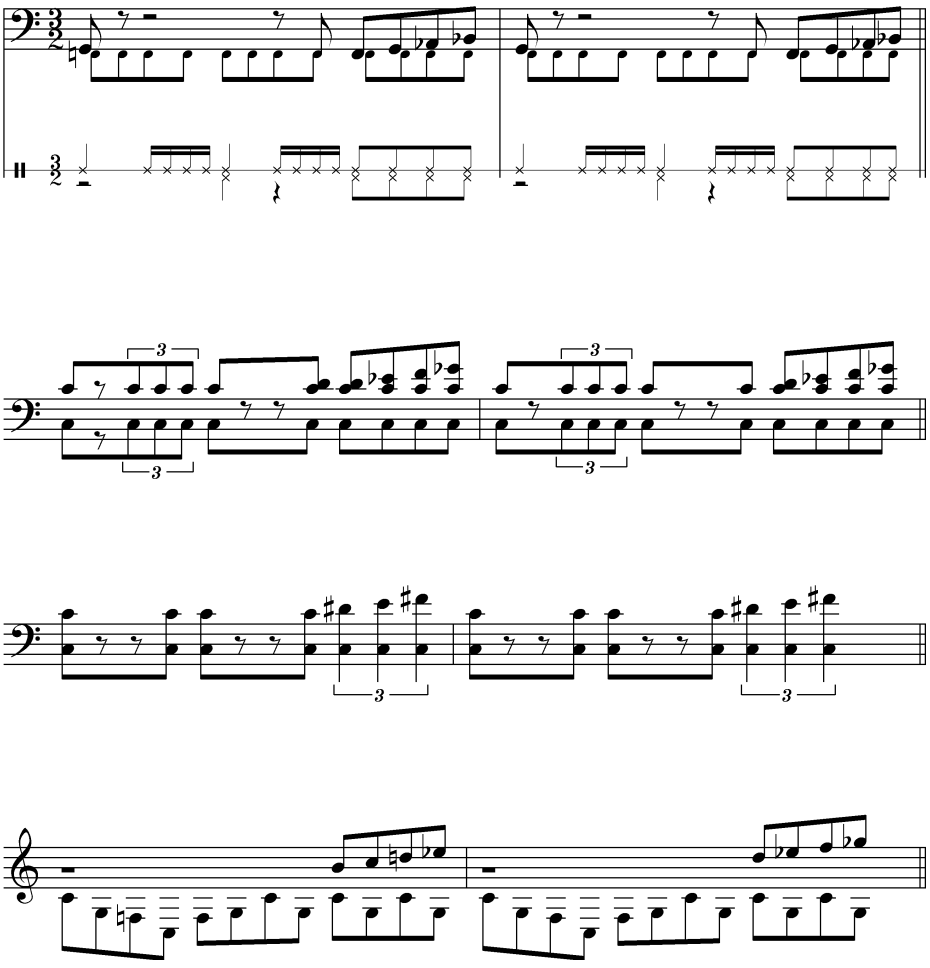


THE JUNGLE CHASE (CONT.)

Examples transcribed from KOTCS 5m38-5m40R

TREACHEROUS TETRADS
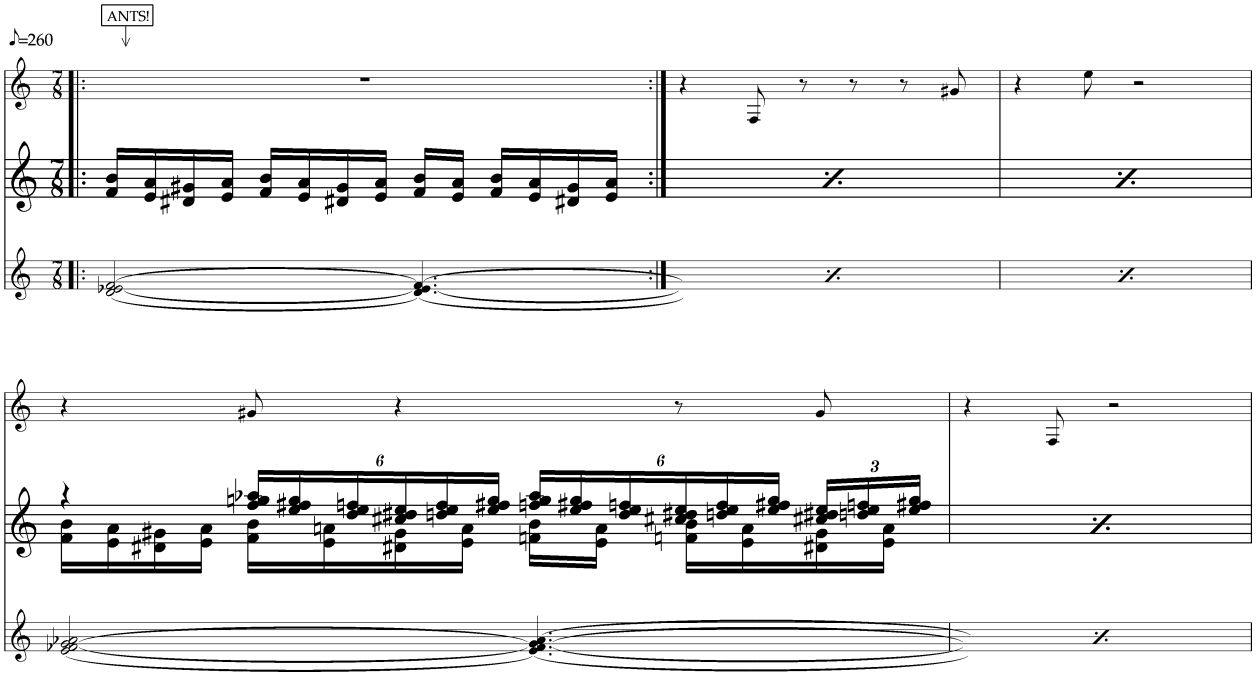


FINAL OSTINATO (VARIOUS)
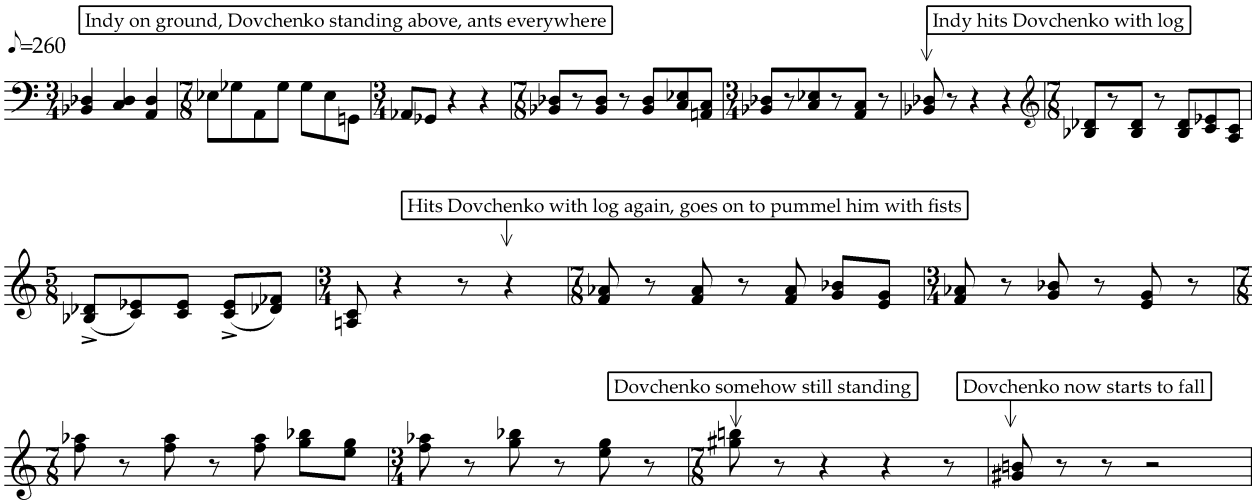


ANTS! (SKULL)

Examples transcribed from KOTCS 5m41

SIAFU SNAFU
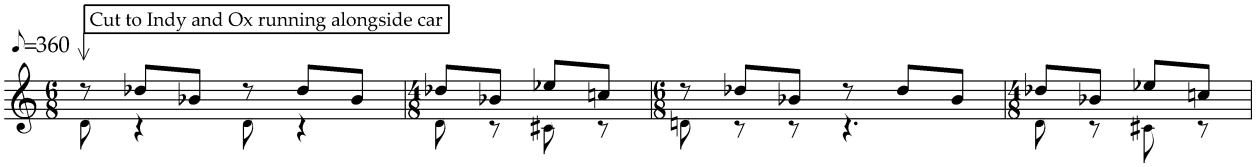


FORMIC FISTICUFFS
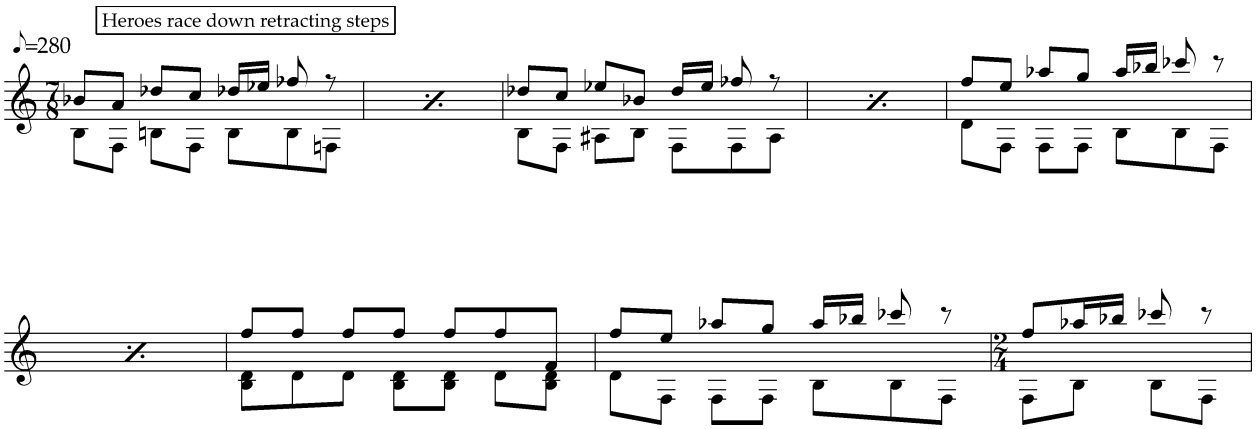


OVER THE CLIFF (SKULL)

Example transcribed from KOTCS 5m42



DOWN THE STAIRS (SKULL)

Example transcribed from KOTCS 6m46



APPENDIX: CUE LISTS

RAIDERS OF THE LOST ARK (1980)

1m1 In The Jungle
1m2 The Cave
1m3 The Rolling Ball
1m3 The Rolling Ball (Insert)
2m2 Flight To Freedom
3m1 The Book
3m2 Thinking Of Marion
3m3 To Tibet
3m4/4m1 The Medallion
4m2 To Cairo
4m5/5m1 Escape In The Alleys
5m3 Poisoned Dates
5m5/6m1 Don't Touch That
6m2 Discovering The Seriph
6m3 Reunion In The Tent
7m1 The Floor That Moves
7m2/8m1 Uncovering The Arc
8m2 Marion Into The Pit
8m3 Escaping The Pit
8m3 Escaping The Pit (Fix)
8m3 Escaping The Pit (Fix Alternate)
8m5 Pffist Fight
9m1 Indie In Pursuit
9m1A Truck Chase
9m1B Indie's Feats
10m4 En Bateau
10m5 The German Sub
10m6 The Nazi Hideout
11m1 Indy Rescues The Ark
11m2/12m1 The Miracle Of The Arc
End Credits Part 1
End Credits Part 2 (Raiders March)

APPENDIX: CUE LISTS

INDIANA JONES AND THE TEMPLE OF DOOM (1983)

1m1 High Life In Hong Kong
1m2 Anything Goes
1m2a Anything Goes - Part II
1m3 Anything Playoff
1m4 A Tribute To Vernon
1m5 Indy Negotiates
1m6 Once In A Vial
1m6a Once In A Vial (Dance Orchestra)
1m7/2m1 Through Chinatown
2m2 Out Of Fuel
2m2 Insert 1
2m2 Insert 2
2m2 Revised Map Extension
2m2a Insert
2m2b Insert
2m3 Down The Snowbank
2m3a Down The Snowbank (New Intro)
2m3b Snowbank Sweetener
2m4 The Indian Village
3m1 The Old Priest's Tale
3m1 Revised The Old Priest
3m2 The Child Returns
3m2a Alternate Beginning
3m3/4m1 The Elephant Ride
4m2 The Scroll
4m3 To Pankot Palace
5m1 Entrance Of The Boy King
5m1x The Emperor's Entrance
5m2a The First Supper
5m2b Exchange Of Glances
5m3 Nocturnal Activities
5m4/6m1 Strangle Hold
6m2 The Inner Chamber
6m3 The Walls Come Down
7m1 Sanskrit Sacrifice
7m1a Sacrifice Sweetener
7m1d Percussion Sweetener - One
7m2 More Sacrifice
7m2d Percussion Sweetener - Two
7m3 Approaching The Stones
7m3d Percussion Sweetener - Three
7m4/8m1 Slave Children
7m4/8m1 Insert
8m2 Moloram's Speech
8m3 The Evil Potion
9m1 Short Round Escapes
9m1x Sacrifice Continued
9m2 Willy In The Fryer
9m3 Saving Willy
9m7/10m1 Crusade Of The Slave Children
10m2 Short Round Helps Out
10m3 Indy Takes Charge
10m4/11m1 Mine Car Chase
11m1 Water Music
11m1 Insert
11m2 The Sword Trick
11m4 The Broken Bridge
11m5/12m1 British Relief
12m2 Finale
12m5 End Credits Note to
Insert
Pankot Palace Source #1
Pankot Palace Source #2-
Rope Bridge Source Music

APPENDIX: CUE LISTS

INDIANA JONES AND THE LAST CRUSADE (1989)

1m2
1m3
1m4/2m1
1m4/2m1x Sweetener
2m2 The Boat Scene
2m3/3m1 Sinister Visitors
3m2a The Holy Grail
3m3 Father's Study
3m4
4m1
4m2 Beneath The Floors
4m3/5m1 Kazim and the Rats!
5m3
5m3 Intro
5m6 Into Bavaria
5m6/6m1 Bringing On Father
6m2 Discussing The Book
6m2x New Ending
6m3
6m3 Alternate Start
6m4 Market Source
6m5 The Capture Of Marcus
7m1 The Austrian Way
7m2 Room In Flames
7m2 Insert
7m3
7m4/8m1 To Berlin
8m2 Koeniggraetzer March
8m3 Meeting Hitler
8m5 Intrigue On The Dirigible
8m7/9m1 Turning Around
9m2
9m2 New Ending
9m2 Final Ending
9m3 Palace Source
9m4 Kasim Meets Max
10m1 The Death Of Kazim
10m1 Insert 1
10m1 Insert 2
10m1 Insert 3
10m1 Fix Fix For Bar 65
10m1 Insert A
10m2
10m3/11m1 On The Tank
10m3/11m1 Insert 1
10m3/11m1 Insert 2
11m2
11m4/12m1 Canyon Of The Crescent Moon
11m4/12m1 Overlap Indy Dad Alternate Start
12m2 The Penitent Man Will Pass
13m1
13m2
13m3 The Wrong Choice
13m4/14m1 Letting It Go
14m2 End Credits

APPENDIX: CUE LISTS

INDIANA JONES AND THE KINGDOM OF THE CRYSTAL SKULL

1m1 Elvis And The Prairie Dog
1m3 The Shoes
1m3R The Shoes [Revised]
1m4 Irena Spalkov [sic]
1m4NR Irena Spalkov [Revised]
1m5 Revisiting The Ark
1m5R Mark Graham Revisits the Ark
1m5B Gun Powder
2m6 Unpacking
2m7 Indie Fights Back [sic, etc.]
2m8 Indie's Great Escape
2m8B A Ride Down Ben Burtt Boulevard
2m8C Indie Versus The Russian
2m9 Giving The Russian The Slip
2m11 Prairie Dog and Nuclear Cloud
2m12 "That's Her"
2m13 Remembering Henry Sr.
2m13R " " " " & Leaving Campus
2m15 "It's Just A Story Kid"
2m15R " " " " [Revised]
2m17 A Knife At A Gunfight
2m19 A Whirl Through Academe
3m20R (2) The Trip to Peru
3m20R The Trip To Akator
3m21 Homage A Maxie
3m23 Reading the Wall
3m24 "I Think I Heard Something"
3m25 Graveside Fight
3m26 Magic Doors and Scorpions
3m26B "Not A Dead End"
3m27 [No Title]
3m27BR "What Is This Thing?"
3m27BR Insert
3m28R Hello Jonesy
3m28v1 Russians Reappear (v. 1)
3m28v2 Russians Reappear (v. 2)
4m30 Not Made By Human Hands
4m32v1 Staring Down The Skull (v. 1)
4m32v2 Staring Down The Skull (v. 2)
4m32v3 Staring Down The Skull (v. 3)
4m33 Ideogram
4m34 Sleeping River Map
4m35 Quick Step In Quicksand
4m36 Grab That Snake
4m37 "We're Not Dead Yet"
5m38 Andy's Full Nelson
5m39 Irina's Great Blade
5m40 Mike Kahn Cooks
5m40R [Revised]
5m41 Ants
5m42 Marion's Best Idea
5m42 [Alt. Ending]
5m43 Ox Marks the SPot
5m43A It Must Be Returned
6m44 Shawn Murphy and the Mad Mayans
6m45 The City Of Gold
6m45alt [Alt. Beginning]
6m46 Stepping Stones
6m47 "This Way, Ramiro!"
6m48 Sanctum Sanctorum
6m49 "Marty Cohen's Hidden Treasure"
6m50 Irena's Long Goodbye
6m50N Earthquake
7m53 Kathy Kennedy's Great Flying Machine
7m53E [Alternate]
7m54 Stick Around Kid
7m54R [Revised]
7m55 George Might Be Next
7m56 Crystal Skull End Credits
7m56 Finale
8m57 Call Of The Crystal
8m58 The Raiders March
8m59 The Adventures Of Mutt
Irina's Theme

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Note on Cadences:

Dominant Focused

PAC: Perfect Authentic Cadence (e.g. …V⇨I^{1})
IAC: Imperfect Authentic Cadence (e.g. …V⇨I^{3}, V^{6}⇨I, etc.)
HC: Half Cadence (e.g. …⇨V)
DC: Deceptive Cadence (e.g. …V⇨vi, V⇨IV)

Subdominant Focused

PC: Plagal Cadence (e.g. …IV⇨I, iv⇨i, ii^{7}⇨I, etc.)
PHC: Plagal Half Cadence (e.g. …⇨IV, …⇨iv)

Other

MC: Modal Cadence (e.g. bII⇨i, bVII⇨i, v⇨I, etc.)
MC: Modal Half Cadence (e.g. …⇨bVII)
CC: Chromatic Cadence (e.g. …bvi⇨I, III#⇨I, etc.)
C-HC: Chromatic Half Cadence (e.g. …⇨bvi)
C-DC: Chromatic Deceptive Cadence (e.g.

The adventure continues. Stay tuned!